MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS MAGAZINE

FEBRUARY 2026



- Detailed release for all exams
- Static GK points included
- Category-wise Compilation
- Live Table of Content

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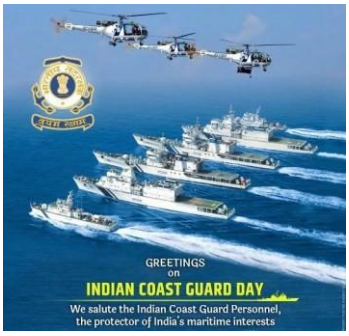
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Important Days & theme

DATE	DAY	THEME/ REMARK
1st February	Indian Coast Guard Day	
1st – 7th February	World Interfaith Harmony Week	
2nd February	Rheumatoid Arthritis Awareness Day	
2nd February	World Wetlands Day	Wetlands and traditional knowledge: Celebrating cultural heritage
3rd February	Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) Foundation Day	
4th February	International Day of Human Fraternity	Dialogue Over Division
4th February	World Cancer Day	United by Unique (2025–27)
6th February	International Day of Zero Tolerance for Female Genital Mutilation	Towards 2030: No end to female genital mutilation without sustained commitment and investment
7th - 14th February	Congenital Heart Defect (CHD) Awareness Week	
8th February	National Opera Day	
Second Monday of February	International Epilepsy Day	
10th February	National Deworming Day	
10th February	World Pulses Day	Pulses of the world: from modesty to excellence
10th February	International Day of the Arabian Leopard	
second Tuesday of February	Safer Internet Day	Smart Tech, Safe Choices: Exploring the Safe and Responsible Use of AI
11th February	International Day of Women and Girls in Science	From Vision to Impact: Redefining STEM by Closing the Gender Gap
11th February	Unani Day	
11th February	World Day of the Sick	
12th February	National Productivity Day	
12th - 18th February	Indian Productivity Week	Clusters as Growth Engine: Maximizing Productivity in MSMEs
12th February	Darwin Day	
13th February	World Radio Day	Radio and Artificial Intelligence: AI is a tool, not a voice
13th February	National Women's Day	
14th February	World Congenital Heart Defect Awareness Day	
15th February	International Childhood Cancer day	Demonstrating Impact
15th February	116th Raising Day of Corps of Signals of Indian Army	
16th February	Delhi Police celebrated Raising Day	
17th February	Global Tourism Resilience Day	
20th February	World Day of Social Justice	Theme: "Renewed Commitment to Social Development and Social Justice"
Third Saturday of February	World Pangolin Day	
21st February	International Mother Language Day	THEME: Youth voices on multilingual education

22nd February	World Thinking Day	
23rd February	World Peace and Understanding Day	
24th February	Central Excise Day	
27th February	World NGO Day	Restoring Dignity Through Inclusion
28th February	National Science Day	Catalysing Viksit Bharat
28th February (Observed annually on the last day of February)	Rare Disease Day	More than you can imagine

1st February – Indian Coast Guard Day



- **50th Raising Day** , **motto is Vayam Rakshamah.**
- The Indian Coast Guard came into being on **1st Feb 1977, with a fleet strength of just seven ships** (two frigates and five patrol boats transfered from the Indian Navy) for **surveillance** in the Indian waters and the **Exclusive Economic Zone**, to prevent ocean-borne goods smuggling.
- The Indian Coast Guard was **formally inaugurated** by the then Prime Minister Shri **Morarji Desai on 19th Aug 1978.**
- **Offshore security, marine safety, and coastal security** are among the Coast Guard's responsibilities, as is safeguarding India's Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ).

1st -7th February World Interfaith Harmony Week



- World Interfaith Harmony Week is an annual event observed during the first week of February.
- It was first proposed by King Abdullah II of Jordan at the United Nations in 2010.

2nd February - Rheumatoid Arthritis Awareness Day



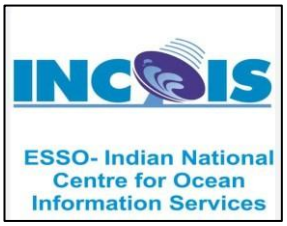
- It is an **autoimmune condition** that **attacks** the **joints and causes inflammation** along with other dangerous conditions.
- Rheumatoid Arthritis is also **one of the most common autoimmune conditions in the world.**
- The condition has **no cure**, but it can go into remission with proper and timely care.

2nd February World Wetlands Day



- Aims to raise global awareness of the vital role of wetlands for people, nature and culture.
- **Theme 2026** – "Wetlands and traditional knowledge: Celebrating cultural heritage"

3rd February - Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) Foundation Day



- Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services **(INCOIS) was established on 3 February 1999** as an **autonomous body under** the **Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES)**, Government of India.

4th February International Day of Human Fraternity



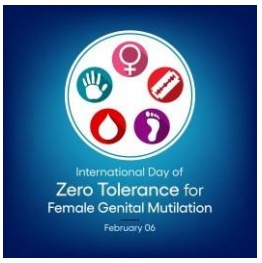
- 2026 Theme: Dialogue Over Division
- proclaimed by the United Nations General Assembly

4th February - World Cancer Day



- Theme **2025-27 - "United by Unique"**
- The day is **led by Union for International Cancer Control (UICC)**
- The day was **established in the year 2000.**

6th February: International Day of Zero Tolerance for Female Genital Mutilation



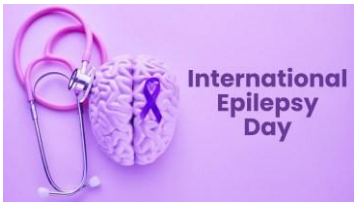
- Female genital mutilation (FGM) comprises all procedures that involve **altering or injuring the female genitalia for non-medical reasons** and is recognized internationally as a violation of the human rights, the health and the integrity of girls and women.
- **This year's theme, "Towards 2030: No end to female genital mutilation without sustained commitment and investment,"**
- **Designated by** UN General Assembly **In 2012**

8th February - National Opera Day



- Opera Day is celebrated every year on 8 February.
- An opera is a combination of acting, scenery, costumes, and dance.
- The term 'opera' in Italian means 'work', and the text is called the 'libretto,' which means "small book."

9th February - International Epilepsy Day



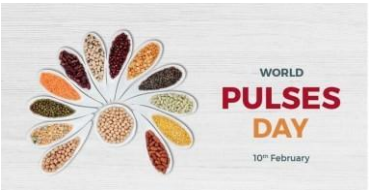
- **second Monday in February** is International Epilepsy Day.
- **Started in 2015** and organized **by** the International Bureau for Epilepsy **(IBE)** and the International League Against Epilepsy **(ILAE),**
- **Epilepsy — also known as a seizure disorder** — is a chronic **brain disorder** where nerve cells don't signal properly, that causes recurring seizures.

10th February - National Deworming Day



- **aimed at deworming (eradicating parasites or intestinal worms) all children between 1 and 19.**
- world's largest deworming programme was **launched in 2015**
- The three types of worms that infect people are **roundworms , whipworms , and hookworms.**

10th February - World Pulses Day

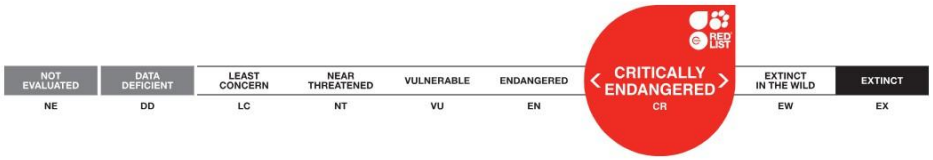


- The day was declared as world pulses day under the **United Nations General Assembly in 2016.**
- **THEME : "Pulses of the world: from modesty to excellence"**
- **India produces the largest pulses (25%),** followed by Canada(9%), China(6%) and European Union(5%).
- India has the largest production(25%), consumption (27%) and importer(14%) of pulses in the world.
- **75% of pulses are produced in the states of Madhya Pradesh** (29.67%), **Maharashtra** (14.66%) **and Rajasthan** (13.75%).

10th February International Day of the Arabian Leopard

- The Arabian leopard (*Panthera pardus nimr*) is a **critically endangered**
- The Arabian leopard **has a very limited distribution**, being found only in a **few isolated pockets of** habitat in **Saudi Arabia, Oman, Yemen, and the United Arab Emirates**. Estimates suggest there may be **fewer than 200** Arabian leopards **left in the wild.**





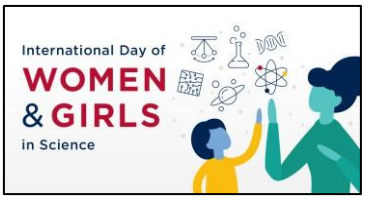
February 10th (second Tuesday of February) - Safer Internet Day

- Safer Internet Day is celebrated globally on the second Tuesday of February
- This annual event is a global call to action for everyone to create a safer and better internet for all, especially for children and young people.
- Theme is “Smart Tech, Safe Choices: Exploring the Safe and Responsible Use of AI."



11th February International Day of Women and Girls in Science

- The theme 2026 - “From Vision to Impact: Redefining STEM by Closing the Gender Gap.”
- In **2015, the UN General Assembly decided to establish** an annual International Day to recognize the critical role women and girls play in science and technology



11th February Unani Day

- commemorates the **birth anniversary of** Unani physician, educator, and freedom fighter **Hakim Ajmal Khan.**
- Unani medicine is **an ancient Greek system of medicine** based on the **teachings of Hippocrates in 460 BC.**



11th February World Day of the Sick

- World Day of the Sick is an annual Catholic observance held on February 11 to pray for those suffering from illness and for their caregivers.



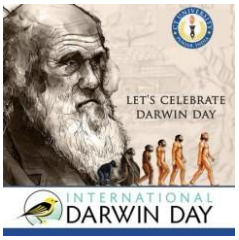
12th February - National Productivity Day

- to commemorate the **founding of the National Productivity Council (NPC).**
- **Indian Productivity Week** - from **February 12 to February 18.**
- **THEME FOR THE WEEK :Clusters as Growth Engine: Maximizing Productivity in MSMEs”.**



12th February – Darwin Day

- **birthday of naturalist Charles Darwin** (12 February 1809 – 19 April 1882).
- Darwin published his work on evolution by natural selection as a book (‘**On the Origin of Species by Means of Natural Selection**’) and a series of articles between 1858-59

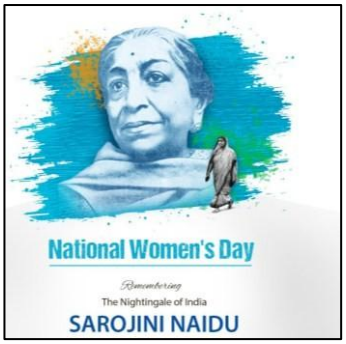


13th February World Radio Day 2026



- World Radio Day, observed annually **on February 13** commemorates the establishment of **United Nations Radio in 1946.**
- designated in 2011 by UNESCO
- **The theme 2026** - "Radio and Artificial Intelligence: AI is a tool, not a voice."
- **The first Community Radio Station** was inaugurated on February 1, 2004 by Bharat Ratna Shri Lal Krishna Advani.
- **Ram Singh Bouddh** from **Amroha, Uttar Pradesh**, known as the "**Radio Man of India**," was recognised by **Guinness World Records in 2025** for owning the **world's largest collection** of 1,257 radios.

13th February – National Women's Day



- **Sarojini Naidu -** Nightingale of India- **Birth Anniversary**
- Naidu was **born in Hyderabad on 13th February 1879**
- **First woman from India** to be elected as the **President of the Indian National Congress** at its **Kanpur session in 1925**.
- After independence, she also became the **first governor of Uttar Pradesh**. Above all, she is a pioneering figure in **Indian English poetry**.
- Naidu's poetic works include **The Golden Threshold**,**The Bird of Time: Songs of Life, Death and The Spring**, **The Broken Wing: Songs of Love, Death and Destiny**, **The Feather of the Dawn**

14th February- World Congenital Heart Defect Awareness Day



- congenital heart defects (C.H.D.), a **deadly group of birth disorders** that impact the heart
- **CHD Awareness Week,** observed annually and this year from **February 7th to 14th**

15th February International Childhood Cancer day



- It is a global collaborative campaign to raise awareness about childhood cancer, and to express support for children and adolescents with cancer, the survivors and their families.
- **Theme -** Demonstrating Impact
- The All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) and the Indian Revenue Service Ladies Association (IRSLA) jointly organised a walkathon in New Delhi

15th February - Corps of Signals of Indian Army celebrates 116th Raising Day



- The Corps of Signals of the Indian Army is celebrating its 116th Raising Day.
- Since its inception on this day in 1911,

16th February – Delhi Police celebrated Raising Day



- 1861 (originally founded as a security force under the British rule)
- **16 February 1948 (renamed as Delhi Police)**

17 February Global Tourism Resilience Day



- Marked to commemorate the resilience and adaptability of the travel and tourism sector.
- In February 2024, the General Assembly decided to proclaim **2027 the International Year of Sustainable and Resilient Tourism.**
- The World Tourism Organization (UNWTO) is a leading UN international agency in the field of tourism.

20 February - World Day of Social Justice



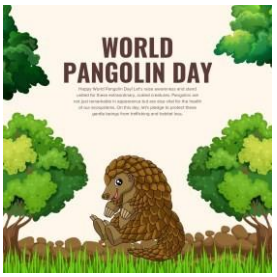
- Declared in 2007 by UN General Assembly
- Theme: "Renewed Commitment to Social Development and Social Justice"

21 February - International Mother Language Day



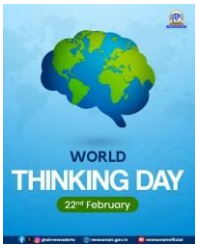
- THEME: Youth voices on multilingual education
- This day promotes the awareness of language and cultural diversity across the world.
- In 1999, it was first announced by UNESCO. It has been observed throughout the world since 2000.

21 February World Pangolin Day 2026



- Every year on the third Saturday of February, people around the world celebrate World Pangolin Day.
- The event was first observed in 2012.
- There are 8 species of pangolins.
- Indian pangolin is Endangered on the IUCN Red List.
- The Chinese pangolin is listed as Critically Endangered.
- Both are protected under Schedule I of India's Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- All 8 species are listed in CITES Appendix I, prohibiting international commercial trade.

22 February - World Thinking Day



- It is observed every year on February 22.
- Dedicated to unity, friendship, and empowerment among girls and young women. Celebrated by members of the Girl Guides and Girl Scouts
- Celebrated since 1926 - 100 years of World Thinking Day.

23 February- World Peace and Understanding Day



- It marks the anniversary of the first Rotary meeting held in Chicago in 1905.

24 February – Central Excise Day



- Commemorates the enactment of the Central Excise and Salt Act of 1944.
- This day was celebrated for the first time in 1944.

27th February - World NGO Day



- Observed annually to acknowledge and celebrate the contributions of Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)
- Theme : "Restoring Dignity Through Inclusion."

28th February - National Science Day 2026



- It is to commemorate the **discovery of the 'Raman Effect'** by the eminent physicist **Sir C.V. Raman** while working in the laboratory of the **Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science, Kolkata.**

- For this discovery, he was awarded the **Nobel Prize in 1930.**
- The **first celebration** took place on **February 28, 1987**
- The **theme** - *Women In Science Catalysing Viksit Bharat.*

28th February - Rare Disease Day



- Observed annually on the last day of February (February 28, or 29 in leap years).
- Theme is “More than you can imagine”.

APPOINTMENT

R Vijay Anandh	**Managing Director & CEO, City Union Bank**
Vinay Tonse	**Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer, Yes Bank**
Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia	**Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Eastern Air Command**
Shri Divakar Jayant	**Director General of Naval Armament (DGONA)**
Yumnam Khemchand Singh	**Chief Minister of Manipur**
Nemcha Kipgen	**Deputy Chief Minister of Manipur**
Rohit Kumar Singh	**Chair, Global Value Chains Committee (USISPF) and Advisor to the USISPF Board of Directors**
Tarique Rahman	Bangladesh Prime Minister
Sanae Takaichi	**Prime Minister of Japan**
Rob Jetten	**Prime Minister of the Netherlands**
Sunetra Pawar	**National President of the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP)**
Asha Sharma	**Executive Vice President and Chief Financial Officer, Microsoft Gaming**
Ranvir Sachdeva	**Youngest speaker to address the high-profile gathering at the India AI Impact Summit 2026**
Captain Rohit Rikhye	**New Head of Operations Control Centre (OCC) at IndiGo**
Harsharan Kaur Trehan	**First woman technocrat appointed as Director (Commercial), Punjab State Power Corporation Limited**
Rajan Bajaj	**Slice Small Finance Bank MD & CEO**
Shri Hardeep Singh Gill and Shri Karm Singh Karma	**Members in the National Commission for Safai Karamcharis**
Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari	**Chief Justice of Madras High Court**
Sachin Tendulkar	**Global Champion for Road Safety**

RBI Appoints Vinay Tonse as YES Bank MD and CEO



- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) approved the appointment of Vinay Muralidhar Tonse as the new Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer of Yes Bank.
- Prashant Kumar, the current MD and CEO, is in the midst of his extended term.

Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia Assumes Charge as AOC-in-Chief, Eastern Air Command



- Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia assumed the appointment of Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Eastern Air Command in New Delhi.
- He was commissioned in the Fighter stream of the Indian Air Force in June 1988.
- He is also a recipient of the Vayu Sena Medal and Ati Vishisht Seva Medal.

SHRI DIVAKAR JAYANT, INAS, TAKES OVER AS DIRECTOR GENERAL OF NAVAL ARMAMENT



- Shri Divakar Jayant, INAS, has taken over as Director General of Naval Armament (DGONA) on 02 Feb 2026, succeeding Shri P Upadhyay, who superannuated on 31 Jan 2026.
- Shri Divakar Jayant belongs to the 1991 batch of the Indian Naval Armament Service

Yumnam Khemchand Set to Become Manipur Chief Minister



- Yumnam Khemchand Singh, 62, was elected Legislature Party Leader of the Bharatiya Janata Party in Manipur , .With the election, Mr. Singh is set to become the Chief Minister of the State.
- Nemcha Kipgen, a Kuki-Zo MLA from Kangpokpi is likely to be appointed Deputy Chief Minister.
- She will be the first woman and the first Kuki-Zo to hold the post.
- The tenure of the State Assembly ends in February 2027.

RBI Approves Vijay Anandh as City Union Bank CEO



- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) had approved the appointment of R Vijay Anandh, currently the Executive Director (ED) at the private bank, as the next Managing Director & CEO.
- for a period of 3 years w.e.f May 1, 2026
- N Kamakodi has been serving as MD & CEO of CUB since May 2011, and his term ends on April 30, 2026.

Rohit Kumar Singh has been appointed as Chair of Global Value Chains Committee of the USISPF



- Former consumer affairs secretary Rohit Kumar Singh has been appointed as Chair of Global Value Chains Committee of the US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) and advisor to the USISPF Board of Directors.
- The 1989-batch an IAS officer of Rajasthan cadre, Singh has served as the Secretary, Consumer Affairs, and led India's first AI-enabled grievance redressal ecosystem

Tarique Rahman's Win Bangladesh General Elections



- The Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) led by Tarique Rahman has secured a historic victory in the general elections, ending nearly two decades of political dominance by the Awami League.
- Won approximately 218 seats, securing an absolute majority.
- Jamaat-e-Islami emerged as the second-largest political force with significant gains.
- Bangladesh is a South Asian country that emerged as an independent nation in 1971 after the Liberation War against Pakistan.
- Capital - Dhaka





Bordering Nations:

- India (West Bengal, Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram) – on three sides
- Myanmar (Burma) – southeast
- Opens to the Bay of Bengal in the south

Sanae Takaichi: Japan's first woman PM



- Japan's PM Sanae Takaichi won a landslide victory, became the first woman leader of a country known for its male-dominated political landscape.
- Location: It is an island nation in East Asia, situated in the Northwestern Pacific Ocean.
- Maritime borders: It is bordered by the Pacific Ocean (East), Sea of Okhotsk (North), Sea of Japan (West East) and East China Sea (Southwest).
- Political Structure: Parliamentary government under a constitutional monarchy.
- Capital City: Tokyo, located in east-central Honshu.
- Main Islands (north to south): Hokkaido, Honshu, Shikoku, and Kyushu.
- Major rivers: Shinano River (longest), Tone River, Kiso River.



Rob Jetten Becomes Netherlands' Youngest Prime Minister



- The Netherlands witnessed history in the making as 38-year-old Rob Jetten was sworn in as the country's youngest prime minister - succeeds Dick Schoof.

Netherlands

- Location: It is a country located in Northwestern Europe.
- Bordering Countries: It is bordered by Germany in the east; and Belgium in the south.
- Maritime Borders: It is bounded by the North Sea in the north and west.
- Capital City: Amsterdam



Deputy Chief Minister Sunetra Pawar was elected unopposed as the national president of the Nationalist Congress Party (NCP)



NEWS IN SHORT

- Microsoft has named Indian-origin Asha Sharma as Executive Vice President and CEO of Microsoft Gaming
- Eight-year-old coder Ranvir Sachdeva emerged as a standout figure at the India AI Impact Summit 2026, becoming the youngest speaker to address the high-profile gathering at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.
- IndiGo has appointed Captain Rohit Rikhye as the new Head of its Operations Control Centre (OCC).
- Harsharan Kaur Trehan, 61, has become the first woman technocrat to be appointed Director (Commercial) of the Punjab State Power Corporation Limited.

Supreme Court collegium recommends Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari as next CJ of Madras HC



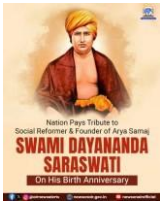
- Madras High Court Chief Justice Manindra Mohan Shrivastava is due to retire from service on March 5, 2026.
- The Supreme Court collegium has recommended Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari, now serving in the Kerala High Court, as the next Chief Justice of the Madras High Court.

News in short

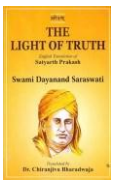
- Shri Hardeep Singh Gill and Shri Karm Singh Karma have assumed the charge of Members in the National Commission for Safai Karamcharis w.e.f. 23.02.2026 (A/N).
- Cricket legend Sachin Tendulkar has been designated a ‘Global Champion for Road Safety’ by the United Nations,
- Slice Small Finance Bank Appoints Rajan Bajaj as MD & CEO

EMMINENT PERSONALITIES

12 Feb- Maharishi Dayanand Saraswati Birth Anniversary

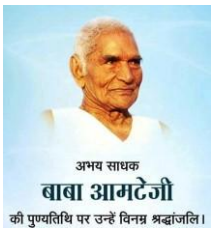






- Dayanand Saraswati was **born on February 12**, 1824, **in Tankara**, a small town in the present-day **Gujarat, India.**
- **Foundation of Arya Samaj (1875):** a Hindu reform movement, in 1875 in Bombay (now Mumbai).
- **Promotion of Vedic Education**: which he believed was essential for the moral and spiritual upliftment of society.
- He **established numerous schools and gurukuls** (traditional Vedic schools) across India, where students were taught the principles of the Vedas, along with modern subjects.
- The **DAV (Dayanand Anglo Vedic) schools** were founded in 1886 to realise Swami Dayanand Saraswati's vision.
- **Paropkarini Sabha:** In 1882-83 - **to publish and preach his works and Vedic texts**
- **Literary Contribution:** Dayanand's seminal work, **"Satyarth Prakash" (The Light of Truth),** was a critical exposition of Vedic teachings and a critique of various Hindu practices and rituals. It remains a key text for followers of Arya Samaj.
- Other books include the **Sanskar Vidhi, Rigved Bhashyam**, etc.

9 February- Baba Amte's Death Anniversary

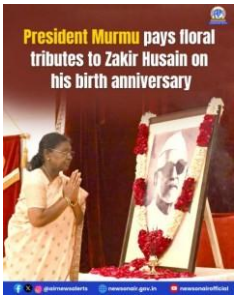


- On February 9,India will commemorate the death anniversary of Baba Amte

Key contributions :

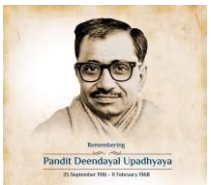
- **Quit India Movement (1942):** Joined the movement, mobilized lawyers, and was imprisoned. Gained the title "Abhay Sadhak" from Gandhi for bravery.
- **Anandwan:** Founded in 1949, Anandwan (meaning 'Forest of Joy') became a self-sustaining community for leprosy patients. It provided medical care, vocational training, and a dignified life to those ostracized by society.
- **Narmada Bachao Andolan (1989) :** Joined the movement to oppose dam projects on the Narmada River, advocating for sustainable development and better rehabilitation of displaced people.

President pays tribute to former President Zakir Hussain on his birth anniversary



- Dr. Zakir Husain (08 Feb 1897- 03 May 1969) was an Indian statesman, and the first Muslim to hold the position of President of India in 1967.
- He was also appointed governor of Bihar state in 1957 and was elected vice-president of India in 1962.
- He helped found the Muslim National University in Aligarh (later moved to New Delhi) and served as its vice-chancellor from 1926 to 1948.
- At Mahatma Gandhi's invitation, he also became chairman of the National Committee on Basic Education, established in 1937 to design a Gandhian syllabus for schools.
- During 1956–58, he served on the executive board of the United Nations Educational, Scientific, and Cultural Organization (UNESCO).

11th February Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya death anniversary



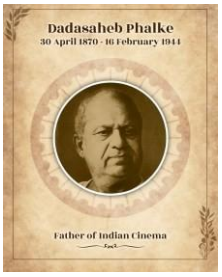
- **Antyodaya Diwas was observed on 25th September** to commemorate the **birth anniversary** of Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya.
- Born on September 25, 1916, in the sacred region of **Braj in in Mathura District.**

- A key leader of the Bharatiya Jana Sangh (BJS), he shaped Indian political thought.
- assassinated on 11th February 1968

Contributions:

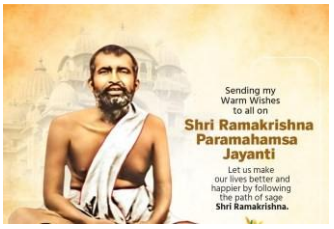
- He **launched the weekly 'Panchjanya'** and the **daily 'Swadesh'.**
- His **mantra for journalism** was **'Don't distort the news'.**
- He wrote a number of books including Samrat Chandragupt, Jagatguru Shankaracharya, Political Diary, **Integral humanism** (**Ekatmamanav-vad)** and an analysis of the Five Year plans in India.

16 February - Dadasaheb Phalke death anniversary



- Dhundiraj Govind Phalke, hailed as the "Father of Indian Cinema,"
- He was born on April 30, 1870, in Trimbak, Maharashtra.
- Phalke was a multifaceted genius — a painter, photographer, stage playwright, and a magician — before venturing into filmmaking.
- He was a film director who is considered the father of Indian cinema.
- He directed India's first full-length feature film, Raja Harishchandra in 1913.
- Dada Saheb Phalke Award is given by the Indian government for lifetime contribution to Indian cinema.

Ramakrishna Paramhansa Jayanti



- Born as **Gadadhar Chattopadhyay** on February 18, 1836, in **Kamarpukur, West Bengal.**
- His **189th birth anniversary** will be observed on **February 18, 2025.**
- As per the Hindu lunar calendar, his birth anniversary falls on **Dwitiya Tithi of Shukla Paksha in Phalguna month.**
- **Spiritual Mentor: Bhairavi Brahmani**
- **Main Teachings:** All religion lead to God, self-realization is the highest goal and devotion is essential in spiritual life.
- The **Ramakrishna Mission** is a significant spiritual and humanitarian organization **founded** on **May 1, 1897** in Belur, West Bengal **by Swami Vivekananda**, a chief disciple of the Indian mystic Ramakrishna Paramahamsa.
- The mission aims to propagate Ramakrishna's teachings and serve humanity, guided by the ideals: *"***Atmano Mokshartham Jagat Hitaya Cha***"*—"For one's own salvation and for the welfare of the world."

17 February - Bharat Ratna Karpuri Thakur ji death anniversary



- Karpoori Thakur, called as "Jan Nayak", was a prominent Indian politician who served as the 11th Chief Minister of Bihar twice, from 1970-71 and 1977-79.
- **Karpoori Thakur, born on 24 January 1924 in Pitaunjhia (now Karpoori Gram) in the Samastipur district, Bihar. At the time of his birth, the area was part of the Darbhanga district**
- Represented the **Nai community, listed as an Extremely Backward Class (EBC) among OBCs.**
- In **2024** , the **President of India** announced the **Bharat Ratna awarded to socialist leader and former Chief Minister of Bihar Karpoori Thakur,** posthumously.

19 February Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Jayanti



- Chhatrapati Shivaji, the **founder of the Maratha Empire**
- **Born on 19th February 1630** at the **Shivneri Fort** in the Junnar district of present day **Maharashtra.**
- He was born **to Shahaji Bhosale and Jijabai.**
- He **introduced the collection of two taxes** called the **Chauth** and **Sardeshmukhi.**

- He also **divided his kingdom into four provinces**, each **headed by** a **Mamlatdar.**
- He **abolished the Jagirdari System** and **replaced it** with the **Ryotwari System.**
- He took on the **titles of Chhatrapati**, Kshatriya Kulavantas and Haindava Dharmodhharak

NATIONAL AWARD

Paradip Port Authority Wins First Prize at Swachhata Pakhwada Awards 2025

- Paradip Port Authority (PPA) has been awarded the **First Prize at the Swachhata Pakhwada Awards 2025,**
- instituted by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW), in recognition of its outstanding performance in cleanliness, sustainability, and community participation.
- Paradip Port Authority successfully implemented the three core pillars of Swachhata Pakhwada 2025: Jan Bhagidari, Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam, and Safai Mitra Suraksha.

Bhutan Queen Mother conferred 'Soldier of Humanity' award in Assam

- **Gyalyum Ashi Dorji Wangmo Wangchuck**, the Queen Mother of Bhutan, was conferred the 22nd Upendra Nath Brahma 'Soldier of Humanity' Award, 2025, at Bodoland University in Kokrajhar, Assam
- presented by the Upendra Nath Brahma Trust (UNBT) in recognition of the Queen Mother's "lifelong and exceptional contributions to humanitarian service, social development, and inclusive growth"
- The award carries a citation, a statuette of Upendra Nath Brahma, revered as Bodofa, (meaning guardian of the Bodo ethnic community), traditional Bodo artefacts including sereja, a musical instrument, aronai, a decorative scarf, and dokhona, women's attire, and a cash prize of ₹2 lakh.



Chef Vishnu Manohar creates world record with 1,111 kg finger millet pudding at Koya Krushi Kumbh

- A world record was created at the 'Koya Krushi Kumbh' festival in Gadchiroli, aimed at promoting agricultural produce and local products on a global platform, when 1,111 kilograms of finger millet (ragi) pudding was prepared under the leadership of noted chef Vishnu Manohar.
- The initiative brought national and international focus to coarse cereals grown in the district, particularly finger millet, highlighting its nutritional value and agricultural importance.
- The record was officially registered with the India Book of Records, the Asia Book of Records, and the World Record Book of India



Karan Adani Wins AIMA Business Leader Award 2026

- Karan Adani, Managing Director of Adani Ports & SEZ Ltd and Adani Cement Ltd, has been honoured with the Business Leader of the Year award at the 2026 Managing India Awards organised by the All India Management Association (AIMA).
- **Director of the Year:** Mohit Suri, Director, Saiyaara.
- **Outstanding PSU of the Year:** Cochin Shipyard Limited. Award received by Harikrishnan S, Director (Operations).
- **Young Business Leader of the Year:** Ananya Birla, Founder, Svatantra Microfin Pvt. Ltd
- **Lifetime Contribution Award:** Harsh Mariwala, Chairman, Marico Limited.



Short news

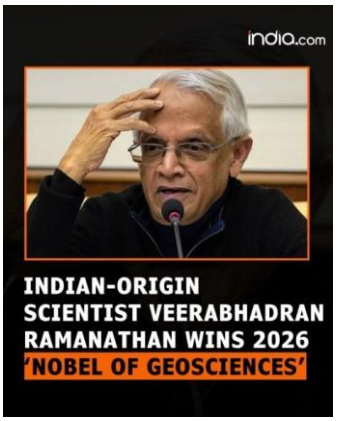
- Diplomat-turned-Congress MP Shashi Tharoor was conferred an honorary Doctor of Letters (D.Litt) degree at the seventh convocation of St Xavier's University, Kolkata, his first honorary doctorate in India.

India Launches Zero Prize, Paying Big for Tangible Pollution Reduction

- Zero Prize has been launched as India's first national results-based environmental award that directly links financial incentives to independently verified reductions in air, water, and land pollution.
- **Convened by the School of Policy and Governance (SPG), the initiative is supported by philanthropic funding, corporate CSR partnerships, and institutional stakeholders.**
- It aims to align financial support with measurable environmental outcomes.
- With a total corpus of ₹5 crore, **the Zero Prize will grant ₹1 crore each in three categories—Air, Water, and Land—to solutions that demonstrate scientifically validated pollution reduction within defined geographies.**
- The prize is structured as an annual national initiative focused on results-based environmental recognition and performance-linked funding.
- **The framework aligns with national missions, including the National Clean Air Programme, the National Mission for Clean Ganga and Swachh Bharat Mission 2.0 by accelerating verifiable, on-ground environmental outcomes.**
- Eligible applicants must implement a real-world pilot within defined urban or peri-urban contexts and undergo independent third-party monitoring and validation.
- **Early-stage concepts without measurable on-ground execution will not qualify.**

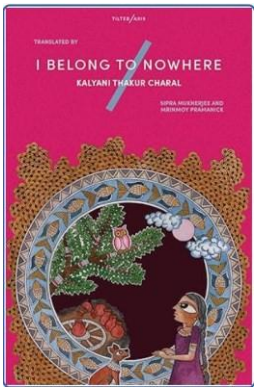
INTERNATIONAL

Veerabhadran Ramanathan and the Nobel of Geosciences



- Indian-origin climate scientist Veerabhadran Ramanathan has been awarded the 2026 Crafoord Prize in Geosciences by the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences.
- Often described as the "Nobel of Geosciences,"
- the prize recognises Ramanathan's decades of research on super-pollutants and atmospheric brown clouds, which have reshaped understanding of global warming.
- Born in Madurai and raised in Chennai,
- Ramanathan, 82, made a landmark discovery in 1975 while working at NASA: chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs), widely used in aerosols and refrigeration, trap heat in the atmosphere up to 10,000 times more effectively than carbon dioxide.
- The Crafoord Prize carries a cash award of 8 million Swedish kronor (approximately $900,000) and a gold medal.

Two Bengal academicians win A.K. Ramanujan Prize for translating Dalit woman poet's works



- Two academicians Sipra Mukherjee and Mrinmoy Pramanick, from West Bengal have won the coveted A.K. Ramanujan Prize
- for translating into English the works of Dalit poet Kalyani Thakur Charal, titled I Belong to Nowhere,
- becoming the first Bengalis to win the honour.
- The poems were translated from Bengali
- It is awarded by the Association for Asian Studies (AAS).

Grammy Awards 2026



- **Organised by the Recording Academy** at the **Crypto.com Arena in Los Angeles**.
- At 90, the Dalai Lama earned his first Grammy Award at the 68th edition of the annual awards ceremony in Los Angeles.
- The Tibetan spiritual leader won in the Best Audio Book, Narration & Storytelling Recording category for his spoken-word album Meditations: The Reflections of His Holiness the Dalai Lama.

CATEGORY	WINNER
Album of the Year	Bad Bunny - Debí Tirar Más Fotos
Song of the Year	Wildflower - Billie Eilish
Record Of The Year	Luther - Kendrick Lamar feat SZA
Best New Age, Ambient, or Chant Album	Nomadica - Carla Patullo
Best New Artist	Olivia Dean
Best Rock Song	Nine Inch Nails - As Alive As You Need Me To Be
Best Rock Album	Turnstile - Never Enough
Narration & Storytelling Recording category	Dalai Lama - Meditations: The Reflections Of His Holiness The Dalai Lama

Paul Thomas Anderson wins DGA Award for 'One Battle After Another'



- The winners of the Directors Guild of America Awards for Outstanding Directorial Achievement in 2025 were announced during the 78th Annual DGA Awards at the Beverly Hilton in Beverly Hills.
- Paul Thomas Anderson claimed the top honor at the Directors Guild of America Awards , winning Outstanding Directorial Achievement in Theatrical Feature Film for One Battle After Another.
- First - Time Theatrical Feature Film category - Charlie Polinger
  The Plague
- Dramatic Series - Amanda Marsalis , The Pitt
- Comedy Series - Seth Rogen & Evan Goldberg
  The Studio, "The Oner"
- Outstanding Directorial Achievement in
  Limited & Anthology Series - Shannon Murphy
  Dying for Sex, "It's Not That Serious"
- Outstanding Directorial Achievement in
  Movies for Television - Stephen Chbosky
  Nonnas

Rouble Nagi Wins Global Teacher Prize In Dubai



- Indian teacher Rouble Nagi received the Global Teacher Prize 2026 during the World Government Summit on Wednesday, winning the one million dollar award presented by GEMS Education in its tenth edition.
- The Global Teacher Prize, presented by GEMS Education and organised by the Varkey Foundation in collaboration with UNESCO

India AI and Intel India create World Record for most pledges received for an AI responsibility campaign in 24 hours



- India has successfully achieved the **Guinness World Records title for the "Most pledges received for an AI responsibility campaign in 24 hours,"** with a staggering 250,946 valid pledges received during the 24-hour period from February 16–17.
- The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India, under the IndiaAI Mission, in collaboration with Intel India, launched "the nationwide campaign beginning 16 February 2026.

Indian movie 'Boong' bags BAFTA award for Best Children's & Family Film



- The 79th British Academy Film Awards ceremony held at the Royal Festival Hall in London.
- A landmark moment for Indian cinema and the Northeast, the Manipuri-language film 'Boong' won the Best Children's & Family Film award at the 79th British Academy Film Awards (BAFTA 2026).
- Produced by Excel Entertainment, Chalkboard Entertainment, and Suitable Pictures.
- **Directed by :** lakshmipriya devi
- **Best Leading Actress** – Jessie Buckley, Hamnet
- **Best Leading Actor** – Robert Aramayo, I Swear
- **Best Cinematography** – One Battle After Another
- **Best Film** – One Battle After Another

- **Outstanding British Film** – Hamnet
- **Outstanding Debut by a British Writer, Director or Producer** – My Father's Shadow
- **Best Film Not in the English Language** – Sentimental Value
- **Best Documentary** – Mr. Nobody Against Putin
- **Best Animated Film** – Zootopia 2
- **Best Children's & Family Film** – Boong
- **Best Director** – Paul Thomas Anderson, One Battle After Another
- **Best Original Screenplay** – Sinners

BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year Awards 2025



- The winners of the sixth edition of the BBC Indian Sportswoman of the Year Awards have been announced.
- **Smriti Mandhana**, Vice Captain of the Indian Women's Cricket Team has been named the BBC Indian Sportswoman Of The Year (ISWOTY) 2025
- **Divya Deshmukh**: BBC Emerging Player of the Year.
- **Preethi Pal:** BBC Para Sportswoman of the Year.
- **Anjali Bhagwat**: BBC Lifetime Achievement Award.

Mumbai to host Earthshot Prize 2026 in November



- **Mumbai will** play host to the **Earthshot Prize 2026** , the world's leading environmental award founded by Britain's Prince William, Kensington Palace in London.
- The 2026 prize will shine a global spotlight on 15 groundbreaking environmental **solutions across five categories developed in collaboration with leading environmental experts:** Protect and Restore Nature; Clean our Air; Revive our Oceans; Build a Waste-Free World; and Fix our Climate.
- **Established in 2020 & 2021** was the first year when awards were handed out to finalists for their contributions towards
- Award - £1 million
- The Earthshot Prize **2025 Awards took place in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.**

Vasai Cathedral Wins UNESCO Award for Conservation



- The **475-year-old Our Lady of Grace Cathedral** in Vasai, Maharashtra, won the **2025 UNESCO Asia-Pacific Award** of **Merit for Cultural Heritage Conservation** for its community-led, traditional restoration.
- The 16th-century **Portuguese-era site**, built without cement, was revived using, mud-based techniques.
- The **2025 UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation recognized** ten outstanding projects, with the Award of Distinction–the highest honour awarded this year–going to the **Iwami Ginzan Library Conservation Project in Oda, Japan**, and **the Sihang Warehouse Conservation Project in Shanghai, China.**
- **Since 2000, UNESCO Asia-Pacific Awards for Cultural Heritage Conservation (#HeritageAwards)** have been recognizing the achievement of the private sector and public-private initiatives in successfully conserving or restoring structures, places and properties of heritage value in the region.
- **In 2020,** UNESCO introduced the Special Recognition for Sustainable Development .

Mangaluru International Airport wins ACI's award for the second consecutive time



- Mangaluru International Airport (MIA) is among six airports in the world chosen for Airport Service Quality (ASQ) Award – 2025 in the 'Best Airport at Arrivals' category by the Airports Council International (ACI) World.
- This marks the second consecutive year that Mangaluru International Airport has secured the global arrivals distinction,
- The airport is managed by Adani Airport Holdings Limited (AAHL).
- Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport (CSMIA) has been recognised as Asia-Pacific's Best Airport for Departures in the over 40-million passengers category at the 2025 Airport Service Quality (ASQ) Customer Experience Awards.
- The Airport Service Quality (ASQ) Awards are conducted by Airports Council International (ACI).

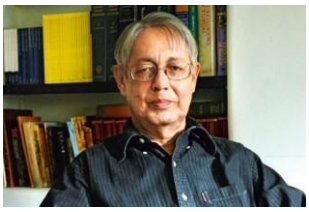
OBUITARIES

Travel Writer and Padma Shri Awardee Hugh Gantzer Passes Away at 95



- Renowned travel writer and Hugh Gantzer, a Padma Shri awardee, passed away
- Hugh Gantzer was born on 9 January 1931 in Patna, Bihar.
- In 2025, Hugh Gantzer was conferred the Padma Shri, in the field of Literature and Education

Sociologist André Béteille passes away at 91



- Mr. Béteille, a Professor Emeritus of Sociology in the University of Delhi, was known for his works on social inequality and caste in India.
- He was conferred the Padma Bhushan in 2005. He also served as the first chancellor of Ashoka University
- He has authored books such as a 'Caste, Class and Power', 'Society and Politics in India' and 'The Idea of Natural Inequality and Other Essays'.

Brazilian MMA Fighter Pablo Oliveira Costa Dies At 31



- Brazilian mixed martial artist Pablo Oliveira Costa has died at the age of 31
- Mixed Martial Arts (MMA) combines techniques from disciplines such as boxing, wrestling, Muay Thai and Jiu-Jitsu.

Noted Bengali author 'Shankar' dies at 93



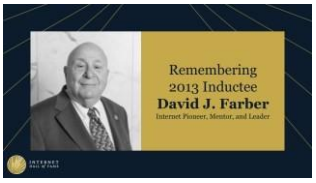
- Eminent Bengali author Mani Shankar Mukhopadhay, popularly known as 'Shankar', died
- **Famous novels :** 'Chowringee'

Mukul Roy dies at 71



- Former railway minister Mukul Roy died in Kolkata .
- In 2012, he briefly served as the Union railway minister in the UPA-II government, led by then prime minister Manmohan Singh.

Internet Pioneer David J. Farber Dies At 91



- David J. Farber, widely known as the "Grandfather of the Internet," passed away on February 7 in Tokyo at the age of 91.
- Many of his students later became pioneers of the Internet Protocol (IP).

Retired Army officer Gnanakan passes away

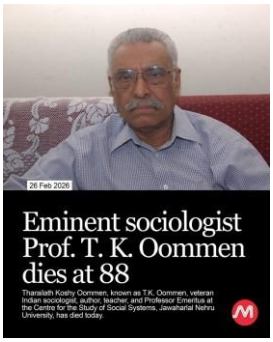


- Colonel A.M. Gnanakan, who retired after a distinguished career in the Indian Army, died in Belagavi , He was 87.
- He led his battalion with courage and conviction during the 1962, 1965 and 1971 wars.
- **He also served as Resident Director (North Karnataka and Kolhapur region) of the Bombay Diocesan Trust Association Pvt. Ltd.**

SHORT NEWS

- A veteran cricket umpire, Manik Gupta, lost his life after a bee attack during a cricket match at the Sapru Stadium in Uttar Pradesh's Unnao.

T.K. Oommen, a leading architect of modern Indian sociology, passes away



- Eminent sociologist and Professor Emeritus at the Jawaharlal Nehru University's (JNU) Centre for the Study of Social Systems, T.K. Oommen, who is regarded as a leading architect of modern Indian sociology, passed away .
- He was 88 .
- He had gained wide attention for his study of the Bhoodan Movement .

Veteran CPI leader R. Nallakannu passes away at age 101 in Chennai



- R. Nallakannu, the 101-year-old veteran Communist Party of India (CPI) leader and freedom fighter from Tamil Nadu, passed away
- Fondly known as 'Comrade RNK'.

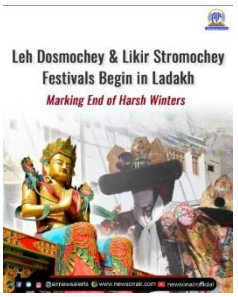
Book

Book	Author	Remark
Atal Bihari Vajpayee: The Eternal Statesman	Vijay Goel	
The Gallery Of Upside Down Women	Arundhathi Subramaniam	Honours bold women who challenged norms and forged their own paths.
The Sage who Reimagined Hinduism: The Life, Lessons and Legacy of Sree Narayana Guru	Dr. Shashi Tharoor	
The Doyen of Odisha Journalism	N. Jagannath Das	
Karnataka Bharat Gaurav Train: Journey of a Thousand Shrines		represents a flagship pilgrimage tourism initiative under Indian Railways' Bharat Gaurav Policy
Love Bites and Pugmarks in Kabini	Lakshmy Ramanathan	Set in Karnataka's Kabini forest; explores the turbulent relationship of wildlife filmmakers running a homestay
Refuge: Stories of War (and Love)	Sunny Singh	Collection of 13 short stories centered on war and human relationships
Life, Law and Literature – Reflections of a Judge	Justice N. Anand Venkatesh	
Four Stars of Destiny	Manoj Mukund Naravane	Memoir of former Army Chief Manoj Mukund Naravane

STATE SPECIFIC NEWS

Ladakh

Leh Dosmochey, Likir Monastery Stromochey being celebrated simultaneously



- In Ladakh, two major monastic festivals, **Leh Dosmochey and Likir Monastery Stromochey**, are being celebrated
- The festivals symbolise the victory of **good over evil**, with sacred **Buddhist tantric mask dances** performed by monks as the main highlight.
- The celebrations mark the conclusion of the harsh winter season in the region and signal the beginning of preparations for the upcoming agricultural season.
- this period as the transition towards renewed activity and hope.

Himachal Pradesh

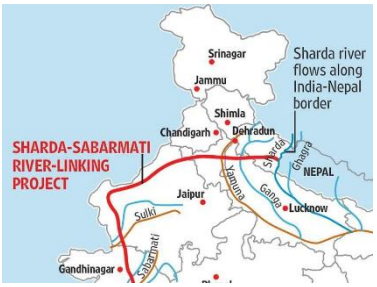
Shipki La Pass



- India is engaged with China to explore the opening of an additional route for the Kailash Mansarovar Yatra, including the possibility of using the Shipki La Pass in Himachal Pradesh, the government informed Parliament recently.
- It is a high mountain pass, bordering India and China in the tribal district of Kinnaur in Himachal Pradesh.
- It serves as the boundary post on the frontier between China and India.
- Situated at an altitude of 3,930 meters, it is one of the highest motorable passes.

Uttarakhand

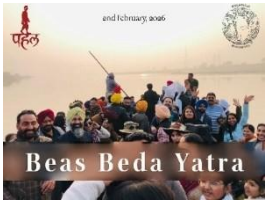
The Uttarakhand chief minister recently laid the foundation stone of the Sharda river corridor at Tanakpur in Champawat district



- It is a transboundary river of northern India and western Nepal.
- Course: It rises as the Kali River in far northern Uttarakhand in the Great Himalayas on the eastern slopes of the Nanda Devi massif.
- The river then flows generally south-southwest, where it constitutes the border between Uttarakhand and Nepal.
- Descending from the mountains, it enters the Indo-Gangetic Plain at Barmdeo Mandi (Nepal), widening there above the Sharda Barrage. Below that point it is known as the Sharda River.
- The Sharda then continues southeastward into India through northern Uttar Pradesh state before joining the Ghaghara River (a tributary of the Ganges) southwest of Bahraich, after a course of about 300 miles (480 km).
- Its major tributaries are the Dhauliganga, Goriganga, and Saryu.
- The Sharda Barrage (dam), near Banbasa (Uttarakhand), is the source of the Sharda Canal (completed 1930), one of the longest irrigation canals in northern India.

Punjab

World Wetlands Day: Fourth consecutive 'Beas Beda Yatra' held at Harike Wetland



- A traditional boat journey — 'Beda Beas Yatra' — on the waters of Beas river was held for the fourth consecutive year at Punjab's Harike Pattan Wetland, to mark the World Wetlands Day.
- aims to spread awareness on the pollution in Sutlej river,

- Harike Pattan Wetland — largest man-made wetland in Northern India, located on the borders of Ferozepur and Tarn Taran districts, witnesses the confluence of the state's two rivers, Beas and Sutlej.

Punjab's Folk and Sufi Traditions at Bharat Parv 2026



- The rich musical and spiritual heritage of Punjab will be presented at Bharat Parv 2026 at the historic Red Fort with captivating performances by the Punjabi Folk Orchestra and Qalandri Dhamal.
- It is a unique ensemble developed using a wide range of traditional Punjabi folk instruments such as Dhol, Dholki, Taal-Koze, Tansari, Flute, Nagara, Chimta, Sap, Kara, and Vanjli.
- It brings together rhythmic, melodic, and percussive folk instruments into a single, structured musical presentation.
- Performance: The orchestra is performed by a group of twelve students, each playing a specific instrumental role.

What is Qalandri Dhamal?

- It is a traditional Sufi folk dance of Sindh and Punjab.
- Qalandri Dhamal is a devotional dance expressing love and surrender to God and Sufi saints, most notably associated with the shrine of Lal Shahbaz Qalandar in Sehwan Sharif.

Punjab Launches 'Meri Rasoi' Scheme



- Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann announced the launch of the 'Meri Rasoi Yojna', **under which 40 lakh families will receive free quarterly food kits starting April, in addition to wheat provided under the National Food Security Act.**
- Each kit will contain two kilograms of lentils, two kilograms of sugar, one kilogram of salt, 200 grams of turmeric powder and one litre of mustard oil for monthly consumption.
- These food kits will be provided in addition to the wheat already being distributed to eligible beneficiaries under the National Food Security Act."
- "Markfed will be the nodal agency for providing these kits and they will be supplied free of cost by the Food and Civil Supplies department,"

NEWS IN SHORT



- ❑ Prime Minister Narendra Modi renamed the Adampur airport in Punjab's Jalandhar district as 'Sri Guru Ravidas Ji' Airport and virtually inaugurated the civil terminal building at Halwara Airport in Ludhiana.

Delhi

President Droupadi Murmu attends the opening of the Amrit Udyan Winter Annuals Edition 2026.



- President Droupadi Murmu attended the opening of the Amrit Udyan Winter Annual Edition 2026 in New Delhi.
- the Amrit Udyan of Rashtrapati Bhavan will remain open for public from 3rd of this month till 31st March.

Delhi Police Draws the Line with Operation Shastra Against Digital Fear



- Delhi Police launched Operation Shastra to target those individuals who were sharing pictures of themselves with weapons on online social media platforms and using abusive language.

Delhi Partners Bharat Taxi for Cooperative Mobility Services



- In a first for the country, the Delhi government signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with Bharat Taxi for cooperative cab services
- Delhi became the first state/UT in India to formally partner with Bharat Taxi's cooperative mobility platform
- Curated taxi-based services for tourists, including two-hour, four-hour and full-day sightseeing, covering major attractions in and around Delhi will be launched
- The MoU was inked between the Delhi Tourism and Transportation Development Corporation (DTTDC) and Sahkar Taxi Cooperative Limited (STCL), the cooperative arm of Bharat Taxi.

Delhi govt launches 'Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana' for Girl Children



- Chief Minister Rekha Gupta government will launch 'Delhi Lakhpati Bitiya Yojna' in April, upgrading and restructuring the Ladli Scheme of 2008.
- Under the new scheme, the government will provide financial assistance of up to Rs 56,000 per beneficiary, deposited in phased installments linked to education and age-related milestones, beginning from birth and continuing through graduation or diploma-level studies
- Under the 2008 scheme, each beneficiary received Rs 36,000 annually.
- the financial support will be given to two girls per family
- the eligibility conditions under the Delhi Lakhpati Bitiya Yojana have been slightly modified from the Ladli Scheme.
- Under the Ladli scheme, Rs 11,000 and Rs 10,000 were deposited when the girl child was born in hospitals and homes, respectively.
- A deposit of Rs 5,000 was added each time the child took admission in classes 1, 6 and 9 as well as when she cleared classes 10 and 12.

The new Delhi Lakhpati Bitiya Yojna

Aid	**Rs 56,000**
Eligibility	**Domicile or resident of Delhi for last three years**
Annual family income	**Rs 1.2 lakh**
Deposits	**Rs 11,000 within one year of birth**
	Rs 5,000 each on admission to classes I, 6, 8, 10 and 12; Rs 25,000 in all
	Rs 20,000 in phases after diploma or graduation
Cap	**2 girls per family**
Transfer of aid	**To be credited phase wise via Aadhar-linked DBT**
Maturity amount	**After Class 12 and 18 years of age, or completed graduation/diploma and 21 years of age**
Unclaimed amounts	**To be credited back to the government**
Aid under existing Delhi Ladli Scheme	**Rs 36,000**

Delhi Govt. Unveils Scheme to Empower Artisans with Global Market Access

- Delhi government has approved the Chief Minister Skill Development Scheme to support artisans linked with khadi, handloom, and cottage industries.
- The scheme aims to provide structured training, digital access, and financial support
- Each artisan will undergo 12 days of structured training, including a two-day Entrepreneurship Development Programme (EDP).
- Training will be conducted in small batches of 35-45 participants to ensure personalized guidance.
- Beneficiaries will receive a stipend of Rs 4,800 (Rs 400 per day) and Rs 100 per day for meals.
- applicants must be at least 18 years old.
- Only one member per family will be eligible, and government employees and their family members will not qualify.



PM Modi Inaugurates India's First Namo Bharat RRTS Launched On This Corridor

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated India's first Namo Bharat Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS) and dedicated the 82-km Delhi-Meerut (Uttar Pradesh)Namo Bharat Corridor
- In a first-of-its-kind initiative in India, both the Namo Bharat Rapid Rail and the Meerut Metro were launched from the same platform and will operate on shared tracks and stations.



Delhi L-G approves 20% quota in male constable posts for ex-Agniveers

- Lieutenant-Governor V.K. Saxena announced 20% reservation for retired Agniveers in recruitment to the post of male constables in Delhi Police, along with a three-year age relaxation and exemption from the physical efficiency test.
- **The Agnipath scheme, a pan-India, merit-based short-term recruitment scheme for soldiers, airmen and sailors, was launched in June 2022.**
- Under the scheme, candidates aged 17.5 to 21 years are given the opportunity to serve in the armed forces as Agniveers for four years, including the training period.
- After the completion of the four-year tenure, 25% of the recruits are retained for regular service, based on organisational requirements and existing policies.



Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan inaugurated the Pusa Krishi Vigyan Mela in New Delhi.



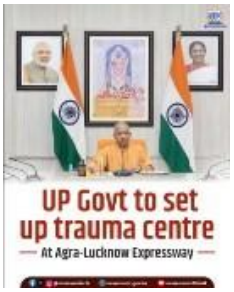
Short news

- Vice President CP Radhakrishnan inaugurated the Tourism Leadership Summit-2026, organised by the US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) in New Delhi.

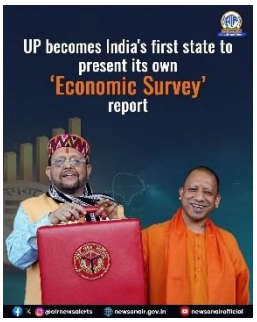
Uttar Pradesh

250-bed trauma centre to come up near Agra-Lucknow Expressway

- Chief minister Yogi Adityanath on said a 250-bed level-1 trauma centre would be set up near the Agra-Lucknow Expressway under the Uttar Pradesh University of Medical Sciences, Saifai (Etawah).
- The facility will ensure high-quality and timely medical care to victims of road accidents and other emergencies.
- Under this initiative, with the cooperation of the Ayush department, an integrative OPD, specialty clinics and yoga and wellness units will be set up.



Uttar Pradesh govt presents first-ever Economic Survey, lays out $1 trillion economy roadmap



- Uttar Pradesh (UP) became the first state in India to present its own Economic Survey report during the budget session of the state assembly.
- The survey estimates that Uttar Pradesh's Gross State Domestic Product has grown at a compound annual growth rate of 10.8 percent, rising from Rs 13.30 lakh crore in 2016-17 to Rs 30.25 lakh crore in 2024-25.
- The economy is projected to expand to Rs 36 lakh crore in 2025-26.
- A key pillar of the state's investment push is the "Triple S" framework of safety, stability and speed.
- The state also has the country's largest rail network
- Uttar Pradesh remains the country's largest foodgrain producer with output of 737.4 lakh metric tonnes in 2024-25.
- The One District One Product (ODOP) scheme has generated over 3.22 lakh jobs, while the state has been placed in the 'A-1' category in the national Startup Ecosystem Ranking

NGT Orders Restoration of Suav River Status



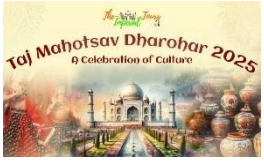
- The National Green Tribunal (NGT) has directed the Uttar Pradesh government to correct official records and restore the Suav, a major tributary of the Rapti river status from a "drain" to a "river" in the revenue records and gazetteer.
- Rapti River is the most important left bank tributary of the Ghaghra River.
- Historically, the Rapti River was known as Iravati.
- Origin: The Rapti River originates in Nepal near Rukumkot in the Mahabharat range of the lesser Himalayas.
- Topography: The entire basin's topography is made up of lofty mountains, inner and outer Tarai, and undulating plain regions.
- **It has two distinct climatic regions due to altitude differences:** the mountainous region has a temperate climate, while the plain region has a subtropical climate.
- Burhi Rapti and Rohini are the major left bank tributaries of Rapti.
- **After flowing through Nepal, it enters Eastern Uttar Pradesh.**

India's first 'cow culture' museum to open in U.P.'s Mathura



- On the initiative of the Uttar Pradesh Braj Teerth Vikas Parishad, the country's first national cow culture museum will be established on Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya Veterinary Science University campus in Mathura.
- The museum will convey the religious, cultural, and spiritual significance of cattle, as well as the scientific utility of cows and their products to the general public.
- The project recognises the cow as a "mother" in Indian culture

17 February to 27 February Taj Mahostsav



- The **10-day-long** Mahotsav, held every year **in Agra**.
- **Theme** : "Vande Mataram: Parampara evam Rashtra Gaurav"
- will allow tourists to get a glimpse of the diverse art, culture and crafts of the country.

Madhya Pradesh

Balaghat Chosen for Grain Storage Plan Pilot

- Balaghat district of Madhya Pradesh was selected as the pilot district under World's Largest Grain Storage Plan in Cooperative Sector (WLGSP).
- Under the pilot project one 500 MT godown was constructed at Bahudeshiya Prathamik Krishi Saakh Sahakari Society Maryadit Parswada in Balaghat District.
- The project has been fully completed and was inaugurated by the Hon'ble Prime Minister on 24 February 2024.
- The plan aims to empower PACS by establishing decentralized storage facilities, processing units, and custom hiring centres.

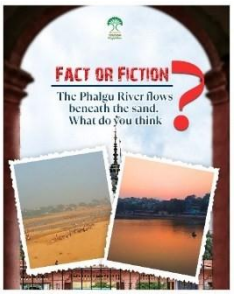
Madhya Pradesh to Extend Bhavantar Yojana to Mustard



- The Legislative Assembly that the Madhya Pradesh Government is planning to extend the Bhavantar Yojana to the mustard farmers.
- **The Bhavantar scheme, pays the farmers the difference if their crop is sold in the market at a price less than the government-declared minimum support price (MSP) or procurement price, currently benefits the soybean farmers in Madhya Pradesh.**
- Mustard is a key rabi crop

Bihar

Phalgu River



- The Phalgu River, also called Falgu, is an important river in Bihar. It is a sacred river for Hindus, Buddhists, and Jains.
- Phalgu river is formed by the confluence of the Lilajan and Mohana rivers near Gaya and eventually joins the Punpun River which is a tributary of the Ganga.
- Phalgu river is often referred to as the 'hidden Ganga' (Gupta Ganga) because it flows below a wide, sandy bed, appearing dry on the surface for most of the year.
- It is historically known as the Niranjana river where Buddha attained enlightenment.
- Sujata stupa lies across the Phalgu river.
- The stupa is dedicated to Sujata, a milkmaid, who offered milk and rice to Gautama Buddha after he had spent many years in deep meditation and severe ascetic practices.
- It is also a major site for Hindu pilgrimage, especially for Pind Daan (ancestral rituals), performed on the banks of the river near the Vishnupad Temple at Gaya.

Bihar Cabinet Approves Sonepur International Airport Project



- The Bihar state cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Nitish Kumar, has approved the construction of a new international airport at Sonepur in Saran district.
- The proposed airport will feature a 4,200-metre runway, making it capable of handling wide-body aircraft, including the Airbus A380.

Om Birla launches e-Vidhan app at Bihar Assembly;

- Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla unveiled the National e-Vidhan Application (NeVA) at the Bihar assembly, aimed at creating paperless legislative processes.
- NeVA aims to create paperless legislative processes by equipping members with digital access to information and building a national data depository for all legislatures.
- NeVA is a workflow system deployed on the NIC cloud to help conduct legislative business in a paperless manner.

Jharkhand

Serengsia Battle



- The Jharkhand government recently commemorated the Serengsia battle (1837) as a landmark Adivasi resistance against British rule, with the Chief Minister attending a state event.
- The Serengsia battle was a fierce armed resistance by Ho Adivasis against the East India Company in 1837, fought in the Serengsia valley of present-day Jharkhand (West Singhbhum).
- It represents one of the earliest organised tribal military challenges to British expansion in eastern India.
- The Kolhan region (East & West Singhbhum, Seraikela-Kharsawan) was traditionally governed by the Ho community.
- In 1820–21, the British brought Kolhan under the Bengal Presidency to secure trade routes between Bengal and Madras.
- Exploitation by zamindars and officials led to repeated unrest, including the Kol uprising of 1831.
- By 1836, British forces established the Kolhan Estate Government, capturing Ho villages and pirhs, intensifying resistance.

Rajkiya Itkhori Mahotsav Inaugurated in Chatra

- Jharkhand's Finance Minister Radhakrishna Kishore inaugurated the three-day Itkhori Mahotsav in Chatra district.
- Itkhori, acknowledged as a mini-temple town, is situated around 150km from state capital Ranchi.
- The mahotsav, initiated in 2015, was officially recognised as a state fair in 2016.

Odisha

The president, offered prayers at the Shree Jagannath Temple





- The president, who is on a six-day tour to Odisha and Chhattisgarh, offered prayers at the Shree Jagannath Temple in Puri recently.
- It is a Hindu temple located in Puri, Odisha.
- It is dedicated to Lord Jagannath, a form of the Hindu deity Vishnu.
- built during the reign of King Anantavarman Chodaganga Deva, of the Eastern Ganga dynasty, in the 12th century
- Ratha Yatra is a Hindu festival associated with Lord Jagannath temple.
- one of the four sacred pilgrimage sites, known as the Chaar Dhaams
- example of Kalinga architecture.

Black Swan Summit India 2026 Kicked off



- The Government of Odisha has launched the Black Swan Summit India 2026 in Bhubaneswar as part of the BharatNetra initiative.
- The summit is organised by the Odisha government in collaboration with the Global Finance & Technology Network (GFTN) under the BharatNetra initiative. Aimed at building digital finance infrastructure and workforce capabilities.
- Objective: Build a future-ready workforce in FinTech, InsurTech, and artificial intelligence (AI).

Odisha To Introduce QR Codes On Land Records



- The state government will introduce an upgraded version of the record of rights (RoR) embedded with a QR code and an electronic security chip
- The Smart RoR will allow instant verification of land ownership details. When the QR code is scanned, it will display the complete transaction history of the land parcel, including past sale and purchase records.
- The embedded electronic chip will act as a tamper-detection mechanism.
- Any unauthorised alteration or illegal intervention in the document will automatically trigger alerts to the revenue inspector (RI) and tehsildar concerned

Chhattisgarh

Akashvani Raipur to Host World Radio Day Conclave



- Akashvani Raipur in Chhattisgarh on February 13 hosted a Conclave to mark World Radio Day.
- The special event in Raipur was held in collaboration with UNESCO.
- Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai attended the event as the Chief Guest.

West Bengal

Mamata Banerjee becomes 1st CM to argue own case in SC



- first sitting chief minister to personally argue her own petition in the Supreme Court, urging the court to “protect democracy” and “people’s lives”,
- as she claimed that millions of voters risk being deleted from the electoral roll over minor spelling and dialect-based discrepancies during the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) in poll-bound West Bengal.

Banglar Yuva Sathi Scheme 2026 Announced



- The West Bengal government has announced that its new scheme, ‘Banglar Yuva Sathi’, will be launched from April 1.
- The ‘Banglar Yuva Sathi’ scheme to provide financial support to individuals aged 21-40 who have passed secondary school until they secure employment.
- Eligible beneficiaries will receive ₹1,500 per month directly in their bank accounts through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT).
- **The applicant must also be a resident of West Bengal to be eligible for the financial assistance.**
- However, those who are already receiving benefits under other state government welfare schemes, apart from the scholarships (Aikyasree, Medhasree, smart card schemes like ‘Sikhasree’ and Swami Vivekananda merit-cum-scholarship), would not be eligible for the ‘Banglar Yuva Sathi’ scheme.

Assam

Northeast’s First Emergency Landing Facility Inaugurated in Assam



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Northeast’s first Emergency Landing Facility (ELF) at Moran in Assam’s Dibrugarh district.
- The Prime Minister made a historic landing at the facility and witnessed a 40-minute aerial display by the Indian Air Force, showcasing fighter jets, transport aircraft and helicopters.

What is the Emergency Landing Facility?

- The Emergency Landing Facility is a specially designed highway airstrip constructed in coordination with the Indian Air Force.
- It enables the landing and take-off of military and select civil aircraft during emergencies.
- This is the first such facility in Northeast India, a region of high strategic importance due to its proximity to international borders.
- The ELF enhances rapid deployment capability and strengthens national security infrastructure in the region.

Key Features of the Moran ELF

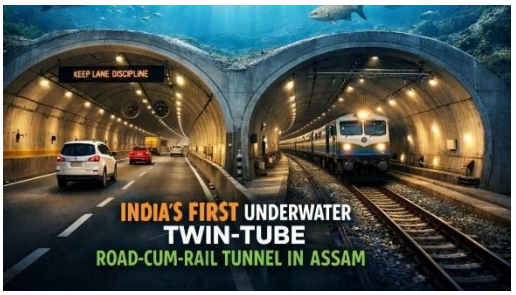
- The facility is 4.2 kilometres long and has been built at a cost of around ₹100 crore.
- It is capable of handling fighter aircraft weighing up to 40 tonnes and transport aircraft with a maximum take-off weight of 74 tonnes.
- Advanced surface engineering ensures durability and high load-bearing capacity.
- During the inauguration, Sukhoi Su-30MKI and Rafale fighter jets successfully operated from the strip, demonstrating its operational readiness.

PM Modi inaugurates ₹3,030 crore bridge on Brahmaputra



- PM inaugurated the Kumar Bhaskar Varma Setu, a 2.86-km-long, six-lane extradosed Prestressed Concrete (PSC) bridge built at a cost of approximately ₹3,030 crore, on the Brahmaputra River in Assam.
- PM Modi arrives on day-long visit to Assam
- The bridge connects Guwahati with North Guwahati and is the first extradosed bridge in Northeast India.
- Designed keeping in mind the region's high seismic activity, the structure incorporates base isolation technology using friction pendulum bearings.
- A Bridge Health Monitoring System (BHMS) has also been installed to enable real-time condition monitoring, early damage detection and enhanced safety throughout the bridge's service life.

Country's First Underwater Road-cum-Rail Tunnel under Brahmaputra River



- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) has approved India's first underwater road-cum-rail tunnel under the Brahmaputra River in Assam at a cost of ₹18,662 crore.
- A 33.7 km four-lane access-controlled Greenfield connectivity project, including a 15.79 km twin-tube underwater tunnel beneath the Brahmaputra River in Assam.
- It will connect Gohpur (NH-15) and Numaligarh (NH-715), reducing distance from 240 km to 34 km.

Key Features:

- Twin-Tube Underwater Tunnel: Two parallel tubes ensure traffic segregation, safety redundancy, and easier emergency evacuation.
- Road-cum-Rail Connectivity: Combines highway and railway infrastructure to enable seamless passenger and freight movement.

Brahmaputra River:

- The Brahmaputra River is one of the largest rivers of Central and South Asia and ranks among the world's top rivers in terms of average discharge.

Origin:

- Originates from the Chemayungdung Glacier near Lake Mapam in Tibet at ~5,300 m elevation.
- Known as Yarlung Tsangpo in Tibet, Siang/Dihang in Arunachal Pradesh, and Jamuna in Bangladesh.
- Nations it flows through: China (Tibet Autonomous Region), India, and Bangladesh.

Indian States it flows through:

- Arunachal Pradesh

- Assam
- (Drainage basin also covers Nagaland, Meghalaya, West Bengal, and Sikkim)

Rajasthan

Alwar District of Rajasthan Became India's First Fully Insured District

- Alwar district has become the first in the country to attain 100% insurance coverage under the Centre's 'Insurance for All by 2047' roadmap
- The 'Insurance for All by 2047' roadmap is a joint initiative of the Government of India and the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India under the Ministry of Finance.

Jaisalmer to Host First Jain Chadar Mahotsav



- Rajasthan's desert city of Jaisalmer will host the country's first Jain Chadar Mahotsav from 6 to 8 March 2026.
- The three-day religious event will centre on the worship of the 872-year-old garments of Dada Shri Jindatt Suri Maharaj, preserved in the Gyan Bhandar library of the Jain temple in Jaisalmer.
- According to the Jaisalmer Jain Trust, the garments date back to Vikram Samvat 1211, when the first Dada Gurudev attained samadhi in Ajmer

Rajasthan Launches Homestay Scheme 2026



- The Tourism Department of Rajasthan has launched the Rajasthan Homestay (Paying Guest House) Scheme – 2026 to promote tourism, rural income generation, and self-employment.
- Under the Homestay Scheme 2026, families can register their homes through a simplified process and legally host domestic and international tourists.

Gujarat

PM to inaugurate India's first semiconductor fabrication plant worth over Rs. 20,000 crore in Gujarat

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate an ATMP (Assembly, Testing, Marking and Packaging) plant of Micron Technology, Inc in Sanand, Gujarat
- The project, backed by an investment of Rs 22,516 crore
- Micron Chairman and CEO Sanjay Mehrotra
- The new facility of Micron — one of the world's largest semiconductor companies — will enable assembly and test manufacturing for both
- DRAM (dynamic random access memory) and
- NAND(a type of flash memory technology used in storage devices) products aiming to address demand from domestic and international markets.

Gujarat CM lays foundation stone for first phase of Shakti Corridor



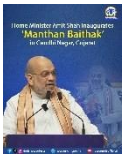
- Gujarat Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel laid the foundation stone for development works worth ₹950 crore under the first phase of the Shakti Corridor at Adyashakti Dham Ambaji, a project planned at a total cost of ₹1,632 crore.
- The Shakti Corridor will connect the Shri Arasuri Ambaji Mata temple , Gabbar and Mansarovar.
- Shri Arasuri Ambaji Mata temple in the town is one of the 51 'shaktipeeths' across the country.

HM Amit Shah launches country's first, Central Bank's digital currency to bring transparency in delivery mechanism



- Launched the country's first Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC)-based Public Distribution System at Mahatma Mandir in Gandhinagar, Gujarat,
- With the launch, Gujarat has become the first state in the country to transfer PDS subsidies using the Reserve Bank of India-authorised Central Bank Digital Currency.
- The new digital token-based distribution system would eliminate corruption within the Public Distribution System and bring much-needed transparency to the delivery process.
- The system will provide beneficiaries with digital wallet tokens containing item name, quantity, and price details.
- also virtually inaugurated the 'Annapurti' Grain ATM in Ahmedabad, which can dispense up to 25 kilograms of grain in just 35 seconds.
- The Home Minister further launched the 'Suposhit Garudeshwar' mission to combat malnutrition in the Narmada district.

Union Home and Cooperation Minister Amit Shah inaugurates the high-level national conclave "Manthan baithak " of State and Union Territory Cooperation Ministers in Gandhi Nagar, Gujarat.



MAHARASHTRA

IMMA to Host 6th National Crop Nutrition Summit 2026



- The Indian agri-input sector will be in focus as the Indian Micro-Fertilizers Manufacturers Association (IMMA) hosts its 6th National Crop Nutrition Summit & B2B Expo on 5–6 February 2026 at the National Stock Exchange, Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai.
- the theme "Converge, Collaborate & Co-create,"

India's First Bharat Ratna Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar Advocate Training and Research Centre Inaugurated in Navi Mumbai



- Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis and former Chief Justice of India Justice Bhushan R. Gavai inaugurated India's first 'Bharat Ratna Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar Advocate Training and Research Centre' (BBATRC) at Taloja in Navi Mumbai.
- The Centre has been established by the Maharashtra and Goa Bar Council.
- It aims to strengthen the legal profession by bridging the gap between legal education and courtroom practice.

Mumbai's Coastal Road to get country's first 'Melody Road'

- In a first-of-its-kind initiative in the country, the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC) has installed a special music technology along Mumbai's Coastal Road, where motorists will hear the song "Jai Ho" upon crossing a speed of 60 kmph.
- The 'Melody Road' is slated to be inaugurated by Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis
- The musical stretch spans 500 metres .
- The technology has previously been implemented in countries such as Hungary, Japan, South Korea and the United Arab Emirates.
- The concept of a musical road was first devised in 2007 in Japan

7th edition of Asia Economic Dialogue 2026 to be held in Pune



- The 7th edition of Asia Economic Dialogue jointly organised by Ministry of External Affairs and Pune International Centre will be held here from February 26 to 28.
- Theme 'Geoeconomics Beyond Globalisation: Tariffs, Technologies and Strategic Alignments',
- AED 2026 will coincide with a Craft Expo and PIC's art and culture programme 'Palash' to be held from February 27 to March 1

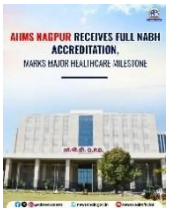
Operation Demolishment

- Security forces have demolished over 200 Naxal-linked memorials and monuments in Maharashtra and Chhattisgarh under Operation Demolishment.
- Operation Demolishment is a counter-insurgency initiative focused on dismantling memorials and monuments allegedly built by Naxal groups to glorify their leaders and spread extremist ideology.
- Launched by: Conducted by Indian security forces in coordination with state police and counter-insurgency agencies.
- Implemented mainly in Naxal-affected states like Chhattisgarh and Maharashtra as part of intensified anti-LWE operations.

Beat the Heat Programme

- Maharashtra has announced that 30 cities have joined the global “Beat the Heat” programme during Mumbai Climate Week 2026.
- Mumbai Climate Week (MCW) 2026 is India's first dedicated metropolitan-scale climate action platform, held from 17–19 February 2026.
- Beat the Heat is a global climate initiative aimed at accelerating action against extreme heat through sustainable cooling and urban resilience strategies.
- It translates the Global Cooling Pledge into practical, city-level implementation.
- Launched In: Announced under the COP30 Presidency (Brazil).
- Supported by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) through the Cool Coalition.

AIIMS Nagpur becomes first public hospital in Maharashtra to secure complete NABH accreditation



- AIIMS Nagpur has achieved a major milestone by receiving full accreditation from the National Accreditation Board for Hospitals & Healthcare Providers (NABH) under the Quality Council of India.
- With this recognition, AIIMS Nagpur has become the first public hospital in Maharashtra to secure complete NABH accreditation.

Short news

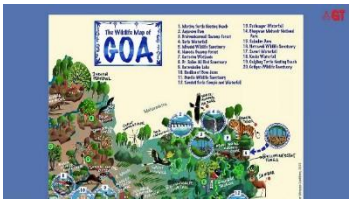
- Soundala village in Maharashtra has become the state’s first village to declare itself “caste-free.”

National Arogya Fair 2026 to Be Held in Shegaon, Maharashtra



- The Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, in collaboration with the All India Ayurvedic Congress, will organise the four-day National Arogya Fair 2026 at Shegaon, District Buldhana, Maharashtra, from 25 to 28 February 2026.
- The President of India, Smt. Droupadi Murmu, will inaugurate the Fair on 25 February 2026 .
- The initiative aims to encourage diversification towards medicinal crops as a sustainable income avenue, while strengthening the supply chain for quality raw materials required by the Ayush sector.

Goa



Goa Unveils First Biodiversity and Cultural Map

- Goa is set to receive its first biodiversity and cultural features map, developed by WWF India,
- offering a child-friendly visual guide to 48 commonly found species and traditional art forms of the state. The map will be released at the Goa Art and Literature Festival
- Kaavi art is a traditional Goan mural art form using red laterite pigment.

Goa Hosts World Ocean Science Congress 2026



- Goa is currently hosting the fourth edition of the World Ocean Science Congress (WOSC) 2026, held from February 23 to 26, 2026.
- This biennial international conclave, themed "Ocean Health and Sustainable Future".
- Taking place at the CSIR-National Institute of Oceanography (NIO) in Dona Paula.
- The National Institute of Oceanography is headquartered in Goa.

News in short

- Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant will inaugurate the Goa Book Festival at the Campal Ground in Panaji.

Arunachal Pradesh

20 February - Arunachal Pradesh Foundation Day



- Arunachal Pradesh **attained full statehood (**formed out of Assam) on **20th February 1987 .**
- **Historical Background:** During the British Colonial Rule, **until 1972**, the state was **named as the North-East Frontier Agency (NEFA).**
- On 20th January, 1972, it became a Union Territory and was named Arunachal Pradesh.
- It was **granted statehood by the State of Arunachal Pradesh Act, 1986.**
- Becoming the **24th state** of the Indian Union **through the 55th constitutional amendment** in alignment with the national policy of granting tribal regions distinct state identities.
- In the west, **Arunachal Pradesh is bordered by Bhutan** and in the north falls the **Tibetan region of China.**
- In the Southeastern region falls **Nagaland and Myanmar** and to the southwestern region falls **Assam.**
- **Capital of Arunachal Pradesh is Itanagar.**
- **State Animal:** Mithun (also known as Gayal)
- **State Bird: Hornbill**
- It is also home to the **Dihang Dibang Biosphere Reserve.**

Protected Areas:



- **Namdapha National Park**
- Mouling National Park
- Sessa Orchid Sanctuary
- Dibang Wildlife Sanctuary
- **Pakke Tiger Reserve**
- **Tribals of Arunachal:** The significant tribal groups include **Monpas, Nyishis, Apatanis, Noctes and Sherdukpens.**

Arunachal's deputy CM Chowna Mein joins Mishmi community in celebrating 56th Tamla Du Festival at Medo in Lohit district

- Tamla Du Festival of the Tawran (Digaru) and Kaman (Miju) Mishmi community of Arunachal Pradesh is being celebrated
- During this festival, the Mishmi people offer prayers to the Almighty Lord Jabmalo and to the forces of nature, seeking good health, abundance in newly sown crops and protection from natural calamities.

Telangana

Second Telangana Seed Festival from February 6 to 8



- The three-day annual festival aims to revive farmer-owned traditional seed systems and strengthen agricultural sovereignty.
- organised by the Council for Green Revolution (CGR) with the support of Bharat Beej Swaraj Manch

Telangana CM A. Revanth Reddy to Inaugurate BioAsia 2026 International Summit in Hyderabad



- Telangana Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy will inaugurate the 23rd edition of BioAsia 2026 international summit , will be held at the Hyderabad International Convention Centre (HICC) - 17TH – 18TH Feb .
- This year's summit is themed 'TechBio Unleashed – AI, Automation, and the Revolutionary Changes in Life Sciences.'

Telangana Police Launch Operation Crackdown on Cybercrime



- The Telangana Police has launched "Operation Crackdown", a statewide drive aimed at dismantling organised cybercrime networks and curbing financial fraud.
- The initiative is being spearheaded by the Telangana Cyber Security Bureau (TGCSB) in coordination with district police units and commissionerates.

Andhra Pradesh

CISF's Vande Mataram Coastal Cyclothon 2026 marks national song's 150th year in Andhra Pradesh



- The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) on January 28 launched the CISF Vande Mataram Coastal Cyclothon–2026, a nationwide public outreach and awareness initiative aimed at strengthening coastal security through community participation.
- The initiative aligns with the Prime Minister's SAGAR vision, anchored in the theme 'सुरक्षित तट, समृद्ध भारत' (Secure Coast, Prosperous India) and Operation Sajag

Kondaveedu Fort



- The Union minister of state recently announced plans for the comprehensive development of the historic Kondaveedu Fort.
- Kondaveedu Fort, also known as Kondavid Fort, is a historical fortification located at Kondaveedu village in the Guntur district of Andhra Pradesh.
- It was constructed during the time of the Telugu Chodas, strengthened by the Kakatiyas and occupied by Prolaya Vema Reddy, who shifted his capital from Addanki to Kondaveedu in 1323 AD
- Later it was taken over by the Gajpathis of Orissa and ravaged by the Bahmani Sultans in 1458.

- The fort later came under the control of the Vijayanagara Empire, the Golconda Sultanate, the Mughals, the French, and the British.
- The architecture displays a blend of Hindu and Islamic styles.
- It was mainly constructed with granite stones and lime mortar.

Karnataka

'Operation Suraksha' to curb night-time crime in Bengaluru

- The Bengaluru City Police have launched a special city-wide drive titled 'Operation Suraksha' to curb illegal activities and anti-social behaviour at night.
- anti-social elements often gather in public places at night and indulge in unlawful activities, including the consumption and sale of narcotic substances.

Sakhi auto service 'by women, for women' launched in Bengaluru



- An auto service designed exclusively for women drivers and passengers started operations in Bengaluru
- The platform, called Sakhi, follows a ride-hailing model.

Nagaland

North East Spring Festival 2026 Begins in Dimapur



- In Nagaland, the three-day North East Spring Festival 2026, also known as the Festival of the North East, will begin in Dimapur, Nagaland.
- The festival is being organised by the North East Zone Cultural Centre (NEZCC), Dimapur, in collaboration with the South-Central Zone Cultural Centre (SCZCC), Nagpur, under the aegis of the Ministry of Culture, Government of India.
- The festival will be celebrated alongside Madhya Dakshini Festival 2026, creating a vibrant cultural confluence between the Northeastern and South-Central regions of the country.

Tripura

State Innovation Mission

- Recently, the Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) under NITI Aayog launched the country's first State Innovation Mission (SIM) in Tripura.

About State Innovation Mission

- It is part of the approved Atal Innovation Mission (AIM 2.0) programme, under the aegis of NITI Aayog's State Support Mission (SSM).
- It is designed as a long-term institutional mechanism to support States and Union Territories in building robust, inclusive, and context-specific innovation ecosystems aligned with national priorities and local strengths.
- The Mission emphasises inclusion, regional balance, and capacity building across the entire innovation lifecycle — from school education to advanced entrepreneurship.

What is Atal Innovation Mission?

- It is a flagship initiative set up by the NITI Aayog in 2016.
- Objective: To create and encourage an environment of innovation and entrepreneurship across schools, educational organisations, research institutes, and industries, including MSMEs

Tamil Nadu

Thai Poosam festival: Devotees get a glimpse of 'Jyothi Darshan' at Vadalur



- Thaipusam, also known as Thai Poosam, is a Hindu festival celebrated **to honour Lord Murugan (also known as Lord Kartikeya), the Hindu god of war, victory**, and wisdom, while also being a symbol of courage, determination, and spiritual growth.
- **The festival is widely celebrated by the Tamil community in Tamil Nadu India and across the world, especially in Sri Lanka, Singapore, Malaysia, and more.**
- The name "Thaipusam" is a combination of "Thai" (the Tamil month) and "Poosam," the star at its highest point during the festival.

World Seafood Congress 2026



- Chennai hosts the World Seafood Congress (WSC) 2026, **biennial forum**
- jointly organised by the International Association of Fish Inspectors (IAFI), an UN-recognised NGO, PDA Ventures and the National Fisheries Development Board, Hyderabad.
- It is co-organised by the Department of Fisheries, with the support of the Ministry of Food Processing Industries, the Ministry of Earth Sciences, and NITI Aayog.
- The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR), New Delhi, is the technical partner for the event.

Supreme Court Orders Tribunal on Pennaiyar Water Dispute



- The Supreme Court has directed the Union government to constitute a tribunal to adjudicate the long-pending inter-state water dispute between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka over the Pennaiyar River.
- a major river in southern India flowing through Tamil Nadu and Karnataka.
- It is also known as the South Pennar River, Dakshina Pinakini in Kannada, and Thenpennai, Ponnaiyar, or Pennaiyar in Tamil.
- It originates in the Nandi Hills in the Chikkaballapura district of Karnataka.
- enter the Bay of Bengal at Cuddalore.
- It is the second longest river in Tamil Nadu, stretching 497 km in length.
- It is also the second largest interstate east-flowing river basin, situated between the Pennar and Cauvery basins.
- Major tributaries are the Chinnar, Markanda, Vaniar, and Pamban.
- Article 262: Provides for the adjudication of inter-state water disputes
- Parliament by law can provide for the adjudication of any inter-state water dispute (Article 262(1))
- Parliament may also provide that neither Supreme Court nor any other court is to exercise jurisdiction in respect of any such dispute or complaint (Article 262(2))

V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority has become the first port in India to implement Anti-Drone System



- V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority has become the first port in India to initiate the implementation of an advanced Anti-Drone System,
- The project involves the deployment of a comprehensive integrated Radio Frequency(RF) and radar-based drone detection and jamming system, specifically tailored for complex port environments, providing 360-degree coverage and Omnidirectional bearing.
- The drone detector, drone detection radar, and man-pack jammer together form a comprehensive security system providing omnidirectional coverage with an effective range of up to 5 km.

V.O.C. Port bags 'Platinum Rating' for sustainable, eco-friendly buildings, energy efficiency certification

- **V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority** , Tamil Nadu. has become **India's first Major Port to receive the prestigious IGBC Platinum Rating**, the highest certification awarded by the Indian Green Building Council.
- In addition, V.O. Chidambaranar Port has also been awarded with **Shunya and Shunya Plus certifications** by the **Bureau of Energy Efficiency (BEE)** under the **Ministry of Power,** Government of India.
- The **Shunya Certification system** is based on the principle that a building's total annual energy demand is fully met through on-site or off-site renewable energy sources.
- **A Shunya building is** a Net Zero Energy Building, - produces as much green energy as it consumes annually.
- **A Shunya Plus building** is a Net Positive Energy Building that generates more on-site renewable energy than it consumes.

'Police Akka' initiative launched in Ariyalur, Tamil Nadu

- The exercise has been rolled out **under the 'Police Akka' initiative**
- Under the initiative, a **team of eight women** constables have been nominated as 'Police Akka' and they **would visit colleges** in their respective jurisdiction periodically.
- **reached out to female students** of various colleges in the district to ascertain their concerns regarding **safety and security and instil confidence in them.**

APEDA facilitated the first direct export consignment of GI-tagged Salem Sago from Tamil Nadu to Canada



- Salem Sago (Javvarisi) is a starch-based food product made from tapioca roots (cassava), where wet starch is processed into small pearl-like granules.
- **It is widely consumed as a staple and is also used in multiple industries such as food processing, textiles, pharmaceuticals and construction.**
- Originates from Salem district, Tamil Nadu, known as the "Land of Sago"
- Over 80% of India's sago production comes from the Salem region and nearby belts like Erode, Namakkal and Dharmapuri.
- **Geographical Indication (GI) tag granted in March 2023**.
- GI registration obtained by The Salem Starch and Sago Manufacturers' Service Industrial Co-operative Society Ltd (SAGOSERVE) under the Government of Tamil Nadu.
- **Tapioca-based product**: Produced from starch extracted from tapioca roots containing about 30–35% starch.
- **Multi-sector usage:** Used in food, paper, textile, cosmetic, pharmaceutical, construction and alcohol industries.

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Kerala

Kochi airport to become India's first airport to operate hydrogen-powered buses



- The Cochin international airport in Kerala is set to become the first Indian airport to operate hydrogen-powered buses for passenger transportation, following the exchange of a memorandum of agreement (MoA) between the Kerala Hydrogen Valley Innovation Cluster Foundation and Cochin International Airport Limited (CIAL)
- procurement and operation of three hydrogen fuel cell electric buses at the Kochi airport as part of the Kerala Hydrogen Valley initiative under the National Green Hydrogen Mission

After Kerala, This Coastal State Takes Flight with India's Second Comprehensive Bird Atlas

- The Bird Atlas of Goa was released at the ninth Bird Festival of Goa on,making Goa the second state in India, after

- Kerala, to publish a comprehensive state- level bird atlas.
- The programme also witnessed the release of "Birds of Goa: Konkani Nomenclature .

The Union Cabinet approved the renaming of the State of “Kerala” to “Keralam”

- After approval of Union Cabinet, the president of India will refer a Bill, namely the Kerala (Alteration of Name) Bill, 2026 to the State Legislative Assembly of Kerala for expressing its views under proviso to Article 3 of the Constitution of India.
- The Article 3 of the Constitution provides for alteration of names of existing States.



Procedure for Renaming of States

- It can be initiated by the Parliament or State Legislature.
- Renaming is governed by Article 3 of Constitution.
  - Article empowers Parliament to alter name of any State by law.
- Bill may be introduced in Parliament on recommendation of President.
  - Then referred by the President to Legislature of that State for expressing their views.
- Bill is passed in each house by a simple majority.

Following president's assent, change in name of state is

The Kerala government declared tidal flooding as a state specific disaster



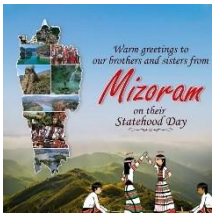
- Tidal flooding, also known as sunny day flooding, king tide flooding, and nuisance flooding, is the temporary flooding of low-lying areas near a coast.
- Causes: It usually occurs through the combination of winds, offshore storms, and full moon cycles during high tide events such as full moons and new moons.
- Unlike cyclone-induced storm surges, tidal flooding happens twice in a day and is more severe during full or new moons.
- Impact on Kerala Coast: It is a common phenomenon along Kerala’s coastline, where the Arabian Sea level temporarily rises above an identified threshold for a brief period, inundating low-lying coastal areas.

SHORT NEWS

- The Kerala State Cabinet has approved the Kerala Nativity Card Bill, empowering the government to issue Nativity Cards as an authoritative identity document for availing State services and fulfilling social requirements.

Mizoram

20 February- Mizoram Foundation Day



- The **Mizo Hills area became** the **Lushai Hills** district within **Assam** at **"** under the **Sixth Schedule** of the Constitution **(Article 244(2)).** the time of **independence**. Further, in **1954** it was renamed the **Mizo Hills District of Assam.**
- Mizoram was granted the status of a **Union Territory in 1972** after signing an accord with the moderates of the Mizo National Front (MNF).
- The formalization of Mizoram State took place on **20th February 1987** after the **53rd Amendment** of the Indian Constitution, 1986.
- Mizoram has been designated as a **"tribal area**
- **International Border:** Myanmar and Bangladesh
- **State Border:** Tripura (northwest), Assam (north) and Manipur (northeast).



Protected Areas:

- **Dampa Tiger Reserve**
- Murlen National Park
- Phawngpui National Park
- Ngengpui Wildlife Sanctuary





- Tawi Wildlife Sanctuary
- **State Animal:** Saza (serow)
- **State Bird:** Vavu (Hume Bartailed Pheasant).
- **Tribals:** It has the **highest concentration (percentage) of tribal population** among all states of India.
- The 5 major tribes include: **Lushei, Ralte, Hmar, Paihte and Pawi.**

Manipur

Zomi National Day Marks 78th Celebration in Manipur

- Zomi National Day commemorates the identity and unity of the Zomi community.
- Churachandpur is a key district with significant Zomi population in Manipur.
- The Zomi are part of the larger Zo ethnic group, which includes Mizo, Kuki, and Chin communities.

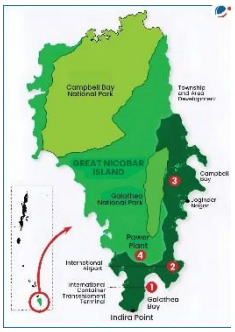
Andaman and Nicobar Islands

NGT clears Great Nicobar Island mega-infrastructure project, cites 'strategic importance'

- News : A six-member special bench of the National Green Tribunal (NGT) disposed of challenges to the Great Nicobar mega infrastructure project and concluded that it found "no good ground to interfere," as there were "adequate safeguards" in the project's environmental clearance (EC).

Significance of the Project

- Strategic location: Great Nicobar Island's geostrategic position makes it critically important for India's security and maritime influence.
- It is located at the mouth of the Malacca Strait, one of the world's busiest shipping lanes, accounting for passage of one-third of global sea trade.
- It is also close to Sunda Strait, Lombok Strait, and the Coco Islands, all of which are important choke-points in the Indo-Pacific region
- It is a massive Greenfield infrastructure project conceived by NITI Aayog and approved by the Union Cabinet in 2021.



Project Components:

- **International Transshipment Port – Galathea Bay**: A deep-sea port to be developed at Galathea Bay on the island's southern coast.
  - Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways (MoPSW) will oversee transhipment port project.
- **A Greenfield international airport**
- **A 450 MW power plant**
- **A modern townshipv**

Jammu & Kashmir

J&K: 'Banwat Ekta Sthal' inaugurated near LoC in Poonch district

- In Jammu and Kashmir, the Army's Northern Commander, Lieutenant General Pratik Sharma, inaugurated the 'Banwat Ekta Sthal' – a public monument symbolising national pride and sovereignty – near the Line of Control (LoC) in Poonch district.
- The project was completed in a record 45 days and features a towering 105 feet National Flag, the tallest in the Poonch district.
- The facility includes an 'Ekta Mandap' to promote peace



Baglihar Hydropower Project

- Operations were suspended at the 450 MW stage 1 **Baglihar hydropower project** on the Chenab river in Jammu and Kashmir after it got flooded recently.
- It is a **900 MW run-of-the-river power project** on the **Chenab River** in the Ramban district of **Jammu and Kashmir.**

- The project construction commenced in 1999 and subsequently entered into commercial operation in 2008.

Key Facts about Chenab River

- It is the largest of the five tributaries of the Indus River.
- **Origin:** It is formed by the confluence of two streams, Chandra and Bhaga, in the Lahaul and Spiti Districts of Himachal Pradesh.
- In its upper reaches, it is also **known as the Chandrabhaga**.
- It flows through the **Jammu and Kashmir union territory, Himachal Pradesh**, and after receiving the **Jhelum River near Trimmu**, the Chenab empties into the Sutlej River.
- The **Chenab valley** is a structural trough formed by the great **Himalayan and Pir Panjal ranges**.
- **Major Tributaries:** Left Bank: Niru, Tawi, Neeru, and Liddrari.
- **Right Bank:** Ans, Bhut Nalla, Bichleri, Kalnai Marusudar, and Miyar Nalla.
- **Major Dams on Chenab River**: Salal (rockfill dam), Aalal (concrete dam), Baglihar, and Dul

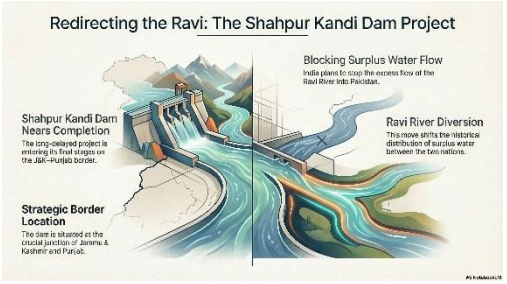
Tulbul Navigation Barrage Project

- The Jammu & Kashmir government is mulling to take advantage of the suspended Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) by diverting, for the first time, **water from the Ravi river** in Punjab to the Jammu region, and pushing for the revival of the Tulbul Navigation Barrage project.
- **The Tulbul Navigation Barrage Project, also known as the Wullar Barrage,** is a navigation lock-cum-control structure located at the outlet of Wullar Lake, in J&K.
- It **was designed to facilitate navigation on the Jhelum River during lean winter months (Oct-Feb).**
- The work on the project had started in 1984 but had to be stopped due to objections by Pakistan under IWT.

Wular Lake

- It is the largest freshwater lake in India and the second largest freshwater lake in Asia.
- It is located in the Bandipore district of Jammu and Kashmir.
- **It is fed by the Jhelum River**.
- In 1990, it was designated as a Wetland of International Importance under the Ramsar Convention.

Shahpur Kandi Dam Project



- India plans to block the surplus water flow from the Ravi River to Pakistan as the delayed Shahpur Kandi dam on the J&K–Punjab border heads for completion.
- It is located on the Ravi River in Pathankot district, Punjab, downstream from the existing Ranjit Sagar Dam.
- **Declared a national project in 2008, the dam is being built at a cost of Rs 3,394.49 crore**, with Punjab contributing 80 percent and the Centre funding the remaining 20 percent.
- It features a 55.5 m high concrete gravity dam with 206 MW power output and a 7.7 km hydel channel.
- The dam will help save any excess Ravi water that used to flow to Pakistan during the rainy season, utilising it for the benefit of the Indian farmers

NATIONAL FESTIVALS

17 Feb - 19 March Ramadan 2026



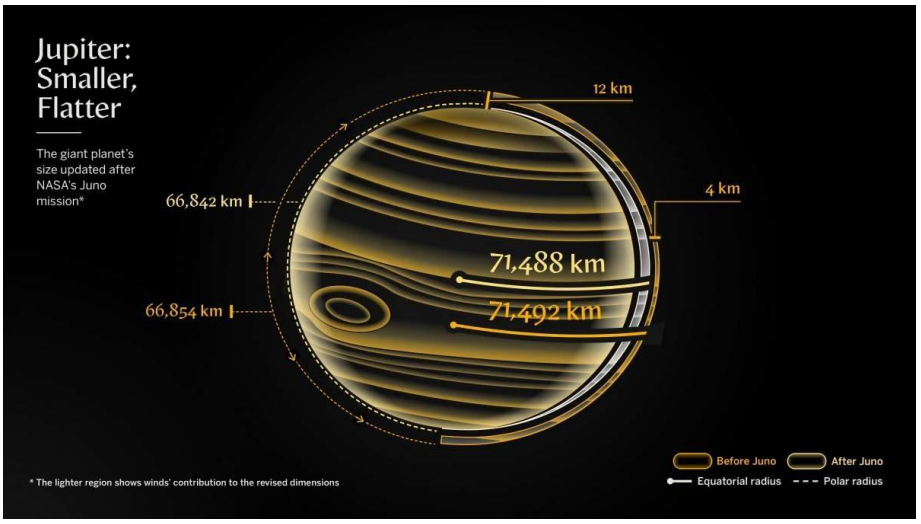
- Ramadan, also referred to as Ramzan, Ramzaan, or Ramazan, **is the ninth month of the Islamic lunar calendar (Hijri).**
- It begins with the **sighting of the crescent moon** and marks the start of a period of fasting, prayer,

- Muslims believe that the Quran, the holy book of Islam, was **first revealed to Prophet Muhammad during Ramadan.**
- The end of Ramadan is marked by Eid al-Fitr, a major festival in the Islamic calendar.

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

NASA Revises Jupiter Size Using Juno Mission Data

- Jupiter, the largest planet in the solar system, is slightly smaller and more flattened than scientists previously believed, according to new findings based on data from NASA's Juno spacecraft.
- NASA's Juno mission, scientists calculated Jupiter's equatorial diameter at 88,841 miles (142,976 km).
- This is about 5 miles smaller than estimates made using Voyager and Pioneer spacecraft data in the late 1970s.
- The planet's polar diameter was measured at 83,067 miles (133,684 km), roughly 15 miles smaller than earlier calculations.
- Jupiter is the fifth planet from the Sun and the largest in the solar system.
- Jupiter is primarily composed of hydrogen and helium.
- Its rapid rotation causes significant equatorial bulging.
- Juno was launched by an Atlas V rocket from Cape Canaveral, Florida, on August 5, 2011
- arrived at Jupiter in 2016.



Perseverance Completes First AI-Planned Drive on Mars



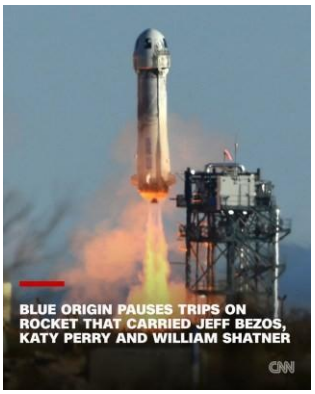
- NASA has achieved a landmark in space exploration as its Perseverance rover successfully completed the first autonomous, artificial intelligence–planned drives on another planet.
- drives planned entirely by AI software developed at NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory.
- Perseverance is NASA's Mars rover exploring Jezero Crater.
- Perseverance Rover - The mission is designed to better understand the geology of Mars and seek signs of ancient life.
- Launch: It was launched on July 30, 2020, from Cape Canaveral, Florida.

ISRO identifies site for Chandrayaan-4 lander

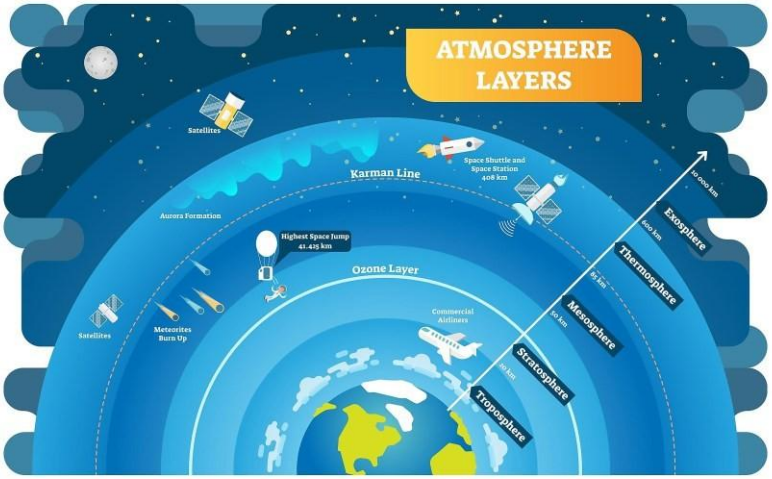
- Scientists from ISRO's Space Applications Centre (SAC) have identified a landing zone in the rugged south polar region of the Moon called Mons Mouton for India's first lunar sample return mission, Chandrayaan-4.
- Mons Mouton is a mountain about 6,000 meters high located near the South Pole of the Moon.
- Its peak is largely flat, which is favorable for landing.
- It is situated in the **South Circumpolar Region (SCR) of the Moon.**

- It is officially named Mons Mouton after **NASA mathematician and computer programmer Melba Roy Mouton.**

What is suborbital tourism?



- News: On January 31, Blue Origin, the private space company owned by Jeff Bezos, announced that it was suspending its New Shepard suborbital space tourism programme for at least two years to focus on its "lunar capabilities"
- Suborbital tourism is a form of space travel where paying passengers fly to the edge of space but don't complete a full orbit around the earth.
- These flights typically reach an altitude of around 100 km — a boundary known as the Kármán line and the region beyond which is considered to be space.
- The experience usually lasts between 10 and 15 minutes.
- Companies like Blue Origin and Virgin Galactic have been the primary providers



Haven-1 to Become World's First Private Space Station



- The world's first private space station, Haven-1, is on track for launch in early 2027 aboard a SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket,
- Haven-1 is designed as a compact, commercial outpost in low Earth orbit, built to operate independently of government agencies and serve as a precursor to larger future space habitats.
- the Falcon 9 booster to place Haven-1 into orbit, with the station expected to function as an autonomous satellite initially. While the mission will be uncrewed at first

Copernicus Sentinel-2 Mission



- The European Space Agency (ESA)'s Copernicus Sentinel-2 mission recently released a stunning high-resolution image of the 2026 Winter Olympic venues across northern Italy.
- It is an Earth observation satellite mission developed by the European Space Agency (ESA).
- It is part of Copernicus – the European Union's Earth observation program.
- It aims at monitoring variability in land surface conditions.
- It comprises a land monitoring constellation of two polar-orbiting satellites placed in the same sun-synchronous orbit.
- The twin satellites S-2B and S-2C have a wide swath width (290 km) and a high revisit time.
- It offers information services that draw from satellite Earth observation and in-situ (non-space) data.

- ESA has developed a new family of satellites, called Sentinels, specifically for the operational needs of Copernicus.

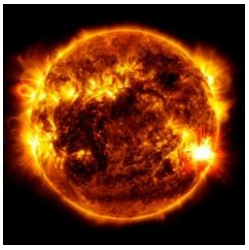
Recently, NASA found a hydrogen leak during a wet dress rehearsal of its Artemis II mission.

- The "wet" in the name refers to the loading of cryogenic fuel (typically liquid oxygen and liquid hydrogen for large rockets) into the rocket's massive tanks.
- Wet rehearsals are important because only they can reveal events that happen in cryogenic conditions, e.g., leaks in seals or in the connections between the rocket and ground equipment

What is a Dry Dress Rehearsal?

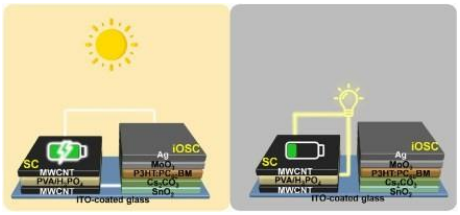
- It practices the countdown and important operations without loading cryogenic propellants into the rocket.
- Instead, the team will power up vehicle and ground systems, verify its communications equipment, simulate critical events, and validate decision-making and handoffs between launch control, engineering, range safety, and, if applicable, crew operations.
- Many of the testing steps use simulated sensor inputs.
- These rehearsals are useful to reveal logical problems in the flow of events without risking fuel leaks..

X8.3 flare, Strongest Solar Flare of 2026



- Over the past 24 hours, **multiple intense solar flares erupted from the Sun**, including an X8.3 flare, the strongest recorded so far in 2026.
- Solar flares are sudden, explosive releases of energy from the Sun's surface, driven by changes in its magnetic field.
- Scientists classify them into five categories based on strength: A, B, C, M, and X
- X-class flares are the most powerful,
- Solar flares affect Earth's ionosphere, not the lower atmosphere.

DST Scientists Develop Photo-Rechargeable Supercapacitor



- Indian scientists have developed a single-unit solar device that can capture and store solar energy simultaneously, eliminating the need for separate harvesting and storage systems.
- It is a photo-rechargeable supercapacitor—a next-generation energy device that integrates solar energy harvesting and electrical energy storage in a single unit, unlike conventional solar systems that require separate solar cells and batteries/supercapacitors.
- Developed by: **Scientists at the Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS), Bengaluru**
- Under the Department of Science and Technology (DST), Ministry of Science and Technology
- The device uses binder-free nickel–cobalt oxide ($NiCo_2O_4$) nanowires grown directly on nickel foam through an in-situ hydrothermal process.

Moltbook Platform



- A new tech phenomenon called Moltbook has erupted across social media as the first social network designed exclusively for artificial intelligence agents.
- Moltbook is a new online platform where artificial intelligence agents interact with each other without direct human participation.
- It was launched in January 2026 by developer Matt Schlicht.
- It allows AI systems to post, interact, and exchange information in a shared digital space.

17 Year Old Aditya Pandya Becomes India's Youngest Male Analog Astronaut



- 17-year-old Aditya Pandya has become India's youngest male analog astronaut after taking part in a lunar-habitat-inspired space mission in the white plains of Dholavira in Gujarat's Kutch region.
- From February 1 to February 8, AAKA Space Studio, a space research and simulation organisation and a registered ISRO Space Tutor, conducted the analog mission to study how humans live and work in isolation under Moon-like conditions.

National Large Solar Telescope

- In this year's Union Budget, the government sanctioned the establishment of two new telescopes namely National Large Solar Telescope and National Large Optical-Near Infrared Telescope to study the sun and the origins of the universe.

National Large Solar Telescope

- It is a 2-metre aperture solar telescope, coming up in the Merak region near the Pangong Tso Lake.
- Purpose: It is meant to study the sun
- It will operate in the visible and near-infrared wavelengths of the electromagnetic spectrum.
- NLST will serve as India's third ground-based solar observatory.
- Currently, the Kodaikanal Solar Observatory (in Tamil Nadu, established 1899) and the Udaipur Solar Observatory (in Rajasthan, established 1975) are operational.

National Large Optical-Near Infrared Telescope

- It is a 13.7-metre aperture segmented-mirror telescope which will be built in Hanle.
- In a segmented-mirror telescope, a larger primary mirror comprises highly complex, smaller hexagonal mirror segments.
- It will have 90 smaller segmented mirrors arranged in a fashion that they all collect light but act as one, large mirror.
- It will be one of the world's largest telescopes operating in the electromagnetic spectrum's optical-infrared wavelengths.
- Objective: Frontier research on exoplanets, stellar and galactic evolution, and supernovae will be possible, besides looking for clues to trace the origins of the universe

Biological E. gets WHO phase II nod for novel oral polio vaccine



- Biological E. has received phase II pre-qualification of the World Health Organisation for its novel oral polio vaccine type 2 (nOPV2).
- The phase II PQ covers both drug substance and drug product manufactured at BE, completing the full manufacturing chain for nOPV2 at a single integrated site.

About Poliomyelitis (Polio)

- Highly infectious viral disease that largely affects children under 5 years of age
- Transmission: Person-to-person spread mainly through the faecal-oral route or,
- less frequently, by a common vehicle (e.g., contaminated water or food) and multiplies in the intestine, from where it can invade the nervous system and cause paralysis.
- India's polio-free status: India was declared polio-free by the World Health Organization (WHO) in 2014, with the last wild poliovirus case reported in 2011

Air-Ships Based High-Altitude Pseudo-Satellite (AS-HAPS)

- The Defence Acquisition Council recently granted Acceptance of Necessity to the procurement of Air-Ships Based High-Altitude Pseudo-Satellite (AS-HAPS) for the Indian Air Force.

Air-Ships Based High-Altitude Pseudo-Satellite (AS-HAPS)

- HAPS are solar-powered unmanned aerial vehicles designed to operate in the stratosphere at altitudes of approximately 18-20 kilometres,

- HAPS platforms can remain airborne for months or even years using solar power during the day and high-density batteries at night.
- This gives them satellite-like capabilities at a fraction of the cost, hence the term “pseudo satellite.”
- HAPS hovers persistently over specific locations, providing real-time monitoring of border areas to det

Gaganyaan Drogue Parachute

- India achieved a key milestone in its human spaceflight programme as **DRDO successfully conducted a qualification-level load test of the Drogue Parachute for the Gaganyaan mission.**
- The Gaganyaan Drogue Parachute is a crucial component of the deceleration system of India’s Gaganyaan Crew Module.
- It is deployed during re-entry to stabilize and reduce the velocity of the module before the main parachutes open.
- **Developed collaboratively by Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).**
- Tested at the Terminal Ballistics Research Laboratory (TBRL), Chandigarh using the Rail Track Rocket Sled (RTRS) facility.

The Gaganyaan deceleration system consists of 10 parachutes (4 types):

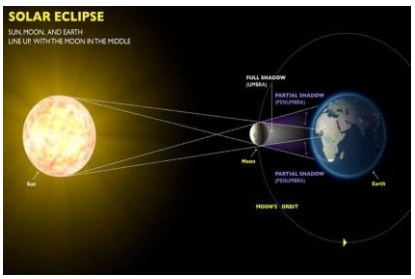
- Apex Cover Separation Parachutes (2) – Remove protective cover.
- Drogue Parachutes (2) – Stabilize and reduce velocity at high altitude.
- Pilot Parachutes (3) – Extract main parachutes.
- Main Parachutes (3) – Provide final deceleration for safe landing.

CHaracterising ExOPlanet Satellite (CHEOPS)



- ESA’s CHaracterising ExOPlanet Satellite (CHEOPS) recently revealed a four-planet system whose outermost world is a small and rocky planet — not a gas giant.
- **It is a European Space Agency (ESA) spacecraft.**
- It is the first space mission dedicated to studying bright, nearby stars that are already known to host exoplanets, **in order to make high-precision observations of the planet’s size as it passes in front of its host star.**
- It focuses on planets in the super-Earth to Neptune size range.
- **Launch date:** 18 December 2019
- **Orbit**: Sun-synchronous, dusk-dawn orbit at 700 km above Earth.
- **CHEOPS observes transits of Earth-to-Neptune-sized exoplanets and measures their diameters within 10 percent**.
- When combined with mass data from ground telescopes, it helps calculate planet density.
- A planet’s density provides vital clues about its composition and structure, indicating, for example, if it is predominantly rocky or gassy, or perhaps harbours significant oceans

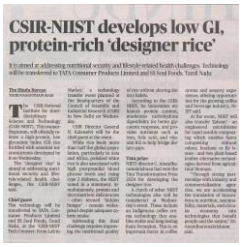
Solar Eclipse (Surya Grahan) 2026



- The year’s first solar eclipse occured, February 17.
- Not visible in India .
- **The rare annular event, during which the Moon will pass over the Sun’s centre**, will create a bright “Ring of Fire” effect.
- A Solar Eclipse shows precise celestial alignment where the Moon’s shadow falls on Earth, creating observable changes in sunlight, temperature and sky brightness.
- Solar eclipses occur exclusively during the New Moon when the Moon lies between the Sun and Earth, blocking solar radiation.

- Eclipses happen only during eclipse seasons occurring approximately every 173 days when lunar nodes align with the Sun.
- **Unlike lunar eclipses, solar eclipses are visible only from narrow geographic regions due to the Moon's small shadow.**
- The type of eclipse depends on whether observers fall within the umbra, penumbra or antumbra shadows.

Protein-rich 'designer rice' developed by CSIR-NIIST to be released


CSIR-NIIST develops low GI, protein-rich 'designer rice'

- The CSIR-National Institute for Interdisciplinary Science and Technology (CSIR–NIIST), Thiruvananthapuram, will officially release a high-protein, **low glycaemic index (GI) rice fortified with essential micronutrients .**
- The 'designer rice' is aimed at addressing nutritional security and lifestyle-related health challenges.

Shalimar Wheat

- **Scientists at Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology (SKUAST-K) have developed two new early-maturing wheat varieties to support the rice–wheat cropping system in Kashmir.**
- Shalimar Wheat refers to newly developed early-maturing wheat varieties bred by SKUAST-K through conventional breeding techniques to suit Kashmir's climatic conditions.
- They are designed specifically to fit into the rice–wheat cropping system, allowing timely wheat harvest before paddy transplantation.

Variety Names:

- Shalimar Wheat-4 (SW-4) – matures by the last week of May
- Shalimar Wheat-3 (SW-3) – matures by the first week of June

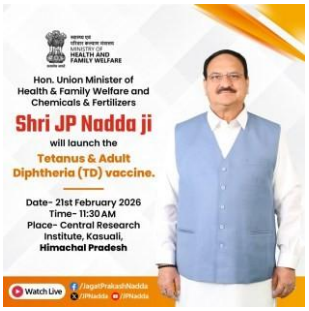
Key Features:

- **Early maturity**: Developed to mature earlier than traditional varieties, enabling timely field preparation for rice cultivation.
- Adapted to mid-altitude regions up to about 1,850 m, unlike earlier varieties sourced from subtropical regions.
- **Rice–wheat rotation compatibility**: Ensures smooth crop sequencing by preventing delays in paddy transplantation.
- **Disease resistance:** Shows resistance to yellow rust, a major fungal disease affecting wheat in Kashmir.
- **High productivity potential**: SW-3 offers productivity up to 38 quintals per hectare, balancing yield with early maturity.
- **Nutritional enhancement (Biofortification):** SW-3 contains higher iron and zinc (>40 ppm) and around 12% protein, improving nutritional value

Tetanus and Adult Diphtheria (Td) Vaccine

- The Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare will launch the Tetanus and Adult Diphtheria (Td) vaccine at the Central Research Institute (CRI), Kasauli, Himachal Pradesh.

Tetanus and Adult Diphtheria (Td) Vaccine

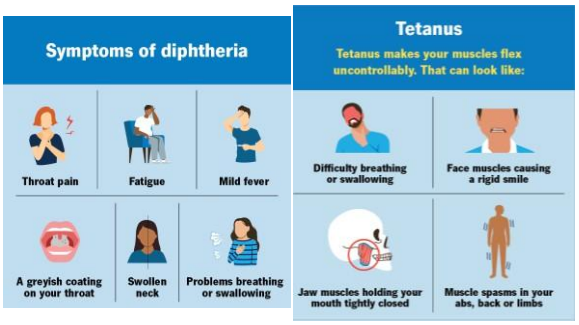


- **Preparation:** It is prepared by combining purified diphtheria toxoid and purified tetanus toxoid.
- **Td is freeze and heat sensitive.**
- The vaccine has been developed and manufactured by the Central Research Institute (CRI), which functions under the Directorate General of Health Services

About Tetanus

- Tetanus is an acute infectious disease caused by toxigenic strains of the bacterium Clostridium tetani.
- The disease may occur at any age and case-fatality rates are high even where intensive care is available.

Symptoms: It causes painful muscle stiffness and spasms and can lead to severe health complications



About Diphtheria

- It is caused by Corynebacterium diphtheriae, has been one of the most feared infectious diseases globally, which causes devastating epidemics.
- **Spread**: It can spread from person to person, usually through respiratory droplets, like from coughing or sneezing.
- **Symptoms:** It is a potentially life-threatening infection that can cause breathing difficulties, heart failure, paralysis, and death.

Vikko Sat-1

- In an impressive display of scientific skill, **13 students from the Class XI batch of Ariyakudi Government Higher Secondary School in Tamil Nadu's Sivagangai district have successfully launched** a 600 gram mini satellite named Vikko Sat-1.
- It is a **600-gram mini satellite**.
- It was **developed by a group of students from the Class XI batch of Ariyakudi Government Higher Secondary School in Tamil Nadu's Sivagangai district**.
- It was specifically designed to detect fungal spores in the stratosphere using five specialised sensors.
- These biological particles play a crucial role in agricultural health and environmental cycles, and their presence in the upper atmosphere can impact crops if they descend.
- By **sending a compact device into the stratosphere via a helium balloon, the students aimed to collect real-time data that is often difficult to obtain through ground-based observations.**
- The mini satellite ascended to a height of 22 km, entering the stratosphere, which is the second layer of the atmosphere.

Epstein – Barr virus

- Researchers are progressing towards a vaccine against Epstein-Barr virus (EBV), which affects 95% of the global population and is linked to multiple serious diseases.
- **It is a common and highly contagious infection.**
- **Transmission: It spreads through bodily fluids, especially saliva.**
- EBV is a type of herpesvirus called herpesvirus 4.
- It has been found to be widely present in the human population.
- Most cases of Epstein-Barr virus affect children, teenagers and young adults, but anyone can get the virus.
- **It usually does not cause any harm, but the virus gets reactivated inside the body in some unusual conditions like immunological stress or immunocompetence.**
- This may further lead to various complications like a type of blood cancer called Burkitt's lymphoma, stomach cancer, multiple sclerosis.
- **Symptoms:** Sore throat and throat inflammation, Fatigue or feeling extremely tired, Fever, Swollen lymph nodes, Rashes on your skin, Enlarged spleen and liver.
- **Treatment**: There is no specific treatment for EBV.

ENVIRONMENT

Lake Urmia

- Recently, after the communal prayer in Tehran, the government mounts cloud seeding in the lake Urmia basin.
- Lake Urmia is one of the largest inland lakes located in northwestern Iran.
- Its waters have no outlet, they are highly saline and it is one-fourth as salty as the Dead Sea.
- The basin is surrounded by mountains in the west and north, by plateaus in the south, and by plateaus and volcanic cones in the east.
- Lake Urmia is home to a number of diatoms, phytoplankton (algae). and bacteria.
- Protection Status: It is designated as a Ramsar Site and part of UNESCO's Man and the Biosphere Programme (MAB).

New 'bio-warrior' species discovered in Bay of Bengal ecosystem , the worms thriving where others die



- the Bay of Bengal's coastline, researchers from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), have uncovered two remarkable new marine worm species (polychaetes) from the coasts of West Bengal.
- One species is named Namalycastis solenotognatha, deriving its name from the Greek words "solenotos" (channeled) and "gnatha" (jaw).
- Ideal conditions for its survival are extreme environments, sulfide-rich, foul-smelling mudflats, and they are mostly found on decomposing mangrove wood and hardened clay.
- The second species had been named Nereis dhritiae, after the first woman director of ZSI, Dhriti Banerjee.
- This species was found living inside wooden dock piles on sandy beaches, which are submerged during times of high tide.
- These worms are "bio-warriors" that thrive where other life withers, offering a fresh perspective on the fragile.

Chichón Volcano Shows Fresh Signs of Hydrothermal Activity



- El Chichón, also known as Chichonal, is a stratovolcano situated in the forested terrain of north-central Chiapas, Mexico.
- This volcano is made up of several lava domes and a tuff ring. A tuff ring is a low, wide ring of volcanic ash and rock.
- It is one of the most active volcanoes located in Mexico.

India to Host First Global Big Cats Summit



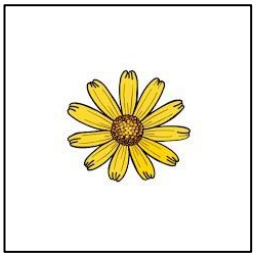
- India announced that it will host the Global Big Cats Summit in New Delhi in 2026, reaffirming global leadership in wildlife conservation.
- IBCA - Launched in 2023 by India for conservation of seven big cat species - tigers, lions, snow leopards, cheetahs, leopards, pumas and jaguars.
- It formally came into force in 2025,
- Organizational Nature: IBCA is a multi-country, multi-agency coalition comprising of 95 big cat range countries, non-range countries, conservation partners, scientific organizations, business groups and corporates with an interest in big cat conservation.
- Secretariat: New Delhi, India.

Project Himank - rare sighting of the elusive snow leopard

- A rare sighting of the elusive snow leopard recorded by Project Himank in the High Himalayas recently, has drawn attention to successful conservation efforts alongside infrastructure development in the region.

- Project Himank is a project of the Border Roads Organization (BRO) in the Ladakh region of India, which started in 1985.
- Objective: Development of road communication in the Ladakh region.
- The "Mountain Tamers" as they are called, have been instrumental in creating and maintaining roads and airfields.
- The Project ensures the maintenance of communication and access to strategic areas close to the Line of Actual Control (LAC) with China.
- It is known for building some of the most motorable roads in the highlands of the world through Khardung La, Tanglang La, Chang La, and Mig La passes.
- At 19,400 ft, Mig La Pass is the highest motorable road in the world.

Recently, the Kerala chief minister launched the NeophyteID application.



- It is an AI-powered mobile application designed to help users identify invasive plant species across Kerala.
- It is developed by researchers at the Malabar Botanical Garden and Institute for Plant Sciences (MBGIPS),
- It is aimed as a citizen-friendly app which enables local communities, students and ecologists to collectively monitor, report and manage the spread of invasive plants threatening native flora and ecosystems.
- Technology Used: It is powered by the YOLOv11 machine learning model.
- The app leverages image recognition and geospatial tracking to accurately detect and map invasive (neophyte) plant species directly from your camera or gallery.
- Each identification contributes to a real-time distribution map, supporting research, conservation, and community-based biodiversity management.
- Languages: It is accessible in English and Malayalam

Dolphin Census in Odisha

- Odisha has recorded its highest marine dolphin population in five years, with 765 individuals counted in the 2026 state-wide census.
- The Dolphin Census is an annual scientific population estimation exercise to assess the abundance, distribution, and diversity of dolphins and other cetaceans in Odisha's marine and estuarine ecosystems.
- It is conducted by the Wildlife Wing of the Forest, Environment and Climate Change Department, Government of Odisha, involving forest officials, marine experts, and field personnel using boat- and shore-based transect surveys



Outcomes of 2026 Census:

- Total Population: 765 dolphins (highest in 5 years).

Species-wise Distribution:

- Humpback dolphins – 497
- Irrawaddy dolphins – 208
- Bottlenose dolphins – 55
- Spinner dolphins – 3
- Finless porpoise – 2

Key Conservation Zones:

- **Chilika Lake – 159 Irrawaddy dolphins (largest single-area concentration globally).**
- Gahirmatha Marine Sanctuary – 474 Humpback dolphins.

About Dolphin:

- Dolphins are aquatic marine mammals belonging to the order Cetacea and are known for their intelligence, social behavior, and echolocation abilities.
- Habitat: They inhabit oceans, coastal waters, estuaries, and some freshwater systems. In India, major habitats include Chilika Lake and coastal marine zones.

IUCN Status:

- The Irrawaddy Dolphin is classified as Endangered on the IUCN Red List.
- Dolphins are protected under Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.

Tropical Cyclone Gezani Hits Madagascar



- A **tropical cyclone** is formed only over warm ocean waters near the equator.
- The centre of a cyclone is very calm and clear with **very low air pressure**.
- The average speed is **120 kmph**.

Dragon Hole



- The Sansha Yongle Blue Hole, also known as the Dragon Hole, sits in the South China Sea and has drawn scientific attention for more than a decade.
- The Dragon Hole is the popular name for the Sansha Yongle Blue Hole, a massive marine sinkhole in the South China Sea.
- Blue holes are steep-sided underwater cavities, often formed in limestone landscapes, that later flooded as sea levels rose.
- It is the deepest known underwater sinkhole in the world.

The Blue Gold: All about India's rare, deep-indigo turmeric with supercharged healing power



- Turmeric is a bright yellow spice, known for its antimicrobial and antioxidant properties.
- India grows its own rare blue turmeric - Naturally bluish-purple in centre, it is an Ayurvedic herb known for its healing and immunity-boosting properties.
- blue turmeric is a rare plant known as Curcuma caesia, also called black turmeric.
- It looks different from regular turmeric because the inside of the root is dark blue or bluish-black rather than bright yellow
- Blue turmeric contains very little curcumin but does contain other active compounds, such as essential oils, camphor, and phenolic compounds.
- Blue turmeric has a stronger smell and a bitter, camphor-like taste, which makes it less suitable for cooking,"

Scientists have raised concerns over the Thwaites Glacier, as it is melting at an unprecedented rate



- Location: It is a large glacier in West Antarctica, about the size of a large country.
- Scientists have often called it the "Doomsday Glacier".
- It's a wide and fast-flowing glacier, roughly the size of Florida or Great Britain.
- It is one of the most vulnerable and important glaciers in the world in terms of future global sea-level rise.
- It contributes 4% to global annual sea-level rise, and its collapse could destabilise the West Antarctic Ice Sheet, which would cause catastrophic sea-level rise

Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve

- Recently, the standing committee of the National Board for Wildlife has recommended approval for the diversion of about 272 hectares of forest for the Kopra medium irrigation project in the core area of the Veerangana Durgavati Tiger Reserve in Madhya Pradesh.
- Location: It is located in the state of Madhya Pradesh.

- It encompasses areas within the Nauradehi Wildlife Sanctuary and Durgavati Wildlife Sanctuary.
- It is the seventh tiger reserve in Madhya Pradesh.
- It is named for Rani Durgavati, the queen of the Gondi people.
- The reserve also boasts a diverse landscape, with hills, valleys, rivers, streams, waterfalls, and grasslands.
- Rivers: It straddles parts of the Narmada and Yamuna River basins.
- The Singorgarh Fort is located within the reserve

Dalma Wildlife Sanctuary

- The Jharkhand tourism minister recently launched a jungle safari and laid the foundation for 30 eco-cottages at Dalma Wildlife Sanctuary in East.
- It is located near Jamshedpur, in the East Singhbhum district of Jharkhand.
- It is situated around the Dalma Hills on the Chottanagpur Plateau.
- The Sanctuary gets its name from the “Dalma mai” a local goddess who is revered and worshipped by the local people and the people of adjoining villages of Dalma.
- Inaugurated in 1975, it contains a significant population of Indian Elephants.
- The terrain here is hilly and rocky, with dense forests and grasslands.
- The entire forest of Dalma Sanctuary falls in the catchment of the Subarnarekha River and Dimna Lake of Jamshedpur.
- It features two prominent waterfalls, Sitaguldi and Dassam.
- A temple dedicated to Lord Shiva, known as the Dalma Temple, is inside the cover.



Continental Mantle Earthquakes

- Recently the Stanford researchers have produced the first global map of a rare type of earthquake i. e Continental mantle earthquakes.
- These are seismic events which originate in the mantle beneath continents.
- **Origin:** Unlike most earthquakes, which originate in the Earth’s cold, brittle crust at depths of around 10 to 29 kilometres, mantle earthquakes often occur more than 80 km below the Mohorovičić discontinuity (boundary between the crust and the mantle).
- **Impact:** They are too deep to cause much shaking or danger at Earth’s surface.
- **Occurrence:** They occur worldwide but are regionally clustered, particularly beneath the Himalayas in southern Asia and the Bering Strait between Asia and North America.

What is Mohorovičić Discontinuity?

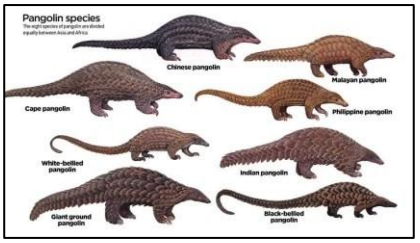
- It is the boundary lying **between the crust and the mantle of the earth** across which seismic waves change velocities.
- It is located approximately 24 miles below the earth’s surface and 6 miles below the oceanic floor, a distance which varies from place to place.
- The discontinuity **was named after Croatian** seismologist and geophysicist **Andrija Mohorovicic** who pioneered its **discovery in 1909.**

Naga Community Bans Pangolin Hunting in Nagaland

- Recently, the apex body of Nagaland’s Sangtam community has passed a resolution to protect pangolins.
- The **Sangtam tribe** is one of the sixteen major tribes of Nagaland.
- They are one of the major **Naga ethnic** groups in Northeast India.
- They are concentrated in the **Kiphire and Tuensang districts** of Nagaland, bordering Myanmar
- The **Sangtam people traditionally practice jhum cultivation (shifting agriculture),** which remains central to their livelihood.
- They follow a patriarchal system of lineage and inheritance as well.



Festivals:



- **Mongmong:** The predominant theme of the festival is the worship of the God of the house and the three cooking stones in the fireplace.
- **Tsohsuh:** It is commonly known as 'vi thung' festival and is celebrated during the spring season in the month of March.
- **HüNAPUNGBI**: It is celebrated especially for children.
- **Pangolin Species:** There are 8 species of pangolins: 4 in Africa (Black-bellied, White-bellied, Giant Ground, Temminck's Ground) and 4 in Asia (Indian, Chinese, Sunda, Philippine pangolins).

Conservation Status:

- Indian pangolin is Endangered on the **IUCN Red List.**
- The Chinese pangolin is listed as **Critically Endangered.**
- Both are protected under **Schedule I** of India's Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.
- All 8 species are listed in **CITES Appendix I.**

Palamu Tiger Reserve Launches 'Vanjeevi Didi' Initiative

- The south division of Palamu Tiger Reserve has launched a new initiative titled 'Vanjeevi Didi' across 17 identified villages to train educated women to become PTR ambassadors.
- **Palamu Tiger Reserve**: It is located on the Chhotanagpur plateau in Jharkhand.
- The reserve forms a part of the Betla National Park.
- It is one of the first 9 tiger reserves created in the country at the inception of 'Project Tiger'.
- **It is the first reserve in the world in which a tiger census was carried out as a pugmark count,** as early as 1932 under the supervision of J.W. Nicholson.

Kole Wetlands

- A recent scientific study conducted at the Kole wetlands, a Ramsar-listed ecosystem in Kerala, has documented a total of 12 species of pygmy grasshoppers.
- The Kole wetlands are located in Central Kerala, that spreads over Thrissur and Malappuram districts.
- It is popular for its paddy cultivation that dates back to 300 years.
- The wetland gets its name from its high productivity – 'Kole' literally translates to 'bumper crop' in Malayalam.
- It was declared as a Ramsar site of international importance in 2002.
- It comes in the Central Asian Flyway of migratory birds.
- In terms of the number of birds, the Kole Wetlands is the third largest in India after Chilika Lake in Orissa and Amipur Tank in Gujarat.
- It has been recognised as one of India's Important Bird Areas by BirdLife International.

Piton de la Fournaise Volcano



- The Piton de la Fournaise volcano on Reunion Island erupted for the second time this year.
- Location: It occupies the east-southeastern end of French Island La Réunion in the western Indian Ocean.
- Type: It is a massive basaltic shield volcano.
- Status: It is around 500,000 years old and since 2010, it has been a member of the prestigious club of natural treasures listed as World Heritage sites by UNESCO.

Shield Volcano

- They are the largest volcanoes on Earth.
- They do not form soaring mountains with conical peaks like composite volcanoes. Instead, they are broad volcanoes with gentle slopes.
- They are almost exclusively basalt, a type of lava that is very fluid when erupted.

- Because basalt has a low viscosity, it can flow on the surface better. So, when these types of volcanoes erupt, lava flows outwards at large distances.
- The Hawaiian shield volcanoes are the most famous examples

One Plant Per Day resolution

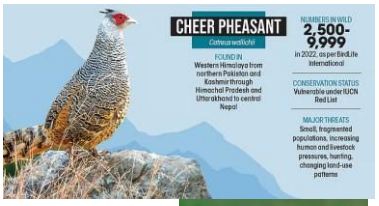
- Union Minister marked the completion of five years of the "One Plant Per Day" resolution.
- The One Plant Per Day Resolution is an environmental initiative launched by Shri Shivraj Singh Chouhan in 2021, under which he pledged to plant at least one sapling daily.
- The initiative promotes individual and community participation in afforestation and aims to convert personal environmental responsibility into a large-scale mass movement.
- Organisation: Led by the Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers' Welfare and Ministry of Rural Development.

Papikonda National Park



- The adult male tiger, named 'Explorer', was reintroduced into the wild in the Papikonda National Park (PNP) in Andhra Pradesh as part of Operation Stripes.
- Location: It is located in the East Godavari and West Godavari Districts of Andhra Pradesh.
- It lies along the banks of the Godavari River.
- Terrain: It encompasses a rugged landscape with steep slopes, hills, and deep valleys.
- Mountains: There are 62 named mountains in the park. Devara Konda is the highest point. The most prominent mountain is Verala Konda.
- It has been recognized as an Important Bird and Biodiversity Area by BirdLife International

Cheer Pheasant





- Recently, it is observed that hunting and habitat degradation remain the biggest threats of ground-dwelling Cheer Pheasant.
- It is found in steep, rocky hillsides studded with scrub, stunted trees and grassy slopes between 1,200 and 3,350 metres.
- Distribution: Western Himalaya from northern Pakistan through Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand, to central Nepal.

Conservation Status of Cheer Pheasant

- **IUCN: Vulnerable**
- **CITES: Appendix I**
- **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: Schedule I.**

Loggerhead Turtles



- A long-term study published in Animals (2026) shows that loggerhead turtles are shrinking in size and producing fewer eggs due to warming oceans and declining marine productivity.
- The Loggerhead sea turtle is a large marine turtle known for its massive head and strong jaws.
- It is one of the most widely distributed sea turtles in temperate and subtropical oceans.
- Scientific Name: Caretta caretta
- Global Distribution – Found in the Atlantic, Pacific, and Indian Oceans, and the Mediterranean Sea.
- **Nesting Beaches** – Prefers sandy, high-energy, sloped beaches for egg-laying.
- **Major Nesting Sites** – Florida (USA), Oman, Cabo Verde, Japan, and Australia.

- **IUCN Status**: Vulnerable (IUCN Red List)
- **Long Lifespan** – Can live 70–80 years or more.

What is the dart frog toxin allegedly used to kill Alexei Navalny?



Russian opposition leader Alexei Navalny was killed using a deadly toxin found in poison dart frogs.

What is the toxin?

- Epibatidine is a natural neurotoxin isolated from the skin of the Ecuadorian poison dart frog.
- It was "200 times more potent" than morphine.
- Epibatidine can be found naturally in dart frogs in the wild in South America.
- This powerful chemical compound acts on nicotinic receptors in the nervous system.

Malabar Pied Hornbill

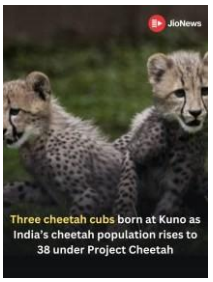


- The Chhattisgarh Forest Department has started establishing six “hornbill restaurants” in the Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve (USTR) for the rare Malabar Pied Hornbill and to promote natural forest expansion.
- The Malabar pied hornbill (Anthracoceros coronatus), also known as lesser pied hornbill, is a bird in the hornbill family.
- Distribution: It is found in the Western Ghats and north-eastern Himalayan foothill regions of India and Nepal, the Satpuda Hills, as well as in Sri Lanka.
- Conservation Status: IUCN: Near Threatened

Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve

- Location: It is located in the state of Chhattisgarh.
- The drainage system of the reserve consists of the Mahanadi as the main river.

Kuno National Park Cheetah Population Rises to 38



- India’s ambitious cheetah reintroduction programme has achieved a fresh milestone as three new cubs were born at Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh.
- The latest births have taken the country’s total cheetah population to 38.
- The births coincide with the completion of three years since cheetahs were reintroduced to India.
- Project Cheetah is the world’s first inter-continental translocation of a large carnivore.
- Kuno National Park is located in Madhya Pradesh’s Sheopur district**.**

Galathea Balasubramaniani



- Researchers recently discovered a tiny crab species named Galathea balasubramaniani from the coral reefs of Agatti in the Lakshadweep Islands.
- It was discovered from the coral reefs of Agatti in the Lakshadweep Islands.
- It belongs to the genus Galathea, a group of small, reef-dwelling anomuran crabs commonly called squat lobsters.

Nandhaur Wildlife Sanctuary



- Smooth-coated otters were officially recorded for the first time in Nandhaur Wildlife Sanctuary, Uttarakhand.
- Nandhaur Wildlife Sanctuary is a protected forest area forming part of the Terai Arc Landscape, serving as a crucial biodiversity corridor between India and Nepal.
- Situated in Nainital district, Uttarakhand.
- Lies between the Gola and Sharda Rivers.

- Connects forests of Ramnagar with Shuklaphanta National Park in Nepal.



History:

- Established in 2012.
- Part of the Shivalik Elephant Reserve (since 2002).
- Recently prescribed by the National Tiger Conservation Authority (NTCA) as Uttarakhand's third Tiger Reserve.

About Smooth-Coated Otter:

- The smooth-coated otter is a semi-aquatic mammal and one of the largest otter species in Asia, known for its sleek body and strong swimming ability.
- Scientific Name: Lutrogale perspicillata
- Conservation Status : Listed as Vulnerable on the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) Red List.

Indian Sandalwood



- According to a recent report by the sandalwood development committee (SDC) set up by the Union Government, globally, the estimated annual demand for sandalwood stands at 5,000 to 6,000 tonnes.
- Santalum album L. (Santalaceae) commonly known as Indian Sandalwood is one of the oldest and precious sources of natural fragrance.
- It is known by the name "Chandan" and "Srigandha" in India.
- Soil: Sandalwood grows better in slight alkaline condition soil PH Range between 6.7. to 7.5.
- Climate: It thrives in hot and humid climates.
- **Uses**: Sandalwood and its essential oils have very high commercial values because of its use in aromatherapy, soap industry, perfumery, cosmetics, and pharmaceuticals.
- **Major Sandalwood Growing States**: Sandalwood is mostly grown in states of Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat, Bihar, Telangana, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Tamil Nadu in India.

Contarinia icardiflores



- Scientists from the ICAR-Directorate of Floricultural Research (ICAR-DFR), Pune, recently discovered a new species of blossom midge, Contarinia icardiflores sp. nov.
- It is a new species of blossom midge.
- It was found causing significant economic losses in jasmine cultivation, especially in some parts of Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka.

DEFENCE

Indian Army's Rudra Brigade showcases at Pokhran : Exercise Rudra Shakti



- In a display of modern combat capability, the Indian Army's cutting edge formation Rudra Brigade, operating alongside newly inducted Apache helicopters and other assets, successfully executed high-intensity all-arms exercise Rudra Shakti at Pokhran.
- The live-firing exercise which showcased seamless integration of mechanized forces, artillery, air defence units and Army Aviation assets, was reviewed by Southern Army Commander Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth.
- Exercise Rudra Shakti was conducted as a follow-up to Exercise Akhand Prahar, which had earlier validated the Rudra Brigade and new operational concepts in the desert sector.

The Indian Air Force will hold Exercise Vayushakti on February 27



- Host / Location: India | Pokaran Field Firing Range, Rajasthan
- Participants: Indian Air Force (IAF) units from across the country
- Key features: Largest day-to-night air-power exercise of the IAF.
  - Participation of 120+ aircraft and helicopters, including Rafale, Su-30 MKI, Tejas, Mirage-2000, Apache, Chinook, and Dhruv.

Agni Pariksha Joint Exercise in Arunachal Pradesh



- The Indian Army and Indo-Tibetan Border Police recently conducted Agni Pariksha in Arunachal Pradesh to enhance joint combat capabilities.
- It is a joint training exercise involving personnel from the Indian Army and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP).
- Location: Arunachal Pradesh
- This first-of-its-kind initiative aimed to enhance inter-force combat synergy and operational integration.

Global navies to gather in Visakhapatnam for International Fleet Review and MILAN 2026



- the International Fleet Review, Exercise MILAN and the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium Conclave of Chiefs will be held in Visakhapatnam from February 15 to 25.
- This will be the first time India hosts all three major maritime events together.
- India has hosted the review twice earlier, in Mumbai in 2001 and in Visakhapatnam in 2016.
- The International Fleet Review : The International Fleet Review is a time-honoured naval tradition that assembles ships and sailors from friendly foreign navies, serving as a platform for confidence-building, mutual respect, and operational familiarity.
- The President of India, as Supreme Commander of the Armed Forces, reviews the assembled fleet at sea.
- Exercise MILAN-26, a biennial multilateral naval exercise will bring together dozens of navies for operational drills.
- Indian Ocean Naval Symposium Conclave is a voluntary initiative that seeks to increase maritime cooperation among navies of the littoral states of the Indian Ocean Region- inaugural edition of IONS was held in Feb 2008 at New Delhi, with the Indian Navy as the Chair for two years (2008–2010.

13th India-Kyrgyzstan Joint Military Exercise KHANJAR-XIII Scheduled in Assam



- The 13th edition of the joint military Exercise KHANJAR between India and Kyrgyzstan begins recently at Misamari in Sonitpur district of Assam from February 4 to 17

- It is the 13th edition of the annual India-Kyrgyzstan Joint Special Forces Exercise.
- Exercise Khanjar was first initiated in December 2011, in Nahan, India.
- Since then, the exercise has been held alternatively in India and the Kyrgyz Republic every year.
- Khanjar-XIII Location: Misamari in the Sonitpur district of Assam.
- The 14-day-long military exercise aims to enhance interoperability between the Special Forces of both nations.

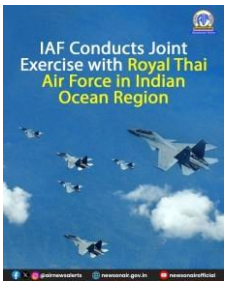


India, Japan, Indonesia conduct trilateral naval exercise in Andaman Sea



- The Indian Navy, along with Japan and Indonesia, conducted a trilateral exercise in the Andaman Sea
- The exercise aimed to enhance joint operational readiness, improve interoperability, and strengthen maritime cooperation for a safe and stable region.

IAF, Royal Thai Air Force jointly conduct air combat exercise in Indian Ocean Region



- India and Thailand conducted a joint air combat exercise in the Indian Ocean Region to enhance interoperability and **Indo-Pacific security cooperation.**
- Simultaneously, the Indian Air Force announced Exercise Vayushakti-26, showcasing its full-spectrum combat capability at Pokhran.
- A bilateral in-situ air combat exercise conducted in the Indian Ocean Region to deepen defence cooperation under India's Act East Policy.
- IAF operated from Andaman & Nicobar Islands

South Korean & US commences joint aerial exercise 'Buddy Squadron'

- The South Korean and the United States' air forces have commenced a joint aerial exercise at Osan Air Base in Pyeongtaek, South Korea
- The Buddy Squadron exercise will run till 13th Feb and is aimed at enhancing interoperability and integrated tactical capabilities between the two allies.
- The Buddy Squadron exercise is a battalion-level drill conducted in rotation between South Korean and US forces, focusing on sharing air-to-air tactics and conducting integrated tactical training involving fourth- and fifth-generation fighter jets, strengthening joint operational readiness in the region.

INS Arnala

- INS Arnala, the Indian Navy's first indigenously designed and built Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC), marks a significant milestone in India's transition from a "Buyer's Navy" to a "Builder's Navy".
- It is the first of the eight ASW SWCs (Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft) built for the Indian Navy.
- It is the Indian Navy's first indigenously designed and built ASW SWC.

- It was designed and built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE), Kolkata.
- It was commissioned into the Eastern Naval Command of the Indian Navy on 18 Jun 2025.
- It is named after the historic fort 'Arnala' located off Vasai, Maharashtra.
- This 77-meter-long warship, with a gross tonnage of over 1490 tonnes, is the largest Indian Naval warship to be propelled by a Diesel Engine-Waterjet combination.

Agni-3 Missile

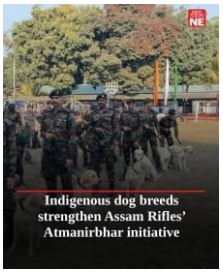


- Recently the Intermediate Range Ballistic Missile 'Agni-3' was successfully test-fired from the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur, Odisha.
- It is an indigenously developed intermediate-range ballistic missile (IRBM).
- It is a surface-to-surface ballistic missile.
- It is one of the sophisticated and accurate missiles of its class and has already been inducted into the armed forces.

Features of Agni-3 Missile

- The missile is two-stage and solid-fuelled, capable of carrying a 1,500 kg payload.
- Range: 3,000–3,500 km
- It is designed primarily as a nuclear delivery system, with an estimated warhead yield of 200–300 kilotons.
- The missile measures 16.7 metres in length, 2 metres in diameter and has a launch weight of 48,300 kg.
- It uses a strapdown inertial navigation system (INS) supported by GPS, giving it an accuracy of around 40 metres circular error probable (CEP).

Tangkhul Hui and Kombai breeds to add bite to the dog squad of Assam Rifles



- Assam Rifles is planning to induct two indigenous dog breeds—**Tangkhul Hui (Manipur) and Kombai (Tamil Nadu)** into its dog squad.
- Assam Rifles (India's oldest paramilitary force) runs a dedicated **Assam Rifles Dog Training Centre (ARDTC),** Jorhat, where trained dogs support operations as:
- Trackers follow human or animal trails across difficult terrain during operations.
- Guard dogs provide security to camps, convoys, and border posts.
- Detection dogs assist in identifying hidden arms, explosives, or narcotics.



About Tangkhul Hui (Haofa) breed:

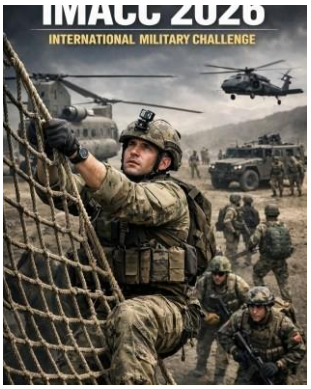
- Tangkhul Hui (Haofa) is an indigenous working dog traditionally **raised by the Tangkhul people in Ukhrul district (Manipur),** historically used for hunting.
- Highly disease-resistant and known for strong stamina rather than speed.
- Exists in two size varieties and has a limited population.

About Kombai breed (Polygar dog):



- Kombai is a strong, indigenous working dog from Tamil Nadu (Theni district; **named after Kombai town**), traditionally **kept for guarding and protection** and sometimes used for hunting.
- The Kombai breed **has not been added yet**; the first batch (2 males, 8 females) is scheduled for induction in April 2026.
- **Strong physical build**: Broad, muscular and athletic body suited for demanding guard and working roles.
- **Distinct appearance:** Short, smooth coat (usually reddish-brown) with a characteristic black mask-like muzzle.
- Traditional working role: **Historically used for guarding property** and occasionally for hunting large game.

Indian Army to host first-ever IMACC 2026 in Eastern Himalayas



- The Indian Army will host the first-ever International Military Adventure Challenge Cup (IMACC) 2026 between the 18th and 23rd of February in the foothills of the Eastern Himalayas.
- the event will bring together military teams from India and friendly foreign countries for a week-long series of challenging adventure and endurance competitions.
- Teams from seven friendly foreign countries – Bhutan, Brazil, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Saudi Arabia, along with teams from the Indian Army, Indian Air Force, Indian Coast Guard and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) will take part in IMACC 2026.
- India has been an active participant in this global tradition and has earlier hosted the 4th CISM Military World Games in 2007.

Indian Navy assumes command of Combined Task Force 154



- The Indian Navy has assumed command of Combined Task Force 154, marking the first time it has led the multinational training task force under the Combined Maritime Forces.
- The change of command ceremony was held on at the CMF headquarters in Manama, Bahrain.
- CTF-154 focuses on training and capacity building for member nations of the 47-nation Combined Maritime Forces.
- The task force was established in May 2023 and is dedicated to enhancing maritime security through multinational training programs across the Middle East and the wider region.
- CTF-154 conducts regular Maritime Security Enhancement Training events.
- It also carries out exercises such as Compass Rose and Northern and Southern Readiness.

MoS for Defence Sanjay Seth to participate in World Defence Show 2026 on Feb 8



- The World Defense Show (WDS) 2026 is the third edition of a premier international defense exhibition founded by Saudi Arabia's General Authority for Military Industries (GAMI).
- It is scheduled to take place from February 8–12, 2026, in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia.
- As part of India's participation, the first-ever India Pavilion at the defence show,

Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)on a four-day official visit to Armenia



- The Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) General Anil Chauhan is leading a high-level defence delegation on a four-day official visit to Armenia to strengthen bilateral defence engagement.
- Location: It is a landlocked country, located in the south of Caucasus mountain range.
- Bordering Countries: It is bounded by Georgia in the north, Azerbaijan in the east, Iran in the southeast and Turkey in the west.
- Capital: Yerevan.



Operation Kiya



- Operation Kiya is in the news due to a fierce counter-terrorism encounter in the forested Basantgarh area of Udhampur, where security forces have cordoned off Pakistani terrorists.
- Operation Kiya is a joint counter-terrorism operation launched by Indian security forces to neutralise terrorists hiding in remote forest areas of Jammu and Kashmir.
- Aim: To track, contain, and eliminate infiltrated terrorists while preventing their movement across districts and safeguarding civilian areas.
- Joint security grid: Conducted by the Army's White Knight Corps, Counter Insurgency Force (Delta), J&K Police, and CRPF, ensuring coordinated intelligence and firepower.

Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR) Technology



- Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) successfully demonstrated Solid Fuel Ducted Ramjet (SFDR) technology from Integrated Test Range, Chandipur.
- SFDR is an air-breathing propulsion system for missiles that uses atmospheric oxygen for combustion and solid fuel burned in a controlled manner to provide sustained thrust at supersonic speeds.
- Unlike conventional rockets, it maintains high energy throughout flight—especially in the terminal phase.

The third edition of the tri-services Future Warfare Course begins in New Delhi.



- The third edition of the tri-services Future Warfare Course is scheduled to commence at Manekshaw Centre in New Delhi from 02 - 25 Feb 2026,
- under the aegis of Headquarters Integrated defence Staff and in partnership with the Centre for Joint Warfare Studies (CENJOWS).

Defence Minister approves Miniratna-I status for Yantra India Limited

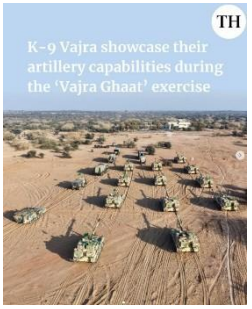
- Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh has approved the grant of 'Miniratna' Category-I status to Yantra India Limited (YIL)
- The YIL is one of the newly formed Schedule 'A' DPSUs functioning under the administrative control of the Department of Defence Production.
- In May 2025, Raksha Mantri had approved grant of Miniratna-I Status to three of the seven DPSUs - Munitions India Limited, Armoured Vehicles Nigam Limited and India Optel Limited.
- Miniratnas are profitable PSUs divided into two categories: Category I and Category II.
- They are financially stable but smaller than Navratna and Maharatna companies.
- Category I companies can invest up to ₹500 crore or their net worth, while Category II companies can invest up to ₹300 crore or 50 percent of net worth.

Army flags off 'Bharat Ranbhoomi Darshan' expedition from Dwarka



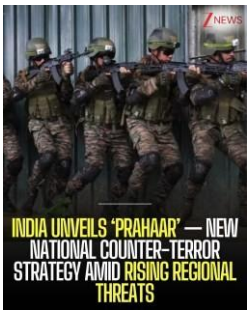
- The 'Bharat Ranbhoomi Darshan' expedition was flagged off from the coastal city of Dwarka
- The expedition is being undertaken in collaboration with gunners of the Indian Navy, and the Border Security Force (BSF).
- The expedition team will travel over 3,400 km along India's western frontier, covering key border regions of Gujarat and Rajasthan.

Exercise Vajra Prahar 2026



- The Indian and US armies will hold the 16th edition of joint Special Forces exercise, Vajra Prahar, at the Special Forces Training School, Bakloh, Himachal Pradesh.
- Duration : February 23 to March 15.
- It is the joint Special Forces exercise between the Indian Army and US Army.
- The focus this year will be on the exchange of advanced special operations tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs), honed through rigorous training in realistic combat scenarios.

Vajra Ghaat exercise



- Type: Indian Army field-firing / combat validation exercise
- Conducted by: Southern Command, Indian Army
- Location: Pokhran Field Firing Range, Jaisalmer (Rajasthan – Thar Desert sector)
- Led by the White Tiger Division
- The drill was organised to validate refined Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) and improve operational effectiveness in desert warfare conditions.
- Demonstration of K9 Vajra self-propelled artillery gun system .

Govt unveils country's first counter-terrorism policy — Prahaar

- The Centre has launched 'Prahaar', India's first comprehensive counter-terrorism policy. Built on a zero-tolerance approach, it emphasises intelligence-led prevention and coordinated responses to extremist violence.
- The framework aims to dismantle terror networks by cutting off access to funding, weapons, and safe havens, both within India and abroad, targeting not just terrorists but also their financiers and supporters.

Guiding Principles

- Zero Tolerance
- Victim-Centric Approach
- No Religious Attribution

- Concern Over State Sponsorship

Seven Key Pillars of Prahaar

Each letter of the acronym represents a strategic pillar:

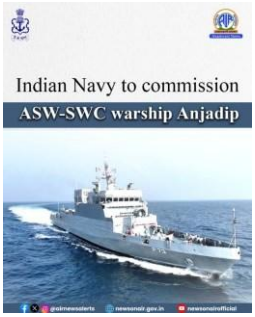
1. Prevention
2. Responses
3. Aggregating Internal Capacities
4. Human Rights and Rule of Law
5. Attenuating Enabling Conditions
6. Aligning International Efforts
7. Recovery and Resilience

INS Sudarshini marks historic port call at Safaga, Egypt during Lokayan-26



- The Indian Navy's sail training ship INS Sudarshini arrived at Safaga, Egypt marking a historic port call during its 10-month transoceanic voyage, Lokayan-26.
- INS Sudarshini is an ind.igenously built Sail Training Ship (STS)
- It was built by Goa Shipyard Limited and based at Kochi, Kerala under the Southern Naval Command of the Indian Navy.
- It was successfully built and was commissioned on 27 Jan. 2012.
- Lokayan 26 - It is a 10-month transoceanic expedition where the ship will sail over 22,000 nautical miles, visiting 18 foreign ports across 13 countries.

Indian Navy to commission anti-submarine warfare shallow water craft Anjadip



- The Indian Navy is set to commission the Anjadip, the third vessel under the eight-ship Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC) project.
- The warship will be formally inducted into the Eastern Naval Command at Chennai Port on February 27.
- Nicknamed a “Dolphin Hunter,”
- Built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers.
- Measuring 77 metres in length, Anjadip is powered by a high-speed water-jet propulsion system, allowing it to achieve speeds of up to 25 knots .
- The vessel is named after Anjadip, a historically significant island off the coast of Karwar.

Cadet training ship for Indian Navy launched, in the presence of Chief of Defence Staff in Chennai



- The first of three indigenous Cadet Training Ships, being built by M/s L&T Shipyard for the Indian Navy, was launched
- Named ‘Krishna’, the ship pays tribute to the River Krishna, the third longest river in the country.
- The contract for the three Cadet Training Ships was signed between the Ministry of Defence and M/s L&T Shipyard
- The primary role of the Cadet Training Ship is to provide basic sea training to Naval Cadets, its secondary roles include Hospital Ship, Non-Combatant Evacuation Ops, HADR, and SAR operations

Indian Navy inaugurates Milan Village as part of Exercise Milan 2026, Visakhapatnam

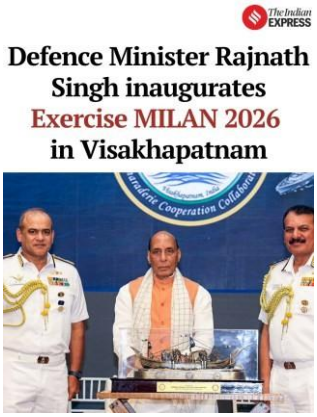
- The Indian Navy inaugurated the MILAN Village at the Eastern Naval Command in Visakhapatnam as part of its flagship multilateral exercise, Exercise MILAN 2026.



- the MILAN Village embodies the theme "Camaraderie, Cooperation, Collaboration,"
- The initiative aims to promote social and cultural exchanges alongside professional naval cooperation,
- Visakhapatnam hosts the International Fleet Review (IFR), MILAN, and the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS)
- Exercise MILAN 2026, It is a biennial multilateral naval exercise, February 15–25,
- It was started with the participation of only four countries, viz Indonesia, Singapore, Sri Lanka and Thailand, in the 1995 edition.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh inaugurates 13th edition of Exercise MILAN-2026 at Visakhapatnam

- Raksha Mantri interacted with Navy Chiefs and delegations from nine ASEAN countries during the MILAN 2026 Naval Exercise held in Visakhapatnam.
- MILAN is a multilateral naval exercise initiated by the Indian Navy to enhance maritime cooperation, interoperability and trust among friendly navies in the Indo-Pacific region.
- It serves as a platform for joint training, operational coordination and strategic dialogue on maritime security challenges.
- Host: Hosted by the Indian Navy
- Theme: "Camaraderie, Cooperation and Collaboration."
- MILAN 2026 is being conducted at Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.



Nations Involved:

- Largest-ever edition with participation from 74 nations.
- Includes nine ASEAN member states, reflecting strong regional engagement.

Includes Sea Phase exercises such as:

- Anti-Submarine Warfare (ASW)
- Air Defence drills
- Search and Rescue (SAR) operations
- Conduct of International Fleet Review 2026 and IONS Conclave of Chiefs.

Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS)



- India assumed the Chairmanship of the Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS) during the 9th Conclave of Chiefs held in Visakhapatnam in February 2026.
- The Indian Ocean Naval Symposium (IONS) is a voluntary, inclusive and multilateral maritime forum that promotes cooperation among navies of the Indian Ocean Region (IOR).
- Established in: Established in 2008.
- Initiated by the Indian Navy to strengthen maritime cooperation among Indian Ocean littoral states.
- History: India held the inaugural chairmanship (2008–2010).
- Successive chairmanships included UAE, South Africa, Australia, Bangladesh, Iran, France and Thailand.

Indian Navy to conduct Goa Maritime Conclave 2026 at Naval War College, Goa



- The fifth edition of Goa Maritime Conclave (GMC-26) is scheduled to be held at the Naval War College, Goa, on 21 Feb 2026.

- Adm Dinesh K Tripathi, Chief of the Naval Staff, will host Chiefs of Navies, Heads of Maritime Forces, and senior representatives from 14 nations
- The theme - *'Common Maritime Security Challenges in the IOR — Progressing Line of Efforts (LsoE) to Mitigate Dynamic Threats such as IUU Fishing and other Illegal Maritime Activities.'*
- The Goa Maritime Symposium (GMS) and Goa Maritime Conclave (GMC) were instituted in 2016 and 2017.

6th Generation Aero Engines

- **Defence Minister of India has asked DRDO scientists to develop an indigenous 6th** generation aero engine within 5–7 years.
- A 6th generation aero engine is an advanced jet engine designed for future stealth fighters.
- Unlike older engines that operate in one fixed mode, these engines can change their working style mid-air depending on mission needs.
- They are not just thrust providers. They also act as a power and cooling hub for AI systems, advanced radars, and future laser weapons.

Khorramshahr-4 Missile

- **Iran recently released dramatic footage of its Khorramshahr-4 ballistic missile** — one of Tehran's most powerful medium-range missiles — as tensions with the United States continue to rise.

Khorramshahr-4 Missile



- Also known as the Kheibar missile, it is a medium-range ballistic missile **developed by Iranian state-owned defence company Aerospace Industries Organization (AIO).**
- **It is liquid-fuelled and has an operational range of approximately 2,000 kilometers.**
- It is capable of striking 80 targets upon reaching the target area

CJ-1000 Missile

- China recently showcased the CJ-1000, a land-based scramjet-powered hypersonic missile, during a military parade in Beijing.
- **It is a road-mobile hypersonic cruise missile developed by China.**
- It is the world's first and so far only operational land-based scramjet-powered hypersonic missile.
- CJ-1000 is mounted on a highly mobile 10-wheel diesel-electric hybrid transporter-erector-launcher.
- It is estimated to have a range of at least 2,500 km.



Why Are Scramjet Missiles More Dangerous Than Glide Vehicles?

- Scramjet missiles have a cruise altitude of 20 km to 30 km, which is much lower than that of glide vehicles.
- Glide vehicles typically fly at an altitude of approximately 60 km to 80 km.
- **For enemy air defence radar systems, the lower a missile flies, the more difficult it is to detect and respond to.**

United Nations Fellowship Training Programme on SALW Control

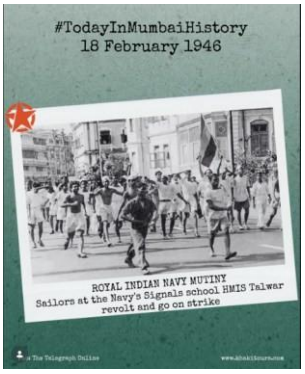
- India is **hosting the inaugural United Nations Fellowship Training Programme on Small Arms and Light Weapons (SALW) Control for the Asia-Pacific region for the first time in Asia.**
- It is a three-week capacity-building initiative aimed at strengthening government expertise in **controlling the illicit trade and misuse of small arms and light weapons**.
- It supports implementation of global disarmament frameworks, particularly the UN Programme of Action (PoA) and the International Tracing Instrument (ITI).

- **Host:** Indian Army
- **Venue**: Military College of Materials Management, Jabalpur, Madhya Pradesh

Organising Institutions:

- **United Nations Office for Disarmament Affairs (UNODA)**
- UN Regional Centre for Peace and Disarmament in Asia and the Pacific (UNRCPD)

80th Anniversary of the 1946 Royal Indian Navy Revolt



- February 18, 2026 marks the 80th anniversary of the 1946 Royal Indian Navy (RIN) Revolt, a major uprising against British rule.
- **The Royal Indian Navy (RIN) Revolt was a five-day armed uprising (February 18–23, 1946) by Indian naval ratings against British colonial authority.**
- It began as a protest over poor conditions but soon evolved into a wider anti-colonial rebellion involving sailors, workers, and civilians.
- Inspired by the Quit India Movement (1942) and the trials of the Indian National Army (INA).
- Appointment of openly racist officers, such as Arthur Frederick King at HMIS Talwar, further fuelled anger.
- **Prominent leaders of the uprising included**: B. C. Dutt, M. S. Khan, Madan Singh, Salil Shyam, and Rishi Dev Puri.

Indian Army Conducts 'Exercise Agni Varsha' at Pokhran



- The Indian Army, under the aegis of Headquarters Southern Command, conducted Exercise Agni Varsha at the Pokhran Field Firing Ranges in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer.
- To validate operational preparedness and integrated combat capabilities in the Desert Sector.
- **The exercise will be conducted from February 24 to March 9.**

India-Japan joint exercise 'Dharma Guardian' commences in Chaubattia, Uttarakhand



- Recently, the Exercise 'DHARMA GUARDIAN' commenced at the Foreign Training Node, Chaubattia in Uttarakhand.
- **(24 February - 9 March)** - the 7th edition of the annual Joint Military Exercise.
- It is the annual joint military exercise between the Indian Army and Japan.
- The aim of Exercise 'DHARMA GUARDIAN' is to strengthen military collaboration and enhance combined capabilities to undertake joint operations in a semi-urban environment.
- **The exercise is held alternately in India and Japan** .

<u>Other Exercises between India and Japan</u>

- Malabar: India and Japan with the United States and Australia participate in the naval war gaming exercise named Malabar.
- JIMEX (Naval)
- SHINYUU Maitri (Air Force)

The Freedom Shield drills



- South Korea and the United States will conduct major joint military drills known as Freedom Shield from March 9 to 19,
- The annual exercise is "defensive in nature".

Southern Air Command of Indian Air Force conducts high tempo joint maritime exercise, Kalari Leap



- Southern Air Command of the Indian Air Force has successfully conducted a high-tempo joint maritime exercise, named Kalari Leap, in the Lakshadweep and Minicoy archipelago.
- **The exercise was aimed at validating joint planning, rapid force projection and precise operational execution in complex maritime environments.**
- The Armed Forces Special Operations Division and the Indian Coast Guard also participated

Indian Army Conducts Successful Strela-10 VSHORADS Test Firing at Pokhran



- India has successfully conducted three flight tests of the indigenously developed **Very Short Range Air Defence System (VSHORADS) missiles at the Pokhran firing ranges in Rajasthan.**
- It is the 4th Generation, advanced miniaturised weapon system
- The tests, carried out by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- Currently, the Indian Armed Forces rely on Russian Igla missiles for short-range air defense.

Sky Sting Missile



- As Prime Minister pays his second state visit to Israel, India is keen to take forward the talks on acquiring the Israeli-origin 'Sky Sting' beyond-visual-range air-to-air missile (BVRAAM) for the Indian Air Force (IAF).
- It is **a 6th-generation beyond-visual-range air-to-air missile (BVRAAM).**
- It is being **developed by Rafael Advanced Defense Systems Ltd., an Israeli defense technology company**.
- Weighing between 180-200 kg, the missile is light enough to be carried by aircraft such as the Tejas Mk1A, while also being compatible with Su-30MKI fighters.
- It boasts a range of 250 km, with a three-pulse solid-fuel rocket motor enabling end-game speeds exceeding Mach 5.
- **Its radio-frequency seeker, supported by AI-driven target discrimination** and jam-resistant technology, allows precise early lock-on and robust electronic counter-countermeasures.

Jammu and Kashmir Police unveils elite high-altitude squad 'Snow Leopard' for anti-terror operations in extreme terrain



- For the first time, the Jammu and Kashmir Police has raised a specialised high-altitude combat unit named the "Snow Leopard Squad" to counter terrorists who have shifted their operations to dense forests and mountainous terrain across the Union Territory.
- The newly formed battalion has been tasked with neutralising terrorists hiding in the higher reaches and snowbound forests of both the Jammu and Kashmir divisions.
- **The squad has made an operational debut after being deployed at the ongoing Khelo India Winter Games in Gulmarg at heights of nearly 14,000 feet.**

NATIONAL CA

Rajya Sabha takes up discussion on motion of thanks on President Droupadi Murmu's address

- Both Houses of the Parliament will take up motion of thanks on President Murmu's address (February 2, 2026), following the presentation of the Union Budget on (February 1, 2026).
- The Motion of Thanks is a parliamentary procedure in which a formal motion is presented to express gratitude or appreciation for the President's Address to both Houses of Parliament.
- The address of the president, akin to the 'speech from the Throne' in Britain, is discussed in both Houses of Parliament through a motion called the 'Motion of Thanks.'
- Article 87 of the Constitution of India states that the President will address both Houses of Parliament at the beginning of the first session after each general election and at the beginning of the first session of each year.
- At the end of the discussion, the motion is put to vote.
- The Motion of Thanks must be passed in the House. Otherwise, it amounts to the defeat of the government.
- It is one of the ways through which the Lok Sabha can also express a lack of confidence in the government.

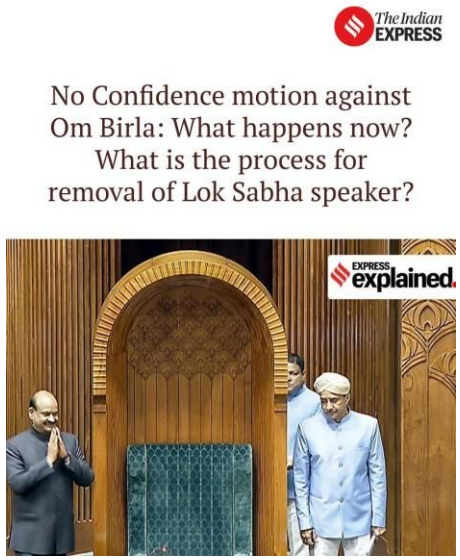


No Confidence motion against Om Birla: What is the process for removal of Lok Sabha speaker?

- The Opposition moved a no confidence motion against Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla.

Can the Lok Sabha Speaker be removed from their post?

- Yes, the process does not apply to the Rajya Sabha or Council of States.
- the Speaker or the Deputy Speaker can be removed from office by a resolution of Lok Sabha passed by a majority of all the then members of the House.
- This is procedurally possible under Article 94 (c) of the Constitution.
- Article 94, per se, provides for the vacation, resignation and removal of those occupying the offices of Speaker and Deputy Speaker; the rules in this regard, however, are stringent



What is the procedure for the removal of a Speaker or Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha?

- A member wishing to give notice of a resolution for the removal of the Speaker or the Deputy Speaker has to do it in writing to the Secretary-General of the Lok Sabha.
- This notice may be given by two or more members jointly – but no resolution for the removal of such officials moved under clause (c) can be moved unless at least fourteen days' notice has been given of the intention to move the resolution.
- After such as notice is received, a motion for leave to move the resolution is entered in the List of Business in the name of the members concerned on a day fixed by the Speaker.
- This day has to be 'any day after fourteen days from the date of the receipt of notice of the resolutions'.
- No-confidence been submitted against a Lok Sabha Speaker or Deputy Speaker in the past - Thrice in the past in the years 1954, 1966 and 1987.
- Such a motion requires to be backed by at least two Members of the House of the People, or the Lok Sabha and "50 members have to stand up" in its favour, that is, the quorum of the House has to be fulfilled for the procedure to take place.

- In 1954, Ganesh Vasudev Mavalankar, the first Speaker of the Lok Sabha, was the first presiding officer to face a no-confidence motion in December, 1954.
- There were two more – against Hukam Singh in November 1966 and Balram Jakhar in April 1987. None of them lost the Speaker chair because of the motion.

What does the Speaker, in their capacity as a Member of the House, do while their removal from office is being discussed?

- According to the rules, whenever the House of the Lok Sabha is dissolved, the Speaker 'shall not vacate his office until immediately before the first meeting of the House of the People after the dissolution.'
- The Speaker has the right to speak as well as to take part in the proceedings of Lok Sabha while any resolution for their removal from office is under consideration in the House.
- They are entitled to vote only in the first instance on such a resolution or any other matter during such proceedings but not in the case of an equality of votes.

Privilege Notice

- The Union Government has announced that it will move a Privilege Notice against Leader of Opposition for allegedly making baseless and misleading statements during the Budget discussion in the Lok Sabha.
- A Privilege Notice is a formal complaint raised by a Member of Parliament (MP) alleging that a breach of privilege or contempt of the House has occurred.
- Parliamentary privilege refers to certain special rights and immunities enjoyed by Parliament and its members to ensure they can perform their duties without obstruction or intimidation
- If these rights are violated, it may amount to a breach of privilege and can be punished by the House.



Articles Associated:

- Article 105 – Powers, privileges and immunities of Parliament and its Members (for Parliament).
- Article 194 – Similar provisions for State Legislatures.
- Article 122 – Courts cannot question the validity of parliamentary proceedings on grounds of procedural irregularity.
- Article 105(2) provides immunity to MPs for anything said or any vote given in Parliament.

A Privilege Notice can be moved when:

- A member is obstructed from performing parliamentary duties.
- There is misleading of the House by providing false information.
- There is defamation or attack on the dignity of Parliament or its members.

What is a Substantive Motion

NEWS: BJP MP Nishikant Dubey has given a notice to initiate a 'substantive motion' against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, and demanded that his Lok Sabha membership be cancelled and he be debarred from contesting elections for life.



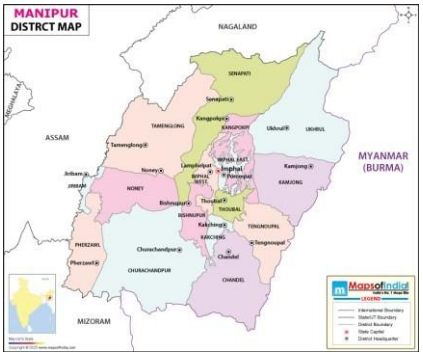
What is Substantive Motion?

- A motion in parliamentary terms is an official suggestion made by a member of the House requesting that the House take a specific action, implement an order, or express an opinion on a particular issue.
- It is crafted to reflect a decision that the House can adopt.
- A substantive motion is an independent proposal submitted to the House for approval, structured to communicate a decision effectively.
- Discussions about the conduct of individuals in high positions must also be initiated through appropriate substantive motions.
- If the motion is accepted, the Lok Sabha will need to engage in a formal debate and make a decision regarding the issue.
- Currently, the next steps are entirely at the discretion of Speaker Om Birla, who can either accept or reject the motion or choose an alternative path according to the rules.

President's rule revoked in Manipur



- Manipur was placed under President's Rule on February 13, 2025, and the State Assembly was placed under suspended animation.
- N. Biren Singh resigned on February 9, 2025,
- President Murmu has revoked the proclamation issued by her under the article 356 of the constitution last year in relation to the state of Manipur.
- In Manipur's case, President's Rule has been imposed, but **the State Assembly has not been dissolved.**



Constitutional Provisions

- The President's Rule was enacted under **Article 356 of the Indian Constitution.**
- The proclamation must be approved **by both Houses of Parliament within two months as per Article 356 (3).**
- It allows the President to take over State governance based on the Governor's report or other inputs.
- The State government and Governor's functions are transferred to the Union government.
- The State Assembly's powers are transferred to Parliament.
- **The proclamation must be laid before Parliament and expires in two months unless ratified.**
- It can be renewed every six months, up to a maximum of three years.

Official Secrets Act, 1923



- The Ministry of Defence is framing fresh guidelines for serving and retired armed forces personnel regarding publication of books, following controversy over the unpublished memoir of former Army Chief M. M. Naravane.
- The proposed framework will incorporate provisions of the Official Secrets Act, 1923, which continues to apply even after retirement.
- The Official Secrets Act, 1923 is a colonial-era law enacted to consolidate and amend laws relating to protection of official information, particularly concerning national security and state interests.

Who are covered?

- The Official Secrets Act, 1923 applies to all persons, including government servants, defence personnel, private individuals, and companies, and extends to Indian citizens even outside India.
- It also covers those holding or having held office under Government and anyone in possession of classified or sensitive official information.

Key Features:

- Penalty for Spying (Section 3): Criminalizes approaching prohibited places, making sketches, or collecting information to aid an enemy; punishment may extend up to 14 years in sensitive defence cases.
- Communication with Foreign Agents (Section 4): Contact or association with foreign agents can be used as evidence in prosecution for offences against State security.
- Wrongful Communication of Information (Section 5): Punishes unauthorized sharing, retention, or misuse of official codes, documents, or information affecting sovereignty or security.
- Protection of Prohibited Places: Defines "prohibited places" including defence establishments, military infrastructure, and other notified sensitive installations.
- Search and Seizure Powers (Section 11): Empowers magistrates and, in emergencies, senior police officers to issue search warrants in suspected offences.
- Restriction on Trial (Section 13): Courts can take cognizance only upon complaint authorized by the appropriate Government, ensuring executive oversight.
- Exclusion of Public Proceedings (Section 14): Courts may exclude the public during trial if publication of evidence may prejudice State security.

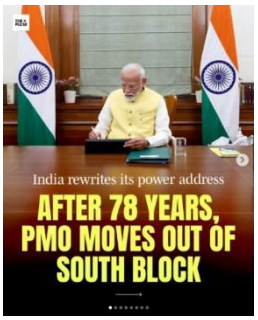
PM Modi inaugurates new PMO at 'Seva Teerth'



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi (February 13, 2026) inaugurated the Seva Teerth complex, which will house the Prime Minister's Office (PMO), the National Security Council Secretariat and the Cabinet Secretariat.
- PM Modi unveiled the plaque of Seva Teerth at the new complex –
- the name inscribed in Devanagari script on the wall of the complex. Below it is the motto 'Nagrik Devo Bhava' (citizen is akin to God).
- The name 'Seva Teerth', which translates to 'abode of service', underscores a focus on citizen-centric administration



- PM Modi also inaugurated Kartavya Bhavan 1 and 2, which will accommodate several key ministries
- The Prime Minister's Office (PMO) will shift out of the iconic South Block in Delhi after 78 years, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi relocating his official workspace to the newly constructed Seva Teerth complex
- Designed by Herbert Baker, a contemporary of Edwin Lutyens - the architect of Lutyen's Delhi - the North and South blocks had initially housed the British government and was taken over by the government of Independent India since 1947.
- The South Block houses the Prime Minister's Office, as well as the offices of the Ministries of External Affairs and Defence.
- The North Block is the site of the key home and finance Ministries.



The Seva Teerth complex, located on Dara Shikoh Road, comprises three interconnected buildings.

- Seva Teerth-1 will house the Prime Minister's Office,
- Seva Teerth-2 already accommodates the Cabinet Secretariat, and
- Seva Teerth-3 is designated for the National Security Council Secretariat and the office of the National Security Advisor.

PM's major decisions on Day 1 in new office

- His first decisions from Seva Teerth related to women, youth and vulnerable citizens.

These included approval for launching a PM RAHAT Scheme.

- Under this initiative, accident victims will get cashless treatment of up to ₹1.5 lakh, ensuring that no life is lost due to lack of immediate medical help.

Chennakeshava Temple



- The Prime Minister's new office complex, **Seva Teerth** has been built in the Indian architectural tradition inspired by the features of the **12th-century Chennakeshava Temple.**
- also referred to as the **Keshava, or Vijayanarayana Temple of Belur** in Karnataka, dedicated **to Lord Vishnu.**
- It was commissioned by **King Vishnuvardhana in 1117** CE (after a major military victory in 1116 CE over the Cholas in the great battle of Talakkad), on the banks of the **Yagachi River in Belur**, also known as Velapura.
- The temple was built over three generations and took 103 years to complete.
- The temple is listed as a **UNESCO World Heritage Site.**
- It is a stunning example of **Hoysala architecture.**
- The Hoysalas used **soft soapstone** for their structures, as they were found suitable for intricate carvings.
- **Enclosed by a Prakara with a Gopura built** in the **Vijayanagar style,** the temple stands on a platform, or Jagati, and looks like a huge casket.

Waste-pickers enumeration under NAMASTE scheme

- The Union government released nationwide enumeration data of waste-pickers for the first time under the NAMASTE scheme.
- The data revealed that 84.5% of waste-pickers belong to SC, ST and OBC communities.

Regional outliers:

- General category majority in Delhi and Goa
- West Bengal: 42.4% from General category
- Linked sanitation data: 91.95% of sewer/septic tank workers belong to SC/ST/OBC groups

- NAMASTE stands for National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem.
- It has been launched with an objective to ensure safety and dignity of sanitation workers in urban India as well as providing sustainable livelihood to these workers.
- Ministries involved: It is launched as a joint initiative of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE) and the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA).
- Implementing agency – National Safai Karamchari Financial Development Corporation (NSKFDC) would be implementing agency for NAMASTE.

Sabhasaar Initiative



- SabhaSaar Initiative is in the news as over 1.11 lakh Gram Panchayats have adopted this AI-enabled tool for **automated Gram Sabha meeting summarisation as of January 2026.**
- SabhaSaar is an AI-powered voice-to-text and meeting summarisation platform designed to automatically generate structured Minutes of Meetings (MoM) from Gram Sabha and Panchayat meeting recordings.
- Launched in: 14 August 2025

Organisations involved:

- Ministry of Panchayati Raj – Nodal implementing ministry
- IndiaAI Mission under Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology – AI & cloud infrastructure
- To strengthen participatory democracy, transparency, and efficiency in local self-government by digitising and standardising Gram Sabha documentation.

Yuva Sahakar Scheme



- Recently, the Ministry of Cooperation provided details of financial assistance released to cooperatives along with beneficiaries for financial year 2022- to 2025 under Yuva Sahakar Scheme.
- Yuva Sahakar – Cooperative Enterprise Support and Innovation Scheme" aims to **encourage newly formed cooperative societies with new and/or innovative ideas.**
- It encourages young entrepreneur Cooperative Societies which are in operation for a minimum of 3 months.
- Loan Facility: **The loan provided under the scheme is a long-term loan (up to 5 years) and as an incentive, NCDC provides 2% interest subvention** on its applicable rate of interest on term loan for the project activities.
- Implementation: It is being implemented by National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) across the country.

Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship informed the Lok Sabha about the Swavalambini Scheme

- It is a woman Entrepreneurship Programme which empowers young women with the skills and confidence needed to establish their own businesses.
- It introduces a structured, multi-stage training approach to help young women transition from ideation to successful enterprise creation.
- It is implemented through National Institute for Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development (NIESBUD), Noida and Indian Institute of Entrepreneurship (IIE), Guwahati.

Ayushman Sahakar Scheme

- The Union Minister for Home and Cooperation, provided an update in the Rajya Sabha regarding the implementation and funding framework of the **Ayushman Sahakar Scheme.**
- Ayushman Sahakar is a dedicated scheme of the National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC) to **provide financial assistance to cooperative societies** for establishing and expanding healthcare infrastructure across India.
- Launched in: 2020 (Notified by NCDC in alignment with National Health Policy 2017)

Ministry:

- Implemented by NCDC
- Under the administrative control of the Ministry of Cooperation

Key Features:

- Any Cooperative Society registered under State or Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act with healthcare provisions in its bye-laws is eligible.
- Supports infrastructure, modernization, AYUSH services, digital health, telemedicine, insurance, and working capital for diverse healthcare facilities.
- Flexible Financial Assistance: Provides term/investment loans up to 8 years (with 1–2 year moratorium) based on actual project requirements.
- Offers 1% interest rebate to women-majority cooperatives, subject to timely repayment compliance.
- Funding through State or direct NCDC route (up to 90% loan) with defined collateral/guarantee mechanisms.

INCOIS to launch three new ocean information services as part of its foundation day celebrations



- Indian National Centre for Ocean Information Services (INCOIS) will be launching three new ocean information services: JellyAIIP, SAMUDRA 2.0 Mobile App, and SIVAS along with a new logo during the foundation day celebrations.
- **JellyAIIP (Jellyfish Aggregation Information Interactive Portal):** It is a national web-based platform for reporting and visualising jellyfish aggregation, swarming, and stranding events along the Indian coast, with geospatial mapping, hotspot analysis, and multilingual first-aid guidance.
- SAMUDRA 2.0 Mobile App: It is an upgraded multilingual advisory platform delivering ocean information and early warnings to fishermen and maritime users.
- **SIVAS: Swell-Surge Inundation Vulnerability Advisory System**, is a coastal inundation early warning service designed to provide advance alerts on swell-surge flooding events, currently operational for the Kerala coast, with multilingual forecast bulletins

PM-SURAJ Portal



- The PM-SURAJ portal disbursed Rs 1,389.61 crore in loans to 1.39 lakh entrepreneurs in the 2024-25 fiscal year, surpassing its target.
- Pradhan Mantri Samajik Utthan evam Rozgar Adharit Jankalyan (PM-SURAJ) portal was launched by the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment in 2024.**
- Objective: To provide credit support to entrepreneurs from disadvantaged sections of society virtually.
- It is a centralised platform where individuals from underprivileged backgrounds **can apply for and track the progress of** all available loans and credit schemes

- Only those intending to establish a new business can apply on this portal, as this platform provides loans exclusively for business startups.
- **Business loans up to Rs 15 lakh** are available at **low interest rates** through this portal, which are transferred directly to your bank account through banks, NBFC-MFIs, and other financial institutions.

PAIMANA Web Portal

- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation has shared updated data in Lok Sabha on the PAIMANA Web Portal, which monitors central infrastructure projects worth ₹150 crore and above.
- PAIMANA (Project Assessment Infrastructure Monitoring and Analytics for Nation-Building) is a web-based monitoring system developed to track ongoing Central Sector Infrastructure Projects costing ₹150 crore and above.
- It replaces the earlier OCMS-2006 (Online Computerized Monitoring System).

Organisation Involved:

- Developed and managed by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).
- Integrated with the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) Integrated Project Monitoring Portal (IPMP) through APIs.

Key Features:

- One Data One Entry Principle: Automatic data flow from IPMP to PAIMANA via APIs, reducing duplication.
- Covers High-Value Projects: Tracks projects costing ₹150 crore and above across 17 Ministries.
- Real-Time Monitoring: Ministries and implementing agencies update progress digitally.
- Reduced Manual Entry: Around 60% of projects in major sectors (Roads, Petroleum, Coal) auto-updated.

Finance Minister announced the launch of Bharat-VISTAAR



- Recently, the Finance Minister announced the launch of Bharat-VISTAAR, a multilingual AI tool to integrate the AgriStack portals and the ICAR package on agricultural practices with AI systems.
- **AgriStack is a Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) for the farm sector.**
- **It is an initiative under the** Digital Agriculture Mission (DAM), and was approved by the Union Cabinet in September, 2024.
- The AgriStack comprises three foundational registries or databases in the agriculture sector:
- The Farmer Registry,
- Geo-referenced village maps
- and the Crop Sown Registry,

all created and maintained by the State Governments or Union Territories.

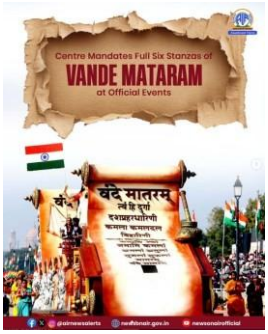
Rashtriya Karmayogi Large Scale Jan Seva Programme

- The Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions said that 10.5 lakh govt servants trained under Rashtriya Karmayogi Large Scale Jan Seva Programme.
- It is a national behavioural transformation initiative for civil servants.
- It is launched by the **Capacity Building Commission (CBC).**
- It was designed to emphasize upon the deeper sense of **Seva Bhav (spirit of service) and Svadharma (duty aligned with personal purpose)** among Government servants, with the objective of strengthening citizen-centric governance.

What is Capacity Building Commission?

- It is the executive body of the Mission Karmayogi framework, to drive civil service reforms through capacity building and competency-based learning.
- It works to strengthen the human resource foundations of the government by focusing on developing individual and institutional capacities, promoting citizen-centric governance, future readiness.

Centre Mandates Six Stanzas of Vande Mataram



- The Union Government has issued fresh guidelines mandating the singing of all six stanzas of 'Vande Mataram' at official functions.
- the original composition by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee be sung at specified government functions.
- **Total duration prescribed:** 3 minutes and 10 seconds.

Mandatory Occasions at the Union Level:

- To be played at civil investiture ceremonies and official state functions.
- To be played upon arrival and departure of the President of India.
- Before and after the President's address broadcast on Akashwani and Doordarshan.
- **State-Level Functions:** To be played during arrival and departure of Governors or Lieutenant Governors at official state functions.

Cultural and Flag-Hoisting Events:

- Mandatory group singing at cultural events and occasions involving flag hoisting.
- Morning assemblies of all schools must incorporate group singing.

Protocols During Rendition:

- Audience must stand in attention posture when the song is played.
- **Exception:** Not mandatory in cinema halls when played as part of films or newsreels.
- A drumroll (mridang/trumpet) to precede the song.

Seven Chakras of the India–AI Impact Summit 2026



- India is hosting the India–AI Impact Summit 2026 – the first global AI summit in the Global South, with participation from 100+ countries, structured around Seven Chakras and guided by Three Sutras: People, Planet, Progress.
- The Seven Chakras are thematic Working Groups that translate the three Sutras into actionable policy, governance, and implementation pathways for responsible and inclusive AI at global scale.

"Bharat Taxi,"



- The Union Cooperation Minister will launch India's first cooperative-based ride-hailing platform, "Bharat Taxi," at Vigyan Bhavan, New Delhi.
- Bharat Taxi is India's first cooperative-led ride-hailing platform registered under the Multi-State Cooperative Societies Act, 2002.
- It is a government-supported initiative developed under the Union Ministry of Cooperation and the National e-Governance Division (NeGD).
- It is India's first cooperative taxi network, allowing drivers to become shareholders and co-owners.
- Promoted: It is being jointly promoted by leading cooperative and financial institutions including NCDC, IFFCO, AMUL, KRIBHCO, NAFED, NABARD, NDD Band NCEL
- **Driver-Owned Fleet**: Drivers can purchase shares and become cooperative members.
- **Zero Commission:** Unlike private cab aggregators that take a large cut, Bharat Taxi transfers the full fare to the driver.
- Transparent, No-Surge Pricing: Fares will remain predictable, with no surge charges.
- Platform Integration & Technical Architecture: Integration of the Bharat Taxi platform with national digital platforms such as DigiLocker, UMANG, and API Setu.

India Signs Pact to Launch Bharat Container Shipping Line



- The government announced the signing of an agreement for setting up of **Bharat Container Shipping Line (BCSL)**
- The pact for BCSL aligns with the spirit of the Rs 10,000-crore Container Manufacturing Assistance Scheme (CMAS).
- The scheme aims to establish a globally competitive container manufacturing ecosystem in India, supporting the rapid growth of containerized cargo, which accounts for nearly two-thirds of the value of international trade.

Nationwide Digital Campaign on 16-17 February 2026 to Promote Ethical, Inclusive and Responsible AI Use



- The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India, under the **IndiaAI Mission**, in collaboration with Intel India, will launch "Most pledges received for an AI Responsibility campaign in 24 hours" a nationwide campaign beginning 16 February 2026
- The initiative will attempt an official GUINNESS **WORLD RECORDS™ title** for the **"Most pledges received for an AI responsibility campaign in 24 hours."**
- The Al Responsibility Pledge campaign forms a key citizen-engagement pillar of the India Al Impact Summit 2026, **scheduled from February 16-20 at** Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi

Central Sector Scheme of Formation and Promotion of 10,000 Farmer Producer Organizations (FPOs)

- The Government of India has completed the formation of 10,000 Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs) under a central sector scheme, with 21.96 lakh women farmers.
- A central sector scheme to form and nurture 10,000 new FPOs across India, enabling small and marginal farmers to collectivise production, processing, and marketing for better incomes and market power.
- Launched in: 29 February 2020

Implementing Agencies (IAs):

- Small Farmers' Agribusiness Consortium (SFAC)
- National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD)
- National Cooperative Development Corporation (NCDC)
- National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED)

Key features: Cluster & commodity approach: Produce-cluster-based formation aligned with One District One Product (ODOP).

Financial support:

- Up to ₹18 lakh/FPO (3 years) for handholding
- Matching equity grant up to ₹15 lakh/FPO (₹2,000 per farmer)
- **Credit guarantee up to ₹2 crore project loan per FPO**

- Market linkage: NAFED-led forward linkages and value-chain integration.
- Capacity building: Structured training via BIRD (Lucknow) and LINAC (Gurugram).
- Inclusion focus: Strong participation of women farmers and coverage of aspirational districts.

Form 7 Controversy

What is the current controversy around Form 7?

What has the Congress alleged with respect to Form 7? How many deletions have been reported?

Saee Pande

The story so far:

In the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR), bulk applications are being filed for the deletion of names from the draft electoral rolls. On January 29, the Congress, in a letter to the Election Commission of India (EC), alleged that the form was being misused through "systemic and coordinated efforts" to delete names of eligible voters and embolden BJP's efforts to wrongfully gain electoral advantage. *The Hindu*'s reporting from Rajasthan and Gujarat also found individuals who said they had not submitted the Form 7 applications purportedly signed by them.

What is Form 7?

Form 7 is used for objecting to the inclusion of another person's or one's own name on the electoral roll on specific grounds such as death, duplication or shifting of residence. It can also be used to object to voters who are ineligible due to age, citizenship or misrepresentation. As per Section 13(2) of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, framed under the Representation of the People Act, 1950, "every objection to the inclusion of a name in the roll shall be (a) in Form 7 and (b) preferred only by a person whose name is already included in that roll". Booth Level Agents (BLAs) can also file objections. Earlier, only persons from the same booth/station were allowed to file an objection but in 2022, the EC amended Form 7 to allow any voter in a constituency to object, widening its ambit. However, to prevent misuse, the Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) is required to mandatorily verify all claims if an individual files more than five objections.

Once a Form 7 application is received, Booth Level Officers (BLO) are required to conduct physical verification of the voter's address and eligibility. In cases of death, verification involves confirmation signatures by three neighbours and a death certificate. If the voter is found absent, the BLO must make three physical visits to confirm whether the person has shifted. The concerned voter is then issued a notice for a hearing. Appeals against the ERO's decision can be made to the district magistrate within 15 days of publication of the updated list.

How extensive is the ongoing SIR?

According to the EC, more than 50.94 crore enumeration forms have been distributed since the launch of Phase II of the SIR, covering 99.94% of the nearly 51 crore voters included in this phase. The SIR is currently underway in Chhattisgarh, Goa, Gujarat, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal, Puducherry, the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Lakshadweep. The revision follows a tight schedule, and against this compressed timeline, the scale of objections and deletions sought through Form 7 has raised concerns about procedural fairness and administrative capacity. According to the draft electoral rolls published by the EC, the names of 6.5 crore electors were removed from the draft rolls of nine States and three Union Territories (UTs) as part of the ongoing SIR. Before the revision, these States and UTs had 51 crore voters; after publication of the draft rolls, the number fell to 44.4 crore. EC officials said those removed were placed in the 'ASD' category – Absent, Shifted and Dead/Duplicate. The highest deletions were reported from Uttar Pradesh (2.89 crore), followed by Tamil Nadu (97 lakh), and Gujarat (74 lakh).

What is the way ahead?

At the heart of the controversy is the bulk submission of Form 7 applications by anonymous or fraudulent actors seeking mass deletion of voters from electoral rolls in the ongoing SIR. Filing a false declaration is a punishable offence under Section 32 of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, attracting imprisonment of up to one year or a fine or both. Critics argue that 'if remained unchecked this will lead to the disenfranchisement of lakhs of voters, especially those belonging to the backward, marginalised communities'.

Saee Pande is a freelance writer.

THE GIST

- Form 7 is used for objecting to the inclusion of another person's or one's own name on the electoral roll on specific grounds such as death, duplication or shifting of residence.
- According to the EC, more than 50.94 crore enumeration forms have been distributed since the launch of Phase II of the SIR.
- At the heart of the controversy is the bulk submission of Form 7 applications by anonymous or fraudulent actors seeking mass deletion of voters from electoral rolls in the ongoing SIR.

- Form 7 has become controversial during the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls after allegations of bulk, fraudulent deletion requests targeting eligible voters.
- Form 7 is a statutory form used to object to the inclusion of a name (one's own or another person's) in the electoral roll on specified grounds such as death, duplication, shifting of residence, ineligibility by age or citizenship, or misrepresentation.
- Governed by the Election Commission of India
- Prescribed under Registration of Electors Rules, 1960, framed under the Representation of the People Act, 1950
- As per Section 13(2), objections must be filed in Form 7 by a person whose name is already on the electoral roll
- Booth Level Agents (BLAs) are also permitted to file objections

Key features:

- Expanded scope (2022 amendment): Any voter in a constituency (not just same booth) can object
- Mandatory verification: Especially if an applicant files more than five objections
- Grounds-based deletion: Death, absent/shifted, duplicate entry, underage, non-citizenship
- Due process safeguards: Physical verification, notices, hearings, and appeal mechanism
- Legal deterrence: False claims attract imprisonment up to one year or fine or both

PM Museum to get copies of Morarji's Nishan-e-Pakistan, Bharat Ratna from Gujarat Vidyapith



- **THE MAHATMA Gandhi-founded Gujarat Vidyapi**th will be sharing replicas of the highest civilian awards of India and Pakistan — **the Bharat Ratna and the Nishan-e-Pakistan —**
- awarded to the **late Prime Minister Morarji Desai**, with the Prime Ministers' Museum and Library (PMML) at the Teen Murti Bhavan, Delhi as part of a Memorandum of Understanding between the two institutions in 2024.
- The original awards from both countries are displayed at a gallery dedicated to the late prime minister at the Gujarat Vidyapith, where Desai was Chancellor from 1963 till his death in 1995.
- **Desai is the only Indian prime minister** to have been awarded the **Nishan-e-Pakistan, given to him on May 18, 1991 —** a few months after he was awarded the Bharat Ratna in March that year.

Devnimori Relics of Lord Buddha

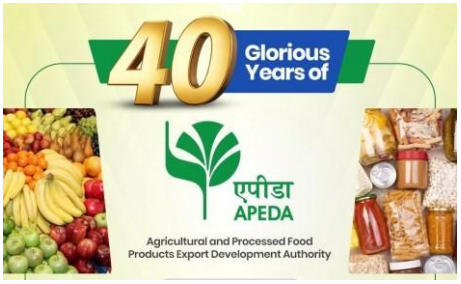


- India is set to undertake a profound gesture of spiritual outreach and cultural diplomacy through the exposition of the sacred Devnimori Relics of Lord Buddha in Sri Lanka.
- The Devnimori Relics originate from the Devnimori archaeological site, located near Shamlaji in the Aravalli district of Gujarat.
- It was first explored in 1957 by eminent archaeologist Prof. S. N. Chowdhry

Major Findings of Excavations

- The excavations revealed important Buddhist structures and relics that stand testimony to the flourishing of Buddhism in western India.
- The relic casket found within Devnimori Stupa at a height of 24 feet from the base, made out of green schist.
- It is inscribed in Brahmi Script and Sanskrit language, it reads. “dashabala sharira nilay” – the abode of the Buddha’s bodily relic.
- It holds a copper box having organic matter with holy ashes, with silk cloth and beads.

Union Minister Piyush Goyal extends his greetings to APEDA on its 40th establishment day



- Union Minister extended greetings to the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) on its 40th establishment day.
- APEDA is a statutory export promotion authority established under the APEDA Act, 1985 (Act 2 of 1986) to promote the export of agricultural and processed food products from India. It replaced the Processed Food Export Promotion Council (PFEPC).
- **Established In:** Act passed: December 1985
- **Came into effect:** 13 February 1986
- **Administrative Ministry:** Functions under the Ministry of Commerce & Industry, Government of India.

Key Functions of APEDA:

- Export Promotion & Market Development: Provides financial assistance, market intelligence, and global branding support to boost agri-exports.
- **Registration of Exporters (RCMC):** Registers exporters of scheduled products and ensures compliance with export norms.
- Quality Standards & Certification: Fixes export standards and monitors quality, including inspection of meat and processed products.
- **Packaging & Value Addition Support:** Promotes improved packaging, labeling, and value-added processing to enhance global competitiveness.
- **Data Collection & Trade Statistics:** Collects and publishes export data to support policy formulation and trade planning.

Department of Posts Releases Set of 8 Commemorative Postage Stamps on ‘Puppets of India’

- The Department of Posts issued a set of 8 Commemorative Postage Stamps on “Puppets of India” on 13th February 2026 at the Indian Habitat Centre, New Delhi.

A set of eight stamps

- namely Kathputli (Rajasthan), Yakshagana Sutrada Gombeyatta (Karnataka), Daanger Putul (West Bengal), Kathi Kundhei (Odisha), Benir Putul (West Bengal), Pavakathakali (Kerala), Ravanachhaya (Odisha) and Tolu Bommalatta (Andhra Pradesh).



PM-DAKSH Scheme



- Recent data released in the Lok Sabha revealed that Less than half of the students trained under the PM-DAKSH scheme between 2021 and 2024 were placed.
- The **Pradhan Mantri Dakshata Aur Kushalata Sampanna Hitgrahi (PM-DAKSH)** Yojana, is a **Central Sector Scheme** that was launched during 2020-21.
- Aim: To provide skills through good quality institutions so that candidates from its target group can find employment.
- **There are four types of skill development training programmes under this namely,** Up-skilling/Re-skilling, Short Term Training Programmes, Long Term Training Programmes, and Entrepreneurship Development Programme.
- **Target Group:** Scheduled Castes, Other Backward Castes, Economically Weaker Sections, and the De-notified Tribes in India (DNTs), 'Safai Karamcharis' or waste pickers.

Eligibility

- **Age:** 18-45 years
- OBC and EWS candidates must have a **family income below Rs. 3** lakh, while there is no income limit for SC, DNT, or Safai Mitras/Waste Pickers.
- It has been merged with the **Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana of the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship..**

Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0



- The Union Cabinet has approved the Startup India Fund of Funds 2.0 (FoF 2.0).
- Startup India FoF 2.0 is a ₹10,000 crore government-backed fund designed to mobilise long-term domestic capital by investing in Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs), which in turn invest in startups.
- Approved in 2026 by the Union Cabinet.
- Launched under the broader Startup India initiative.
- Builds on the earlier Fund of Funds for Startups (FFS 1.0) launched in 2016

Urban Challenge Fund (UCF)

- The Union Cabinet has approved the launch of the Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) with ₹1 lakh crore Central assistance to drive market-led urban transformation.

- The Urban Challenge Fund (UCF) is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme** designed to support transformative and bankable urban infrastructure projects through a competitive "challenge mode" framework.
- **Organisation involved:** Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) – Nodal ministry for implementation and monitoring.



Salient Features of the Urban Challenge Fund:

- **₹1 Lakh Crore Central Assistance:** Central share covers 25% of project cost to catalyse investments.
- **Market-Linked Financing Model:** Minimum 50% project funding must be mobilised from market sources.
- **Challenge-Based Selection:** Competitive framework prioritising high-impact, reform-oriented proposals.
- **Reform-Linked Funding:** Fund release tied to governance, financial, planning, and operational reforms.
- **₹5,000 Crore Credit Enhancement Corpus:** Strengthens creditworthiness of 4,223 cities, especially Tier-2 & Tier-3.
- **Credit Repayment Guarantee Scheme**: Provides up to ₹7 crore guarantee for first-time loans to smaller ULBs.
- **Operational Period:** FY 2025–26 to FY 2030–31 (extendable till 2033–34).
- **Project Verticals:** Focus on Cities as Growth Hubs, Creative Redevelopment, and Water & Sanitation.
- **Digital Monitoring:** Paperless tracking via single MoHUA digital portal.

Vibrant Villages Programme

- **Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation recently inaugurated a two-day workshop on the Vibrant Villages Programme (VVP) in New Delhi**, organised by the Border Management Division of the Ministry of Home Affairs.
- It is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme implemented over the financial years 2022-23 to 2025-26.
- **Objective:** Comprehensive development of the 2,967 villages in 46 blocks in 19 districts abutting the northern border in the States of Arunachal Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Sikkim, Uttarakhand, and UT of Ladakh.
- Vibrant Village Action Plans will be created by the district administration with the help of Gram Panchayats, and 100% saturation of Central and state schemes will be ensured.
- There will be no overlap with the Border Area Development Programme.

Nationwide Campaign "Badhna Hai Toh Yahan Judna Hai" launched



- Shri Jayant Chaudhary, Minister of State for Skill Development and Entrepreneurship and Minister of State for Education, Government of India, launched a nationwide awareness campaign titled "Badhna Hai Toh Yahan Judna Hai" on the sidelines of the India AI Impact Summit 2026.
- **The campaign aims to further expand access to Skill India Digital Hub (SIDH)**
- The campaign brings on board legendary actor Amitabh Bachchan.
- **Built as a mobile-first, AI-enabled platform, SIDH integrates multiple government skilling initiatives**, offers industry-aligned and future-ready courses, and provides personalized recommendations based on learner interests and career goals.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman Launches National Monetisation Pipeline 2.0 in New Delhi

- The second phase of the pipeline has been developed by NITI Aayog**, in consultation with infrastructure line ministries, based on the mandate for 'Asset Monetisation Plan 2025-30'** as announced in the Union Budget 2025-26.

- **NMP 2.0 aims to provide a medium-term roadmap of the programme for public asset owners; along with visibility on potential assets to private sector.**
- The aggregate asset pipeline under NMP 2.0 over the five-year period, FY 2026-2030.
- The National Monetisation Pipeline (NMP) is a structured and transparent roadmap that lists major infrastructure assets to be monetised over a fixed period.
- **It was first announced by the Finance Minister** and covers core revenue-generating assets belonging to the Central Government and its departments.



AI-Preneurs of India

- The Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) under NITI Aayog launched AI-Preneurs of India at the India AI Impact Summit 2026.
- **AI-Preneurs of India is a flagship coffee table book that documents the journeys of 45 pioneering AI startups solving real-world problems.**
- It is the 7th edition of AIM's Innovations For You series and showcases India's growing deep-tech and AI startup ecosystem.



AI Impact Summit: Government launches SAHI, BODH to strengthen health AI ecosystem

- The Union Minister of Health and Family Welfare will launch two key national initiatives namely SAHI and BODH at the India AI Summit at Bharat Mandapam

About SAHI

- The Strategy for Artificial Intelligence in Healthcare for India (SAHI) is a **national guidance framework to enable the safe, ethical, evidence-based, and inclusive adoption of Artificial Intelligence across India's healthcare system.**
- It aims to provide strategic direction on governance, data stewardship, validation, deployment, and monitoring of AI solutions, while supporting States and institutions in responsible adoption aligned with public health priorities.

About BODH

- The Benchmarking Open Data Platform for Health AI (BODH) developed by the Indian Institute of Technology Kanpur in collaboration with the National Health Authority.
- It is a **privacy-preserving benchmarking platform that enables rigorous evaluation of AI models using diverse, real-world health data without sharing underlying datasets.**
- It is a digital public good under the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission.

AI-for-Energy mission

- The **International Solar Alliance (ISA)** launched a **global AI-for-Energy mission** at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi to fast-track clean energy adoption across 120+ member countries.
- A strategic **international initiative designed** to integrate Artificial Intelligence (AI) into the clean energy infrastructure of developing and emerging economies.
- It leverages the India Energy Stack—a digital public infrastructure model—to modernize grids and decentralize power systems.
- **Launched By**: The International Solar Alliance (ISA), in partnership with India's **Ministry of Power, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), and REC Limited.**



The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology unveiled VoicERA at the India AI Impact Summit 2026

- It is an open-source, end-to-end Voice AI stack.

- It is deployed on the BHASHINI National Language Infrastructure.
- It establishes a national execution layer for multilingual Voice and Language AI.
- It is designed to be open, pluggable, interoperable, cloud deployable, and on premise ready.
- **The platform enables secure and scalable deployment of voice systems across government, research institutions, and innovation ecosystems.**



What is BHASHINI?

- **BHASHINI, or the BHASHa Interface for India**, is an artificial intelligence (AI)-powered language translation platform.
- It is developed by the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY)** under its National Language Translation Mission.
- It aims to build a **National Public Digital Platform** for languages to develop services and products for citizens by leveraging the power of AI and other emerging technologies.
- It helps people translate content into various Indian languages.
- It is implemented by **Digital India BHASHINI Division**, a division under Digital India Corporation, a Section 8 Company of the MeitY.
- **Bhashini currently supports more than 22 languages**, enabling inclusivity for a broad range of linguistic communities

At Delhi AI Impact Summit 2026, PM Modi unveils 'MANAV' vision for artificial intelligence

- PM Modi unveiled 'MANAV' vision for AI, which encompasses moral and ethical systems, accountable governance and national sovereignty.



The acronym

- **'M' stands for moral and ethical systems**
- **'A' stands for accountable governance**
- **'N' stands for national sovereignty**
- **'A' stands for accessible and inclusive**
- **'V' stands for valid and legitimate**

India Joins Pax Silica at India AI Impact Summit 2026

- India formally joined Pax Silica –the US-led effort on artificial intelligence and supply chain security .



What is Pax Silica?

- Launched in December 2025, Pax Silica is the US Department of State's flagship effort on AI and supply chain security, advancing economic security consensus among allies and trusted partners a new.
- **The name combines "Pax" (Latin for peace) and "Silica" (referencing silicon chips), symbolising a stable, cooperative, and peaceful technological order.**
- The coalition aims to secure the entire AI technology stack, from mineral extraction to advanced manufacturing and logistics.

America-India Connect Subsea Cable Initiative

- Google **CEO Sundar Pichai** announced the billion **"America-India Connect" initiative** at the India AI Impact Summit in New Delhi.



- A massive collaborative digital infrastructure project that anchors **Google's five-year, billion** investment in India.
- It involves the construction of **multiple international subsea cable**s and a **new subsea gateway** on India's east coast to provide high-speed, resilient connectivity for AI and cloud workloads.

Key Features:

- **New Subsea Gateway:** Establishment of India's first major international subsea gateway in **Visakhapatnam (Vizag),** providing geographic diversity from existing landings in **Mumbai and Chennai**.
- **Three New Subsea Paths:** Direct routes connecting India to **Singapore, South Africa, and Australia.**
- **Four Strategic Fiber Routes**: New paths linking the **US East/West coasts to India via Africa and the South Pacific.**
- **West Coast Connectivity:** A direct fiber-optic path between **Mumbai and Western Australia.**

AI Summit Declaration 2026



- The **AI Impact Summit**, held in New Delhi from **February 16–20.**
- At the end of the summit, 88 countries and international organisations adopted the **New Delhi Declaration on AI**.
- The 2024 summit was held in Seoul, followed by the AI Action Summit in Paris in February 2025, **co-chaired by PM Modi and French President Emmanuel Macron.**
- Bengaluru-based **Sarvam AI launched India's first domestically trained multi-billion parameter large language models (LLMs).**

AI Impact Summit 2026: Key Outcomes and Controversies

- The government reported over five lakh attendees, surpassing G20 2023 participation.
- **Eighty-eight countries and international organisations —** including the US, China, France, Australia, and the UK — signed the New Delhi Declaration on AI Impact, marking a major diplomatic success for India.
- **Unlike the Paris AI Summit**, where the US and UK declined to sign, this time a wide spectrum of nations endorsed the framework.
- It announced $250 billion in overall investment commitments, including $20 billion for frontier deep-tech research, alongside more than 500 global discussions.

New Delhi Declaration on AI: Key Provisions

- The New Delhi Declaration aligns with India's multilateral priorities, with commitments described as voluntary and non-binding to encourage broad global participation.
- A central feature is a charter promoting the "democratic diffusion" of AI, ensuring wider access and preventing concentration of technological power.

SHORT NEWS

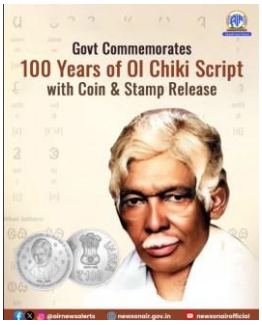
- Switzerland's President Guy Parmelin announces Geneva as host of 2027 AI Impact Summit on the sidelines of the AI Impact Summit being held at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.

NHAI to Develop First of its Kind 'BeeCorridors' Along the National Highways


NHAI to Develop First of its Kind 'BeeCorridors' Along the National Highways

- National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has announced a first-of-its-kind initiative to develop pollinator or bee corridors along National Highways.
- **The 'Bee Corridor' will have a continuous linear stretch of bee-friendly vegetation comprising flowering trees and plants that will ensure the availability of nectar and pollen throughout the year.**
- NHAI field offices will also plan and develop at least three pollinator corridors during 2026–27.

100 Years of Ol Chiki Script

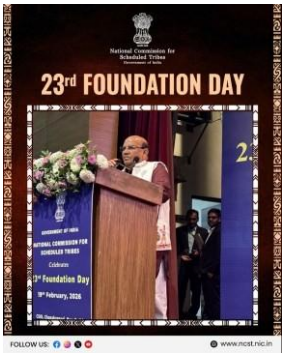


- The centenary (1925–2025) of the Ol Chiki script is being inaugurated on 16 February 2026 by the Ministry of Culture in New Delhi.
- **Ol Chiki is the official writing system of the Santhali language, a major tribal language of India.**
- It is a scientifically designed script created to represent Santhali sounds accurately.
- Unlike borrowed scripts (Roman, Bengali, Odia, Devanagari), Ol Chiki was built specifically for Santhali phonetics.
- Developed in 1925 by Pandit Raghunath Murmu.
- **First major literary work**: High Serena (1936).
- **States where widely spoken**: Jharkhand, Odisha, West Bengal, Assam, and Bihar
- Indigenous design philosophy – Not adapted from Brahmi or Roman roots.

Constitutional Milestone:

- Santhali was included in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution in 2003 via the 92nd Constitutional Amendment Act.
- **In December 2025, the Constitution of India was translated into Santhali using Ol Chiki.**

National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST)



- The National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) **celebrated its 23rd Foundation Day in New Delhi on 19th Feburary.**
- The National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST) is a constitutional body **established under Article 338A** of the Constitution of India to protect, monitor and promote the rights and welfare of Scheduled Tribes (STs).
- It acts as a watchdog institution ensuring implementation of constitutional safeguards and addressing grievances related to tribal communities.
- Established in 2004 following the Constitution (89th Amendment) Act, 2003.

2003–04: 89th Constitutional Amendment bifurcated the body into:

- National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC)
- National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (NCST)

Members:

- **The NCST consists of:**
  - Chairperson
  - Vice-Chairperson
  - Three Members
- All are appointed by the President of India and generally include persons with expertise in tribal administration, social justice and policy.

e- Railway Claims Tribunal system



- Recently, the Union Minister for Railways launched the e- Railway Claims Tribunal system as reform number four under Indian Railways' flagship "52 Reforms in 52 Weeks" initiative.
- **It will enable end-to-end computerisation and digitisation of the Railway Claims Tribunal**.
- **Objective**: It will transform the filing, processing and adjudication of claims by making the process faster, more transparent and accessible from anywhere in the country.

The platform comprises three core components

- It helps in 24×7 online filing of claims and legal documents from any location and uploading of petitions, affidavits, annexures and supporting records.
- It is a **centralized database of all cases** for auto-allocation, case registration and real-time tracking from filing to final to final disposal.

- It is the **digital storage of pleadings, notices,** summons, orders and judgements along with digitally signed records

MeitY Launches 'Blockchain India Challenge' to Boost Digital Governance



- The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) launched the Blockchain India Challenge
- **A national initiative aimed at encouraging Indian startups to develop permissioned blockchain-based digital governance solutions for government use cases**
- The initiative is being implemented by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) with support from MeitY

Cabinet approves Minimum Support Prices for Raw Jute by Rs 275 per quintal



- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs has approved Minimum Support Prices (MSP) of Raw Jute for Marketing season 2026-27.
- The MSP of Raw Jute (TD-3 grade) has been fixed at Rs 5925 per quintal for 2026-27 season.
- The MSP of Raw Jute for Marketing season 2026-27 is an increase of Rs 275 per quintal over the previous Marketing season 2025-26.
- **The Minimum Support Price (MSP) is the minimum price set by the government to ensure farmers receive fair value for their crops, even when market prices fall.**
- This concept was introduced in 1966-67 during the Green Revolution as part of agricultural reforms, MSP serves as a safety measure taken by the union government to protect farmers from financial losses and maintain food security.

ANVESH–2026 to Focus on Sustainable Healthy Foods



- National Institute of Food Technology Entrepreneurship and Management (NIFTEM-K), **under the Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI), will organise the "International Conference on Advanced Next Generation Vision for Emerging and Sustainable Healthy Foods (ANVESH–2026)" from 26–28 February 2026.**
- ANVESH–2026 will provide a robust global platform for dialogue on emerging areas such as digital compliance, food safety and traceability, alternative proteins, nutraceuticals, waste management, circular economy approaches and agri-food entrepreneurship.

Nitin Gadkari Launches Upgraded RAJMARG PRAVESH Portal

- Union Minister of Road Transport and Highways, Shri Nitin Gadkari, launched the upgraded RAJMARG PRAVESH web portal .
- **It is for hassle free obtaining No Objection Certificates (NOCs) for fuel stations**, wayside amenities, private properties, rest area complexes, connecting roads, and other such facilities along National Highways
- The portal can also be used by Government and private organizations to obtain permissions for laying utilities such as water pipelines, gas pipelines, optical fibre cables, electrical lines, and other services along or across National Highways.

Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change to organize 'Him-CONNECT'

- **T**he Union Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) is organising 'Him-CONNECT', as part of the The Energy and Resources Institute's (TERI) World Sustainable Development Summit (WSDS), from 25th - 27th February 2026 in New Delhi.

- 'Him-CONNECT' is a platform aimed at connecting researchers working in the Indian Himalayan Region (IHR) with start-ups, investors and policymakers to enable the scaling and on-ground application of their research outcomes.



DBT Launches SUJVIKA AI Biotech Data Portal

- Recently, the Union Minister of Science & Technology launched the SUJVIKA Portal during the 40th foundation day of the Department of Biotechnology.

About SUJVIKA Portal

- It is an AI driven Biotech Product Data Portal.
- It is developed in collaboration with Industry partners ABLE.
- **SUJVIKA is a Trade Statistics Digital Intelligence Platform that presents authenticated biotechnology product import data in a structured and accessible format.**

MSME Ministry Upgrades NSIC to Schedule 'A' Category CPSE



- The Ministry of MSME has upgraded the National Small Industries Corporation (NSIC) from a Schedule 'B' to a Schedule 'A' Central Public Sector Enterprise (CPSE).

What are Category CPSE?

- Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs) are companies where the direct holding of the Central Government is 51% or more.
- **To streamline management and salary structures, the Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) classifies these entities into four distinct schedules: A, B, C, and D.**

The Four Categories:

- **Schedule A:** The highest tier, comprising large-sized enterprises with significant national and strategic importance.
- **Schedule B:** Mid-sized enterprises.
- **Schedule C:** Smaller enterprises or those with niche operations.
- **Schedule D:** The smallest tier, often used for initial categorization of new CPSEs.

Governing Act & Authority:

- **Governing Act**: Most CPSEs are incorporated under the Companies Act, 2013 (or previous versions like the 1956 Act) or created as Statutory Corporations through specific Acts of Parliament.
- **Administrative Authority:** The Department of Public Enterprises (DPE), under the Ministry of Finance, is the nodal agency for categorization and policy formulation.

India Launches Zero Prize, Paying Big for Tangible Pollution Reduction

- Zero Prize has been launched as India's first national results-based environmental award that directly links financial incentives to independently verified reductions in air, water, and land pollution.

- Convened by the School of Policy and Governance (SPG), the initiative is supported by philanthropic funding, corporate CSR partnerships, and institutional stakeholders.
- It aims to align financial support with measurable environmental outcomes.
- With a total corpus of ₹5 crore, **the Zero Prize will grant ₹1 crore each in three categories—Air, Water, and Land—to solutions that demonstrate scientifically validated pollution reduction within defined geographies.**
- The prize is structured as an annual national initiative focused on results-based environmental recognition and performance-linked funding.
- **The framework aligns with national missions, including the National Clean Air Programme, the National Mission for Clean Ganga and Swachh Bharat Mission 2.0 by accelerating verifiable, on-ground environmental outcomes.**
- Eligible applicants must implement a real-world pilot within defined urban or peri-urban contexts and undergo independent third-party monitoring and validation.
- **Early-stage concepts without measurable on-ground execution will not qualify.**

BANKING / FINANCE

Union Budget 2026-27

Union Budget 2026-27 highlights: Key announcements from FM Nirmala Sitharaman's speech





- Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, presented the Union Budget 2026-27 on February 1, 2026.
- The government has chosen the path of "reforms over rhetoric", delivering growth rate of around 7% for India.
- **Ms. Sitharaman delivered her ninth Budget speech in the Parliament , a first in independent India's history.**
- This is also the third Budget of the BJP-led NDA government in its third term in office.
- **Ms. Sitharaman had in her first Budget in 2019 replaced the leather briefcase** — which was in use for decades for carrying Budget documents — with a traditional 'bahi-khata' wrapped in red cloth.
- This year's Budget would also be in paperless form.
- **For the first time in India's fiscal history, the Union Budget will be presented on a Sunday**
- The finance minister highlighted the need to adopt new technologies in the 21st century **and mentioned aritificial intelligence 11 times in her speech which is the highest ever for an FM's Budget speech in India.**
- In 2026 the Finance Minister spoke in Parliament for 1 hour and 25 minutes, which comes to a total of 85 minutes.
- The shortest Union Budget speech ever was delivered much earlier, in 1977–78, by former Finance Minister Hirubhai M. Patel. He was serving in the Morarji Desai government.

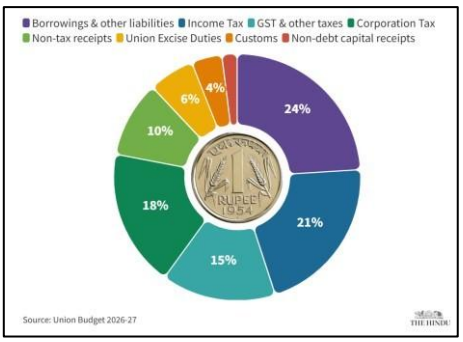
Three 'kartavyas' of the Govt.

- **First kartavya:** To accelerate and sustain economic growth, by enhancing productivity and competitiveness, and building resilience to volatile global dynamics.
- **Second kartavya**: To fulfil aspirations of our people and build their capacity, making them strong partners in India's path to prosperity.
- **Third kartavya:**To ensure that every family, community, region and sector has access to resources, amenities and opportunities for meaningful participation. This is "aligned with our vision of Sabka Sath, Sabka Vikas

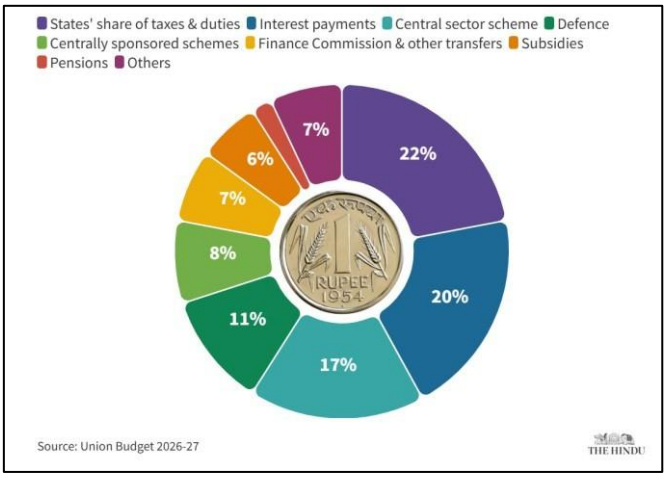
Budget estimates for FY 2026-2027

- Fiscal Deficit: 4.3%
- Revenue Deficit: 1.5%
- Effective Revenue Deficit: 0.3%
- Primary Deficit: 0.7%

Where does the money come from?



Where does the money go?



Union Budget 2026 : Key highlights



- FM announced the budget to be 'Yuva Shakti Driven Budget' and the government's sankalp is to focus on poor, underpriviliged and disadvantaged.

Biopharma SHAKTI (Strategy for Healthcare Advancement through Knowledge, Technology and Innovation):

- Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman proposed to develop India as a global bio-pharma manufacturing hub by establishing Bio Pharma Shakti with an outlay of Rs 10,000 crore over the next 5 years.
- This will build an ecosystem for domestic productions of biologics and biosimilars.

2. India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) 2.0 to be launched

- **India Semiconductor Mission** — Recognising the significance of semiconductors in achieving technological self-reliance and economic growth, India launched the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) in 2021 with the aim to strengthen India's strategic position in the global value chain.

3. Odisha, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu to establish dedicated rare earth mineral corridors.

4. Scheme for Enhancement of Construction & Infrastructure Equipment (CIE) to be introduced
5. Three dedicated Chemical Parks to be established.
6. Manufacturing Scheme to be introduced with budgetary allocation of ₹10,000 crore over 5 year period
7. Scheme to revive 200 legacy industrial clusters to be introduced.

Textile Sector: the Budget has proposed **a new scheme Mahatma Gandhi Gram Swaraj Yojana** to boost the Khadi handloom sector with training, skilling, production and quality checks, says Sitharaman.

The Budget proposed Integrated Programme with 5 sub-parts:

- **National Fibre Scheme** for self-reliance in natural fibres, Textile Expansion and Employment Scheme to modernise traditional clusters, A National Handloom and Handicraft programme, Tex-eco initiative, and Samarth 2.0.
- **A Scheme to revive 200** legacy industrial clusters to improve their cost competitiveness and efficiency were introduced in the Budget.
- **Creating "Champion SMEs" :** Recognising MSMEs as a vital engine of growth, Budget proposed three-pronged approach to help them grow as 'Champions': Equity support, liquidity support, and Professional Support.

8. Infrastructure: The Budget proposed to increase the Public capex to ₹12.2 lakh crore, compared to ₹2 lakh crore in FY2014-15, shows multifold increase, to continue the momentum of infrastructure development.

9. The FM has proposed to set up an Infrastructure Risk Guarantee Fund to provide prudently calibrated partial credit guarantees to lenders.

10 . **For environmentally sustainable movement of cargo,**

(a) It has been proposed to establish **new Dedicated Freight Corridors** connecting Dankuni in the East, to Surat in the West;

(b) Operationalise **20 new National Waterways (NW)** over next 5 years;

(c) Launch a **Coastal Cargo Promotion**

11. **Scheme for incentivising a modal shift from rail and road.** A ship-repair ecosystem is to be established in **Varanasi and Patna**.

12. **Carbon Capture Utilization and Storage technologies**: FM has proposed an outlay of Rs 20,000 crore over the next 5 years in Carbon Capture Utilization and Storage (CCUS) technologies. CCUS is a means of reducing atmospheric emissions of carbon dioxide — a key driver of global warming and climate change.

13. Sports: To transform the Sports sector over the next decade, the Budget has proposed **to launch a Khelo India Mission** to systematic nurturing the sports talent in the country.

14. Ease of Doing Business (EoDB): For this, the Budget has announced to permitted Individual Persons Resident Outside India (PROI) to invest in equity instruments of listed Indian companies through the Portfolio Investment Scheme.

15. 'Education to Employment and Enterprise' standing committee: Union FM Nirmala Sitharaman has proposed to set up a high-powered 'Education to Employment and Enterprise' standing committee

16. — Medical tourism service: In order to promote India as a hub for medical tourism services, a new scheme will be launched by the government to support States in establishing five Regional Medical Hubs, in partnership with the private sector.

17. — Ayurveda: Recognising the growing global demand of Ayurveda, the Budget has proposed to

- (i) set up 3 new All India Institutes of Ayurveda;
- (ii) upgrade AYUSH pharmacies and Drug Testing Labs; and
- (iii) upgrade the WHO Global Traditional Medicine Centre in Jamnagar.

18. Orange Economy: FM announces content creator labs to boost India's Animation Visual effects, Gaming and Comic (AVGC) sector in 15,000 secondary schools across India and 500 colleges.

19. Education: The Budget has proposed the following:

- **National Institute of Design** to be established to boost design education and development in the eastern region of India
- **5 University Townships** to be created in vicinity of major industrial and logistic corridors
- **1 girls' hostel** to be established in every district in Higher Education STEM institutions
- **4 Telescope Infrastructure facilities** to be set up or upgraded to promote Astrophysics and Astronomy



20. Catering Technology. A pilot scheme will be launched for upskilling 10,000 guides in 20 iconic tourist sites and a **National Destination Digital Knowledge Grid will also be establishe**d to digitally document all places of significance—cultural, spiritual and heritage

21. Heritage and Culture Tourism: The government has proposed to develop 15 archeological sites including Lothal, Dholavira, Rakhigarhi, Adichanallur, Sarnath, Hastinapur, and Leh Palace into vibrant, experiential cultural destinations.

22. — FM proposed Bharat-VISTAAR (Virtually Integrated System to Access Agricultural Resources) —a multilingual AI tool that shall integrate the AgriStack portals and the ICAR package on agricultural practices with AI systems.

- FM announced that **Self-Help Entrepreneur (SHE) Marts** will be set up as community-owned retail outlets. It is built in the success of Lakhpati Didi Program.

23—Healthcare & accessibility: R&D and integration into assistive devices for People with Disabilities manufactured by Artificial Limbs Manufacturing Corporation of India (ALIMCO).

24. Mental Health and Trauma Care

- Since there are no national institutes for mental healthcare in north India, the government **will set up a NIMHANS-2** and also upgrade **National Mental Health Institutes** in Ranchi and Tezpur as Regional Apex Institutions. Currently, NIMHANS is located in Bengaluru, Karnataka.

25. **FM proposed the development of Purvodaya** through an integrated East Coast Industrial Corridor with a well-connected node at Durgapur,

- creation of 5 tourism destinations in the 5 Purvodaya States.
- **FYI: Purvodaya focuses on five states, namely Bihar, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Odisha, and Andhra Pradesh.**
- — Focussing on Buddhist sites in North-East India and civilizational confluence of Theravada and 18 Mahayana/Vajrayana traditions, FM proposed to launch a Scheme for Development of Buddhist Circuits in Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim, Assam, Manipur, Mizoram and Tripura.

New Income Tax Act

- Income Tax Act, 2025 will come into effect from 1st April, 2026. The simplified Income Tax Rules and Forms will be notified shortly, giving adequate time to taxpayers to acquaint themselves with its requirements.

Union Budget 2026: what gets costlier, what gets cheaper?

What gets costlier ?
Umbrella and its parts
Gutka
Paan Masala
Beedis
Khanij (Minerals such as Iron, Coal, Salt)
Futures and derivative trading

What gets cheaper?
17 Cancer drugs or medicines
Leather or synthetic footwear
Smartphones
EV batteries
Microwave ovens

Solar panels
Lithium Battery Components
Drugs and medicines for 7 additional rare diseases
Civilian training aircraft parts
Leather products
Dutiable drugs and medicines imported for personal use (HS Code: 9804)
Overseas Tours packages

Railway Budget 2026

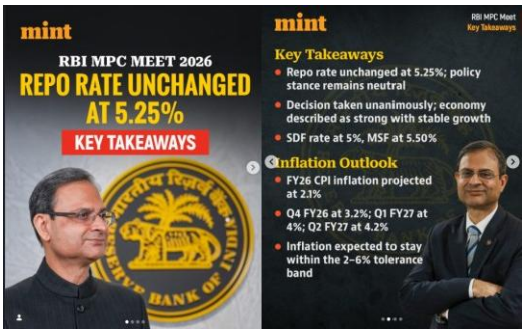
- The Ministry of Railways has been allocated a total capital expenditure (capex) of Rs 2,93,030 crore in the Union Budget for the financial year 2026–27.
- It received total outlay of Rs 2,78,030 crore in the Budget 2026. This is the highest-ever allocation for the ministry.
- **In the Union Budget 2026-27, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman proposed to develop seven high-speed rail corridors across the country.**
- **These are:** Mumbai-Pune, Pune-Hyderabad, Hyderabad-Bangalore, Hyderabad-Chennai, Chennai-Bangalore, Delhi-Varanasi, and Varanasi-Siliguri.

India Budget 2026: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman chooses Kanjeevaram saree and Bahi-Khata tablet for budget presentation



- This time the minister has gone for handwoven traditional Kanjeevaram silk saree, sourced from Tamil Nadu's centuries-old weaving traditions.
- **The now-iconic digital tablet enclosed in a traditional red bahi-khata-style pouch.**
- Traditionally, the Kanjeevaram is a saree that is usually handwoven in mulberry silk and has pure gold or silver zari that renders it a festive quality

RBI MPC keeps repo rate unchanged at 5.25%



- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) conducted its first Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting of 2026, during which RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra announced that the key policy rate, known as the repo rate, will remain unchanged at 5.25%.
- The inflation for FY 2025-26 is at 2.1%.
- CPI inflation projection for FY26 to 2.1%
- FY26 GDP real GDP growth projection to 7.4% from 7.3% earlier,
- Monetary policy refers to the use of monetary instruments under the control of the central bank to regulate magnitudes such as interest rates, money supply, and availability of credit with a view to achieving the ultimate objective of economic policy.

- The repo rate is the interest rate at which the RBI lends short-term funds to commercial banks against government securities.
- It serves as a primary tool for the RBI to regulate liquidity, control inflation, and influence overall economic activity.
- By adjusting the repo rate, RBI can either encourage banks to borrow more (by lowering the rate) or discourage borrowing (by raising the rate), thus influencing the money supply in the economy.
- The reverse repo rate is the interest rate at which the central bank (such as the RBI) borrows surplus funds from commercial banks, thereby absorbing excess liquidity from the system.
- It is the opposite of the repo rate, where commercial banks borrow from the central bank.

Moody's Ratings projected India's GDP to grow at 6.4% in the in FY'27, the fastest pace among G-20 economies



- As per official estimates, India is likely to grow at a faster pace of 7.4% in the current fiscal (2025-26), higher than 6.5 per cent growth clocked in 2024-25.

NPCI. extends 'UPI One World' wallet service to visitors from 40 countries to AI Summit



- National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has announced the extension of the UPI One World wallet services for international visitors from over 40 countries attending the India AI Impact Summit 2026 from 16–20 February in New Delhi.
- **The wallet is available at New Delhi Airport and the NPCI Pavilion.**
- Visitors can load money and pay via UPI QR codes using the PPI-UPI app, avoiding cash and forex issues

New GDP Series (Base Year FY23)



- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) **has officially overhauled India's national accounts, shifting the GDP base year from 2011-12 to 2022-23 and introducing significant methodological shifts to improve accuracy**.
- The GDP base year is a standard reference point used by economists to calculate Real GDP.
- By using prices from a specific stable year (now 2022-23), the effect of inflation is removed, allowing the government to measure the actual increase in production and output of the economy.

New Base Year:

- **Current**: 2011-12
- **Revised**: 2022-23 (FY23)
- **Frequency**: India periodically updates this to align with the International System of National Accounts (SNA).

Key Changes in the New GDP Series:

- **Granular Deflators**: The number of price indicators has tripled (from ~180 to ~600), utilizing specific CPI and WPI components to ensure real output isn't distorted by broad price averages.
- **Double Deflation**: In a major technical shift for manufacturing and agriculture, inputs and outputs are now deflated separately.
- **Targeted Indices**: The use of composite economy-wide indices has been replaced by sector-specific and unit-value indices, tailoring the measurement to the unique price movements of specific industries.
- **From Proxies to Actuals**: Instead of using old survey data to guess current activity, the series now uses annual level estimates from the Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprise (ASUSE) and the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS).

- **Capturing the Gig Economy**: New data codes specifically track the contribution of platform workers (e.g., delivery partners and aggregator drivers).

Integration of Big Data & Administrative Datasets

- **GST & Digital Footprints**: GST data is now a primary tool for cross-validating corporate growth and allocating economic activity across states.
- **Sectoral Tracking**: The series incorporates e-Vahan data for a precise count of road transport services and the Public Finance Management System (PFMS) for real-time tracking of government spending.

INTERNATIONAL CA

4 February - National Day of Sri Lanka



- to commemorate the country's political independence from British rule in 1948.
- Capital : Sri Jayawardenepura Kotte (legislative), Colombo (executive)
- Currency: Sri Lankan rupee (Rs) (LKR)
- Sri Lanka, island country lying in the Indian Ocean and separated from peninsular India by the Palk Strait.
- President - Anura Kumara Dissanayake
- Prime Minister - Harini Amarasuriya



India and Gulf Cooperation Council sign Terms of Reference for a Free Trade Agreement



- Recently, India and the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) have signed the Terms of Reference for a Free Trade Agreement in New Delhi.
- GCC - Cooperative agreement among six-nation bloc, established by an agreement concluded on 25 May 1981.
- Members (6): United Arab Emirates; Kingdom of Bahrain; Kingdom of Saudi Arabia; Oman; Qatar; Kuwait.
- Headquarters: Riyadh, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.



India-U.S. tariff deal 2026



- The 2026 India-U.S. trade deal slashes total effective tariffs on Indian goods from 50% to 18%
- by entirely removing a 25% punitive penalty and lowering the base reciprocal tariff from 25% to 18%.
- According to the Commerce and Industry Ministry, India's goods trade surplus with the US almost halved, falling from $3.17 billion in April to $1.73 billion in November.

Key Concerns and Unanswered Questions

- Zero Tariffs: It mentioned only the tariff reduction, US claimed India agreed to zero tariffs and to significantly increase purchases of American goods. However, clarity on whether zero tariffs apply universally, especially in sensitive sectors like agriculture, remains lacking.
- American Agricultural Exports: US suggested increased Indian purchases of US agricultural products, but details on US imports of Indian produce were not provided..

- Russian Oil Purchases: US stated India agreed to cease Russian oil purchases, favoring US and potentially Venezuelan oil. However, Modi did not mention this publicly
- India's Services Exports: The US administration's stricter immigration policies, such as the increased H-1B visa fee.



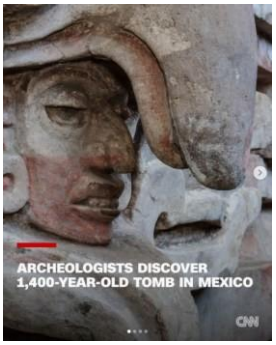
Arab League

- Recently, the External affairs minister met the foreign ministers of five Arab League member states and held discussions on ways to develop ties with West Asia and the situation in the region.
- The Arab League, or League of Arab States, is a voluntary association of countries whose peoples are mainly Arabic-speaking or where Arabic is an official language.
- It is a regional organization of Arab states in the Middle East and parts of Africa.
- Formation: It was formed in Cairo on 22 March 1945 with six members: Egypt, Iraq, Transjordan (later renamed Jordan), Lebanon, Saudi Arabia, and Syria, with Yemen joining on 5 May 1945.
- Observer Members: Brazil, Eritrea, India, and Venezuela.
- Headquarters: Cairo, Egypt.



Zapotec Civilization

- Archaeologists in Mexico recently discovered a 1,400-year-old tomb from the Zapotec culture that features well-preserved details, including a sculpture of a wide-eyed owl with a man in its beak, multicolored murals and calendrical carvings.
- The Zapotec civilization thrived in the Valley of Oaxaca, Mexico, characterized by its high elevation and reliance on irrigation from the Atoyac River and its tributaries.
- Emerging from hunter-gatherer societies, the Zapotecs transitioned to agriculture, developing skills in weaving, pottery, and stone masonry.
- It was also one of the first to experience the drawbacks of urban living, particularly the need to conquer others in order to obtain sufficient food to sustain an urban civilization.
- Decline around 900 CE shifted the capital to Mitla and later Zaachila.



Elon Musk became the first individual on Earth to cross a net worth of USD 800 billion.

- Musk's fortune jumped sharply after the merger of SpaceX and xAI, creating a combined entity valued at USD 1.25 trillion.



World Government Summit 2026 Opens in Dubai

- The World Government Summit 2026 opened in Dubai
- under the theme "Shaping Future Governments,"



Blue Line along the Lebanon–Israel frontier



- The United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL) temporarily suspended patrols along parts of the Blue Line.
- The Blue Line is a UN-identified line of withdrawal, marking Israel's pullback from southern Lebanon.
- It is not an international border, but a temporary demarcation used to monitor compliance with UN resolutions.
- Located in: Runs for about 120 km along southern Lebanon, separating it from Israel and the Israeli-occupied Golan Heights.

BRICS Centre for Industrial Competencies.



- Recently, India joined the **BRICS Centre for Industrial Competencies (BCIC)** at Vanijya Bhavan, New Delhi.
- It was launched in partnership with the United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO).
- Objective: It serves as a one-stop centre providing integrated support services to manufacturing companies and Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) across BRICS countries.
- It is a network-driven initiative under UNIDO, supporting SMEs, industrial modernization, and digital transformation in BRICS.
- It focuses on strengthening Industry 4.0 competencies.
- Implementation: The National Productivity Council (NPC) has been designated as the India Centre for BRICS Industrial Competencies.

Project Vault



- The US government recently rolled out **Project Vault**, a $12 billion scheme to stockpile rare earths and critical minerals, aiming **to shield American companies from global supply disruptions.**
- It is a public-private partnership that will buy and store critical minerals and rare earth elements.
- These minerals are used in products such as smartphones, batteries, jet engines, and electric vehicles.

Chinese New Year 2026



- Chinese New Year, also known as the Spring Festival,
- celebrated by **Chinese and East Asian** communities around the world.
- In 2026, the festivities will commence on the Lunar New Year, - **February 17,** and will conclude on **March 3.**
- It marks the start of a new year on the traditional lunisolar **Chinese calendar**, with the celebration spanning 15 days.
- Also known as **Lunar New Year**
- commencing at the end of the first lunar month and ending in the **Lantern Festival,** which marks the **first full moon** of the **new lunar year.**
- The **Year of the Fire Horse** replaces the Year of **the Wood Snake in 2025**, beginning on **February 17** and ending on **February 5, 2027,** when the **Year of the Fire Goat begins.**

Tamil Brahmi inscriptions found in Egypt's Valley of the Kings shed light on ancient trade links



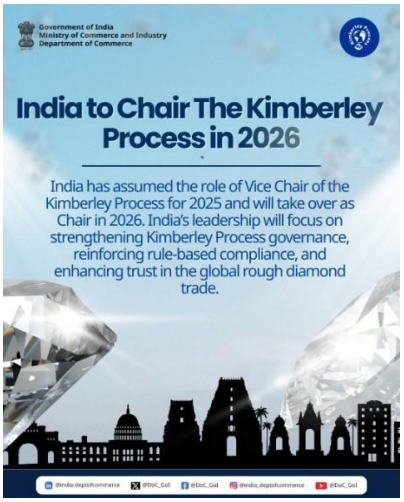
- Two researchers recently identified close to 30 inscriptions in **Tamil Brahmi, Prakrit and Sanskrit** at tombs in the **Valley of the Kings in Egypt.**
- These inscriptions are said to belong to the period between the **1st and 3rd Centuries C.E.**

Valley of the Kings

- It was the **burial site of dozens of pharaohs**, or kings, of ancient Egypt.
- The valley lies in the southern half of Egypt, just west of the **Nile River**.
- It was part of the **ancient city of Thebes**.
- These **pharaohs ruled from 1539 to 1077 BC,** during the period of Egyptian history known as the New Kingdom.
- **By that time** the **pharaohs had stopped** building pyramids to serve as their tombs.
- In **1979 UNESCO made the Valley of the Kings** part of the **World Heritage site** of ancient Thebes

India has assumed the chair of the Kimberley Process (KP) for the year 2026.

- It is a coalition of governments, civil society and the diamond industry to eliminate the trade in so-called conflict diamonds.
- Conflict diamonds are defined by the relevant United Nations Security Council resolution (UNSC resolution 1459) as “rough diamonds used by rebel movements or their allies to finance conflict aimed at undermining legitimate governments”.
- Based on a mandate from the United Nations, the Kimberley Process regulates the international trade in rough diamonds.



What is the Kimberley Process Certification Scheme (KPCS)?

- It is the mechanism the KP uses to prevent the trade of conflict diamonds.
- Under this scheme, the Government implements safeguards on shipments of rough diamonds and certifies the diamond as conflict-free.
- According to this Scheme, each rough diamond shipment must be accompanied by the Kimberley Process certificate and transported in a tamper-resistant container.
- Since 2003, India has been actively participating in the KPCS process.
- **The Department of Commerce is the nodal Department.**
- Gem & Jewellery Export Promotion Council (GJEPC) is designated as the KPCS Importing and Exporting Authority in India.
- GJEPC is responsible for issuing KP Certificates and is also the custodian of KP Certificates received in the country.

PM Modi visits Malaysia

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi's official state visit to Malaysia, where he held wide-ranging talks with counterpart PM Dato’ Seri Anwar Ibrahim
- India and Malaysia unveiled multiple initiatives aimed at deepening cooperation between the countries in defence and security, semiconductors and trade segments





1. Establishment of an **Indian Consulate General in Malaysia.**
2. Agreement between NIPL (NPCI International Payments) and Malaysia's national payments network PAYNET SDN BHD, on cross-border payments
3. Audio-visual co-production agreement between the governments of India and Malaysia
4. MoU between India and Malaysia on co-operation in **disaster management.** EoN on cooperation in the field of semiconductors between the governments of India and Malaysia.
5. Framework agreement on International Big Cats Alliance (IBCA).
6. 6. MoC between India's Employees' State Insurance Cooperation (ESIC), and Social Security Organisation (PERKESO) on Social Security Programs and Activities for Indian citizens as insured persons in Malaysia.
7. 7. Establishment of a dedicated Thiruvalluvar Centre in University Malaya, Kuala Lumpur
8. 8. Institution of Thiruvalluvar Scholarships for Malaysian Nationals
9. 9. Memorandum of understanding (MoU) between University of Cyberjaya (UoC) and Institute of Training and Research in Ayurveda (ITRA) on academic collaboration.

Malaysia



- Southeast Asian Country, separated by South China Sea into Peninsular Malaysia (West Malaysia) and East Malaysia (on Borneo Island).
- Official Capital: Kuala Lumpur
- Bordering countries: Thailand, Brunei and Indonesia, linked to Singapore by a bridge.
- Maritime Border: **Strait of Malacca, South China Sea, Sulu Sea and Sulawesi/Celebes Sea.**

India-Malaysia

- Defense: Exercises Harimau Shakti (Army), Udarashakti (Air).
- Trade: India's 3rd largest trading partner in ASEAN.

Chabahar Port



- Iran has reaffirmed its support for the Chabahar Port project and deeper cooperation with India despite uncertainty arising from renewed U.S. sanctions and the possible expiry of the sanctions waiver.
- Chabahar Port is Iran's only oceanic deep-sea port, developed as a multipurpose commercial and strategic port to facilitate regional trade, transit, and connectivity between South Asia, Central Asia, and the Middle East.
- Location: Situated in southeastern Iran, in Sistan–Baluchestan province
- Lies on the Gulf of Oman, with direct access to the Indian Ocean
- Comprises two terminals: **Shahid Kalantari and Shahid Beheshti**
- Integrated with road–rail projects connecting Iran to Afghanistan and Central Asia
- Part of the broader International North–South Transport Corridor (INSTC) vision
- In 2016, India, Iran and Afghanistan formalised cooperation to use Chabahar as a transit hub

PM Modi announces Special Economic Package of 175 million dollars for Seychelles



- Recently, India and Seychelles discussed strengthening maritime trade and blue economy cooperation at a Business Roundtable in Mumbai, underscoring Seychelles' strategic role in India's Indian Ocean outreach under the MAHASAGAR vision.
- Location: It is an archipelagic island country located in the western Indian Ocean.

- It is located to the northeast of Madagascar and east of mainland Africa.
- Other major islands near Seychelles include Comoros and Mauritius to the south, and Maldives to the east.
- It consists of an archipelago of 115 islands (only 8 are permanently inhabited).
- Capital City: Victoria.
- Mahe Group is volcanic with a narrow coastal strip and rocky, hilly interior; others are relatively flat coral atolls, or elevated reefs; sits atop the submarine Mascarene Plateau.
- Highest Point: The highest point in Seychelles is Morne Seychellois

Who is Narges Mohammadi and why Iran has sentenced the Nobel Peace Prize winner again



- Mohammadi won the Nobel Peace Prize in 2023 for her long-running campaign for women's rights and human rights in Iran.
- Iranian Nobel Peace Prize laureate Narges Mohammadi has been given additional prison sentences totalling seven-and-a-half years
- Since 2021, she has been serving a 13-year sentence on national security charges, which she denies.

Greek Defence Minister Nikos and Indian Defence Minister will hold a bilateral meeting at the Manekshaw Centre in New Delhi



Greece

- Location: It is located on the southern edge of the Balkan Peninsula.
- Bordering Countries: It is bordered by 4 nations namely, North Macedonia and Bulgaria in the north, Albania in the northwest, and Turkey in the northeast.
- Bordering Seas: It is also bounded by the Aegean Sea in the east, Ionian Sea in the west and the Mediterranean Sea in the south.
- Capital: Athens



India conferred with 'Country of the Year' at BIOFACH 2026 in Germany



- India has been designated as the 'Country of the Year' at BIOFACH 2026, the world's leading trade fair for organic products, scheduled to be held from February 10 to 13 in Nuremberg, Germany,
- Organised by the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA).
- The pavilion will showcase a wide range of organic products such as rice, oilseeds, herbs, spices, pulses, cashew, ginger, turmeric, large cardamom, cinnamon, mango puree, and essential oils, among others.

NATO launches new 'Arctic Sentry' mission



- NATO had launched a new mission to bolster security in the Arctic, **in a move to assuage US President Donald Trump after he backed off claims on Greenland.**
- Arctic Sentry **underscores the alliance's commitment to safeguard its members and maintain stability** in one of the world's most strategically significant and environmentally challenging areas,"
- NATO Full FormThe full form of NATO is **North Atlantic Treaty Organization.**
- It is a **military alliance established on April 4, 1949**, with the signing of the **North Atlantic Treaty (also known as the Washington Treaty).**
- As of 2026, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) has **expanded to 32 member countries**, growing from the **original 12 founding nations**.
- The **founding members of NATO** are Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, the United Kingdom, and the United States.

India, UK Sign Social Security Agreement for Temporary Employees

- **India and the United Kingdom** have signed a **Social Security Agreement (SSA)** to prevent double social security contributions for employees on **short-term assignments**.
- India and the United Kingdom have signed a reciprocal Social Security Agreement, **also referred to as a Double Contributions Convention (DCC),** to eliminate the burden of dual social security payments for employees temporarily working in each other's territory.
- The agreement **allows employees on assignments of up to 36 months** to continue contributing to their home country's social security system, thereby avoiding double payments.

Russia Blocks WhatsApp, Urges Shift To Max Messenger



- Russia has blocked the popular messaging platform WhatsApp, citing non-compliance with domestic legislation.
- directing Russian citizens to use its state-backed Max app.
- WhatsApp is owned by Meta Platforms Inc., a US-based technology company.
- End-to-end encryption ensures only communicating users can read messages.

Saudi Arabia to Host HCI Conference 2026 in Riyadh

- Saudi Arabia has announced the third edition of the Human Capability Initiative (HCI) Conference 2026,
- scheduled to take place in Riyadh on 3–4 May
- under the theme "The Human Code."
- The United Kingdom has been designated as the Country of Honor

News in shorts

- US President Donald Trump has launched a new website, TrumpRx.gov, aimed at lowering the cost of prescription medicines for Americans

Trump Announces 10% Global Tariff After Supreme Court Setback



- Following the judicial setback to his tariff policy, U.S. President Donald Trump announced a temporary blanket tariff surcharge of **15% (from 10% earlier) on global imports for 150 days,** invoking powers under the Trade Act of 1974.
- The move came a day after the Supreme Court of the United States invalidated his sweeping reciprocal tariffs imposed under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA).
- The decision has significant implications for India–U.S. trade relations, global trade flows, and the ongoing negotiations for a bilateral trade agreement.

New tariff regime:

- 15% ad valorem surcharge on imports, to be effective from February 24, and valid for 150 days.
- It applies uniformly to all countries, including India.

Impact on India

- **Tariff changes:** The new tariff rate (15%) is lower as compared to the previous rate (18%).
- Earlier effective tariff under IEEPA (~22.3%).
- Potential tariff after court verdict (without surcharge) – ~8.2%.
- Thus, India benefits compared to earlier tariffs, but loses potential gains from the court ruling.

Russia moves to replace Gulag museum



- Founded in 2001, Moscow's Gulag History Museum, the last major institution in Russia devoted to documenting the legacy of Joseph Stalin's forced labour camps, is now set to be replaced with a new state museum centred on Nazi crimes.

Jean Todt Launches UN Global Road Safety Campaign 'Make A Safety Statement' in India

- **The United Nations Secretary-General's Special Envoy for Road Safety, Jean Todt**, launched the UN-JCDecuax Global Campaign for Road Safety, titled Make A Safety Statement.
- The Campaign is aimed at promoting everyday measures to improve road safety.
- **A project titled 'Sustainable Financing for Road Safety in India: A Collaborative Approach', supported by the UN Road Safety Fund was also launched.**
- The initiative, implemented with technical support from the World Health Organization, UNICEF and the UN Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific,

Operation Chivalrous Knight 3



- The Ruler of Ajman has launched a humanitarian air bridge to Gaza for Ramadan **under Operation Chivalrous Knight 3.**
- A comprehensive, multi-phased international humanitarian mission **led by the United Arab Emirates (UAE)** to provide emergency relief and infrastructure **support to the Palestinian people in the Gaza Strip.**
- To alleviate the humanitarian crisis in Gaza by ensuring a steady flow of food, medical supplies, and essential services to displaced families and vulnerable groups, especially during the Holy Month of Ramadan.

Saka Nakodar Day



- **On February 17, the City of Stockton** in California proclaimed **February 4 as Saka Nakodar Day,** marking 40 years since four unarmed Sikh students were shot dead in Punjab, India.
- **On February 4, 1986, Ravinder** Singh, Harminder Singh, Baldhir Singh, and Jhilman Singh — **all unarmed students — were shot dead in a police firing while participating in a peaceful protest against the desecration of Sikhism's sacred scripture in Nakodar.**
- The public anger forced the Government of Punjab to establish the Justice Gurnam Singh Commission of Inquiry the same year.

India-UK Offshore Wind Taskforce



- **India and the United Kingdom** launched the India-UK Offshore Wind Taskforce under Vision 2035 to accelerate cooperation in offshore wind energy development.

- The India-UK Offshore Wind Taskforce is a **bilateral cooperation platform launched under the Fourth India-UK Energy Dialogue** to strengthen collaboration in offshore wind energy.

India–France Special Global Strategic Partnership



- French President Emmanuel Macron visited India, to participate in the AI **I**mpact Summit and **inaugurate the 2026 India-France Year of Innovation.**
- During this visit, both nations elevated their bilateral ties to a "**Special Global Strategic Partnership" to guide cooperation until 2047**.

Key Agreements under the New Partnership:

- **Year of Innovation 2026:** Launching a series of high-impact collaborations in AI, healthcare, and sustainable development across both nations.
- **Focus on the co-production of fighter jet engines** (Safran-HAL) and the procurement of 26 Rafale-Marine jets.
- A commitment to co-develop SMRs and Advanced Modular Reactors (AMRs) to bolster India's 100 GW nuclear target.
- Establishing a research centre involving AIIMS New Delhi and the Paris Brain Institute to integrate AI into healthcare
- **Space Autonomy**: Expanding cooperation in human spaceflight, satellite launchers, and space situational awareness through the CNES-ISRO partnership.
- **Introducing visa-free transit for Indian nationals through French airports** (6-month pilot) and targeting 30,000 Indian students in France by 2030.

H-125 Helicopter



- Recently, the Prime Minister of India and French President Mr Emmanuel Macron inaugurated the **Final Assembly Line of the Airbus H-125 Light Utility Helicopter, located at Vemagal, Karnataka.**
- It is a single-engine light utility helicopter from the legendary Ecureuil family.
- It is valued for its reliability, low maintenance and adaptability.
- **The H125 is the only helicopter in history to have landed on the summit of Mount Everest**.
- **Uses**: It is used in emergency services, aerial filming, tourism, law enforcement, firefighting, and civil transport.

French President Emmanuel Macron invites PM Modi to G7 Summit in France



- French President Emmanuel Macron has invited Prime Minister of India to attend the **52nd G7 Summit (2026) in France.**
- The G7 Summit 2026 is the annual meeting of leaders of the world's seven advanced democracies to deliberate on global economic stability, security, climate change, and geopolitical issues.
- **Host Country:** France
- **Venue:** Évian, France
- The **Group of Seven (G7)** is an informal forum of leading industrialized democracies that meet annually to coordinate responses to global economic and political challenges.
- **Members of G7:** United States, United Kingdom, France, Germany, Italy, Japan, and Canada.
- The **European Union (EU)** participates as a non-enumerated member represented by the Presidents of the European Council and European Commission.
- **Established:** 1975 (Rambouillet Summit, France).

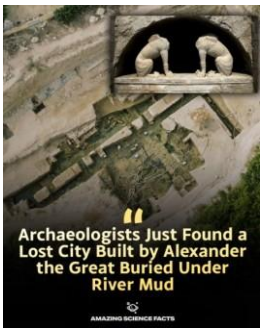
Iran Temporarily Closes Strait of Hormuz During US Talks





- It is a narrow waterway between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula, specifically the United Arab Emirates, and Musandam (Oman).
- The Gulf of Oman is on the strait's east, while the Persian Gulf is on the west.
- **It is the only sea channel linking the oil-rich Persian Gulf (west) with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea (southeast).**
- Iran is located on the north coast, while the UAE is on the south coast.
- At its narrowest point, the Strait of Hormuz is only 29 nautical miles wide (54 km).
- **The Strait of Hormuz is considered one of the world's most economically important choke points.**
- About 30% of the world's liquefied gas and 25% of oil pass through the Strait of Hormuz.
- It serves as a key passage for supertankers transporting oil and gas from Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Iraq, Qatar, Bahrain, the UAE, and Iran.

Deep in the deserts of Iraq, the lost city of Charax Spasinou has finally been found



- It was an ancient port city located at the confluence of the Tigris and Choaspes rivers**, near the modern border of Iraq and Iran.**
- Founded during the Hellenistic period, it was initially established by Alexander the Great.
- It was reportedly founded in 324 BCE, just a few years before Alexander's death.
- He might have wanted it to cement control over Mesopotamia at a strategic river junction.
- **Some sources say it was originally called Alexandria**.
- The city passed to the Seleucid Empire after Alexander's death until it was destroyed at some point by flooding.
- **Due to its favourable location, Charax became a very important harbour in the Persian Gulf area and a major trading point between Mesopotamia (a region in the Middle East) and India.**

Takeshima/Dokdo Islands



- South Korea lodged a firm diplomatic protest against Japan's Takeshima Day, an annual event held in Shimane Prefecture to assert sovereignty over the disputed islets.
- The territory is a cluster of small, rocky outcroppings located in the Sea of Japan (referred to as the East Sea by South Korea).
- **Composition:** It consists of two main volcanic islets—Dongdo (East Island) and Seodo (West Island)—along with roughly 30 to 90 smaller rocks and reefs.

Dubai Esports and Games Festival (DEF) 2026

- Dubai will host the 5th edition of the Dubai Esports and Games Festival from May 8 to 24, 2026.
- **Organised by:** Dubai Festivals and Retail Establishment (DFRE).
- **Parent body:** Dubai Department of Economy and Tourism.
- The festival has witnessed rapid growth since its launch in 2022.

International Climate Initiative

- Recently, India and Germany launched a new Large Grant project for India, which has a funding volume of up to EUR 20 million under the International Climate Initiative.

About International Climate Initiative

- It is an important part of the German government's international climate finance commitment.
- **It was established in 2008.**
- It operates within the framework of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD).
- It finances climate change mitigation and biodiversity conservation in developing, emerging and transition countries to implement and ambitiously develop the Nationally Determined Contributions (NDCs) anchored in the Paris Agreement.
- **Priority Countries**: The IKI priority countries include Brazil, China, Colombia, Costa Rica, India, Indonesia, Mexico, Peru, the Philippines, South Africa, Thailand, Türkiye, Ukraine and Vietnam

20th anniversary of the Maritime Labour Convention, 2006



- The ILO and IMO marked the 20th anniversary of the Maritime Labour Convention (MLC), 2006.

About 20th anniversary of the Maritime Labour Convention, 2006:

- Often referred to as the Seafarers' Bill of Rights, the MLC, 2006 is a comprehensive international treaty that establishes minimum requirements for almost every aspect of working and living conditions for seafarers.
- **Established In**: The Convention was adopted on 23 February 2006 by the International Labour Conference in Geneva.

PM Modi arrives in Tel Aviv, set to become first Indian PM to address Knesset





- Prime Minister of India is undertaking a State visit to Israel at the invitation of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.
- Address the Israeli Parliament, Knesset, and interact with the Indian diaspora.
- Israel is a resilient democracy located at the eastern end of the Mediterranean Sea in West Asia (the Levant).
- **Established in 1948, it is the world's only Jewish-majority nation.**
- **Capital**: Jerusalem is the seat of the Israeli government, including the Knesset (Parliament) and the Supreme Court.
- **Bordering Nations:** Lebanon, Syria, Jordan, West Bank, Egypt, Gaza Strip, and Mediterranean Sea.

Key Features:

- **The Dead Sea:** Located in the Jordan Rift Valley, it is the lowest point on Earth's surface and is famous for its extreme salinity.
- **Sea of Galilee (Lake Tiberias):** Israel's largest freshwater lake and a primary water source

PM Modi conferred with Israel's 'Speaker of the Knesset Medal'



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with the "Speaker of the Knesset Medal" by Israel's Parliament, becoming the first Indian prime minister to receive the legislature's highest honour.
- **Knesset Speaker Amir Ohana presented the award to the prime minister following his address to the Israeli Parliament.**
- The medal was bestowed in recognition of the prime minister's exceptional contribution, underpinned by his personal leadership, to advancing strategic relations between India and Israel.
- Modi is among the few global leaders to have received top civilian honours from both Israel and Palestine.

- In 2018, he was conferred the Grand Collar of the State of Palestine, the highest Palestinian award granted to foreign dignitaries.

India–GCC Free Trade Agreement (FTA)



Signing of the Joint Statement formally launches negotiations for a comprehensive and mutually beneficial India–GCC Free Trade Agreement, marking a significant milestone in bilateral economic engagement.

- India and the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) signed a Joint Statement formally launching negotiations for the India–GCC Free Trade Agreement (FTA).
- The India–GCC FTA is a proposed comprehensive trade agreement between India and the **Gulf Cooperation Council (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman, and Bahrain).**
- It aims to establish a structured framework to enhance bilateral trade, investment flows, and economic integration through reduced trade barriers and improved market access.



The Druzhba Oil Pipeline

- The Druzhba oil pipeline is at the center of a geopolitical standoff following a complete halt in flows due to drone attacks, leading Hungary and Slovakia to veto new EU sanctions on Russia.
- **The Druzhba Pipeline (translating to Friendship in English) is one of the world's longest and largest crude oil pipeline networks.**
- Established during the Soviet era, it serves as the primary artery for transporting Russian and Kazakh oil to the industrial heartlands of Central and Eastern Europe.
- The network originates in Almetyevsk, Tatarstan (Russia), where it collects oil from Western Siberia, the Urals, and the Caspian Sea.



States/Countries it Goes Through:

- **Russia**: The starting point and primary source.
- **Belarus**: The central transit hub at Mazyr where the line splits.
- **Northern Branch**: Travels through Poland to reach Germany.
- **Southern Branch**: Travels through Ukraine to supply Hungary, Slovakia, and the Czech Republic.
- **Historical Branches**: Connected to Lithuania and Latvia (currently inactive).

SPORTS

The Milano Cortina 2026 Olympic and Paralympic Winter Games 2026





- The 2026 Winter Olympics are one of the biggest global sports events. Officially called the Milano Cortina 2026,
- the Games will be held in Italy.
- The 2026 Winter Olympics will be held in Italy.
- The winter olympics will take place from 6 to 22 February 2026.
- The paralympics will take place from 6 to 15 March.
- The official Mascots of Milano Cortina 2026 are two cheerful stoats named Tina and Milo.
- Their names are inspired by the host cities: Tina from Cortina d'Ampezzo and Milo from Milano.
- Milo - the Paralympic mascot, and Tina - the Olympic mascot,
- Italy is hosting the Winter Olympics for the third time:
- Cortina d'Ampezzo – 1956
- Turin – 2006
- The Winter Olympics are held every four years under the International Olympic Committee (IOC). These Games include sports played on snow and ice, such as skiing, skating, ice hockey, and snowboarding.
- The Games will feature 16 winter sports

2026 Winter Olympics: India's participation

- India will have two representatives at the 2026 Winter Olympics — Arif Mohammad Khan and Stanzin Lundup.
- Arif has qualified in Alpine Skiing, while Stanzin will compete in Cross-Country Skiing.

India to host shooting's Asian Olympic qualifying championship in 2027

- India will host the Asian Rifle/Pistol Championships 2027 in New Delhi, a key qualifying event for shooting at the LA 2028 Olympics, the National Rifle Association of India (NRAI)
- The Asian Rifle/Pistol Championships will be held from December 1 to 10 next year
- It will also be the second LA 2028 Olympic qualifying event India hosts in 2027
- World Cup (Rifle/Pistol/Shotgun) from April 21 to 30 next year, also to be held in Delhi.

Tejaswin Shankar clinches India's lone gold in Asian Indoor Athletics Championships



- Tejaswin Shankar won the men's heptathlon event to clinch India's lone gold as the country ended the Asian Indoor Athletics Championships campaign with five medals
- 6th – 8th Feb , Tianjin , China
- Host nation China
- India finished overall sixth in the medals tally, five medals – one gold, two silver, and two bronze
- China topped the chart with 34 medals — 10 gold, 11 silver and 13 bronze.
- Qatar – second Position

Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	CHINA	10	11	13	34
2	QATAR	4	0	0	4
3	JAPAN	3	6	2	11
4	KAZAKHSTAN	3	1	3	7
5	UZBEKISTAN	3	1	0	4
6	INDIA	1	2	2	5

India Dominates Asian Rifle/Pistol Championship 2026



The Asian Rifle/Pistol Championship New Delhi 2026 concluded at the Dr. Karni Singh Shooting Range,. India finished at the top of the medal standings, securing a total of **94 medals, including 51 gold, 23 silver and 20 bronze.**

Asian Shooting Championship 2026: Indian medal winners

10m air pistol

- Gold (women's individual): Esha Singh
- Gold (women's team): Suruchi Singh, Manu Bhaker and Esha Singh

10m air rifle

- Gold (men's individual): Rudrankksh Balasaheb Patil
- Gold (men's team): Rudrankksh Balasaheb Patil, Arjun Babuta and Vishal Singh
- Gold (women's team): Elavenil Valarivan, Meghana Sajjanar and Arya Borse
- Gold (mixed team): Arjun Babuta and Elavenil Valarivan
- Gold (women's individual): Elavenil Valarivan

25m pistol

- Gold (women's team): Esha Singh, Manu Bhaker and Rhythm Sangwan

50m rifle 3 positions

- Gold (men's individual): Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar
- Gold (men's team): Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar, Niraj Kumar, Akhil Sheoran

50m rifle prone

- Gold (women's team): Sift Kaur Samra, Tejaswini Sawant and Manini Kaushik

25m centre fire pistol

- Gold (men's individual): Amanpreet Singh

The 4th edition of the Women's Premier League 2026 results



- In Cricket, Royal Challengers Bengaluru have clinched their second Women's Premier League title, defeating the Delhi Capitals by six wickets in Vadodara last
- Held from Jan 09 - Feb 05
- They were crowned champions for the second time in history, joining the Mumbai Indians as the most successful team in the league.
- The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) has announced a total prize pool of ₹10 crore
- Royal Challengers Bengaluru captain Smriti Mandhana won the Orange Cap in WPL 2026,
- Gujarat Giants bowler Sophie Devine won the Purple Cap in WPL 2026.
- Sophie Devine was entitled with the Player of the Tournament.
- Sophie Devine topped the Most Valuable Player rankings in WPL 2026
- Nandni Sharma was awarded the Emerging Player of the Season in WPL 2026

ICC Under 19 World Cup 2026



- 2026; Hosted by Zimbabwe and Namibia
- Captained by: Ayush Mhatre
- India defeated England by 100 runs in the ICC Under-19 World Cup final to lift the trophy for a record sixth time.
- The Under-19 Men's cricket World Cup is an international cricket tournament, which is organised by the ICC every alternate year since 1988.
- Vaibhav Sooryavanshi won the Player of the Tournament
- 2024; Hosted by South Africa

- Winner: Australia



India thrash Bangladesh, clinch SAFF U-19 Women's title

- In Football, India thrashed Bangladesh 4-nil in the final to clinch the South Asian Football Federation (SAFF) Under-19 Women's Championship title at the Pokhara Rangasala Stadium in Nepal.

Services defeat Kerala to clinch 8th Santosh Trophy Title



- Services clinched the 79th National Football Championship for the Santosh Trophy after edging past Kerala 1-0 in the final at Dhakuakhana Stadium in Assam
- The victory secured Services their eighth Santosh Trophy title.
- Named After: Sir Manmatha Nath Roy Chowdhury, Maharaja of Santosh.
- Founded: 1941

Devika Sihag Wins Maiden BWF Super 300 Title at Thailand Masters



- Devika Sihag became only the third Indian **women's singles player to win a World Tour 300 title after triumphing at the USD 250,000 Thailand Masters in Bangkok.**
- **Devika joined P. V. Sindhu and Saina Nehwal as the only Indians** to win a Super 300 women's singles title.

News in short

- The 6th edition of the Badminton Asia Team Championships is set to begin in Qingdao, China.

Tennis: Elena Rybakina Clinches First Australian Open Crown



- Elena Rybakina defeated Aryna Sabalenka in the Women's Singles Final at the 2026 Australian Open in Melbourne.

Carlos Alcaraz wins maiden Australian Open Men's title defeating Djokovic



- In Men's Tennis, Carlos Alcaraz has won the Australian Open, completing the career Grand Slam, win his first Australian Open
- Alcaraz defeated Djokovic,

Mumbai Open 2026 tennis: Mananchaya Sawangkaew wins singles title



- Thailand's Mananchaya Sawangkaew won the women's singles title at the Mumbai Open 2026 WTA 125 tournament .
- Doubles: Elena Pridankina/Polina Iatcenko

News in short

- Indian teenage squash sensation **Anahat Singh** created history by becoming the youngest ever asian player to enter the World Top 20 in PSA rankings beating the previous record of eight time World champion Nicol David.

Pro Wrestling League 2026: Haryana Thunders win championship title

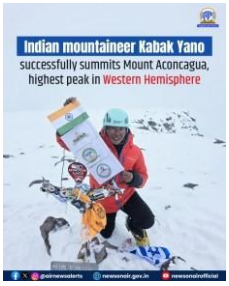
- In Wrestling, Haryana Thunders were crowned champions of the Pro Wrestling League 2026 at the Noida Indoor Stadium
- Turan Bayramov of Delhi Dangal Warriors received the Player of the Tournament award
- Neha Sangwan (Haryana Thunders) won the Player of the Match
- Ronak (Delhi Dangal Warriors) won Fighter of the Match
- Akshay Dhere (Haryana Thunders) - Impact player of the match .

Mirabai Chanu breaks three National Records at National Weightlifting Championships 2026



- Olympic silver medallist Mirabai Chanu broke three National Records during the National Weightlifting Championship 2026 in Modinagar, Uttar Pradesh
- competing in the 48kg category, recorded a best lift of 89kg in snatch and 116kg in Clean & Jerk.
- With a combined lift of 205kg, she secured the top spot on the podium

Indian mountaineer from Arunachal successfully summits Mount Aconcagua, the highest peak in Western Hemisphere



- Indian mountaineer Kabak Yano has successfully summited Mount Aconcagua in Argentina, the highest peak in South America, as part of her ambitious 7-Summit Mountaineering Expedition. Kabak Yano hails from Arunachal Pradesh.
- At 6962 metres, Mt. Aconcagua is the highest peak outside Asia.
- It lies in the Southern Andes (the world's longest mountain range that is located along the entire western coast of South America).
- At 8,850 metres, Mount Everest is the highest mountain in Asia and the world.



Jharkhand Women Strike Gold at Para Throwball Nationals 2026



- Jharkhand's women's team clinched the gold medal in Women's Category at the Para Throwball National Federation Cup 2026
- victory over hosts Rajasthan
- held from February 3 to 5,
- In the men's Category, Andhra Pradesh lifted the title, Telangana finishing runners-up, while Haryana claimed the bronze medal.

Kenya's Kemboi & Renu Singh Win Aizawl International Half Marathon 2026



- Kenya's Kemboi Kevin Kiprono won the men's 21-km race, while Renu Singh topped the women's event at the second Aizawl International Half Marathon 2026,
- Jointly organised by the Mizoram government and Innovations India

Winter Olympics 2026 – Medal Table & Highlights

- The 2026 Winter Olympics, officially the XXV Olympic Winter Games, **were held in Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy from 6 to 22 February 2026.**
- India finished the Games without a medal.
- Norway officially topped the table for the third consecutive Winter Games,



Rank	Country	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	Norway	18	12	11	41
2	United States	12	12	9	33
3	Netherlands	10	7	3	20
4	Italy	10	6	14	30
5	Germany	8	10	8	26

T20 World Cup: Rashid Khan becomes first cricketer to take 700 wickets in T20s



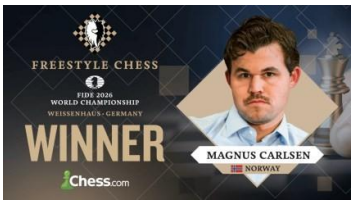
- **Afghanistan spinner Rashid Khan became the first player to achieve 700 T20 wickets during Afghanistan's group-stage match against the United Arab Emirates** (UAE), being played at the Arun Jaitley Stadium in Delhi .
- Retired West Indies all-rounder Dwayne Bravo is in second place with 631 wickets.

Chhetri becomes oldest scorer in ISL history as Bengaluru FC defeats SC Delhi



- Bengaluru FC forward Sunil Chhetri became the oldest player to score in the Indian Super League during his side's ISL 2025-26 season opener against Sporting Club Delhi at the Sree Kanteerava Stadium.
- At 41 years and 196 days, he broke the record held by French legend Robert Pires, who set it when he scored for FC Goa during the 2014-15 season, aged 41 years and 15 days.

Magnus Carlsen Wins FIDE Freestyle Chess Title 2026



- Magnus Carlsen won the 2026 FIDE Freestyle Chess World Championship on February 15, 2026, defeating American grandmaster Fabiano Caruana
- the first official Freestyle Chess World Championship
- Freestyle Chess is also known as Fischer Random chess.
- The 2026 championship was held in Weissenhaus, Germany.
- Total prize fund of $300,000, with Carlsen earning $100,000

BWF Para World Championships 2026



- The 2026 BWF Para-Badminton World Championships concluded on 14 February 2026 in Manama, Bahrain.
- **China topped** the overall medal table with 11 gold medals
- **Japan** – 2nd position
- India finished 3rd in the overall medal table - **15 medals, including 2 Gold, 5 Silver, and 8 Bronze.**
- Odisha's pride and India's ace para shuttler **Pramod Bhagat** delivered a historic performance at the BWF Para Badminton **World Championships 2026 in Bahrain**,
- clinching the Gold Medal in **Men's Singles SL3 and adding a second gold in Men's Doubles SL3–SL4** .

Greece's Stefanos Sakellaridis lifts Delhi Open 2026 singles title



- In tennis, Greece's Stefanos Sakellaridis lifted the Delhi Open 2026 men's singles title after defeating Great Britain's Oliver Crawford
- **In the doubles event, India's Siddhant Banthia and Bulgaria's Alexander Donski claimed the title .**

Carlos Alcaraz won the 2026 Qatar Open title

Event	Winner(s)
Men's Singles	Carlos Alcaraz
Women's Singles	Karolína Muchová
Men's Doubles	Henry Patten and Harri Heliovaara
Women's Doubles	Anna Danilina and Aleksandra Krunić



Short news

- Argentine tennis player Tomas Martin Etcheverry has won his maiden ATP Tour title, claiming the ATP 500 Rio Open.

Miss



The 6th National Rafting Championship titled "The Ultimate River Battle" will begin at Shibnote in Doda district of Jammu and Kashmir

INDEX

Henley Passport Index India rises to 75th, loses one visa-free destination



- The Henley Passport Index, prepared by Henley and Partners, ranks 199 passports and 227 travel destinations,
- The ranking is finalised based on exclusive data from the International Air Transport Association (IATA).
- India recorded the 75th most powerful passport in the world's most powerful passport list, enabling visa-free travel access to 56 countries
- Indian passport made an upward momentum of 10 rank in comparison to 2025's position at 85.

World's most powerful passport?

- Singapore consolidated its position as world's strongest passport with visa-free access to 192 countries.
- followed by Japan and South Korea at second spot, enabling visa-free access to 187 countries.
- They were followed by Sweden and United Arab Emirates at third spot, allowing visa-free access to 186 countries.

India Jumps Four Places in Network Readiness Index 2025

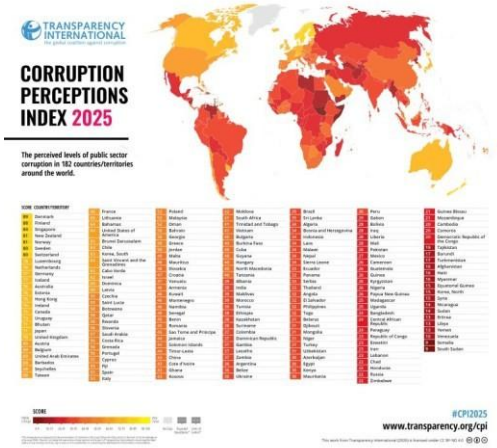


- India has improved its position by four places to rank 45th in the Network Readiness Index 2025 (NRI 2025)
- according to the report released by the Portulans Institute, a Washington DC-based independent, non-profit research and educational institute.
- The report assesses the network readiness of 127 economies based on their performance across four pillars — **Technology, People, Governance and Impact — covering a total of 53 indicators.**
- The United States retained the top position for the fourth consecutive year, leading globally in terms of access to and use of digital technologies.
- Finland has now taken second place, surpassing Singapore, which has fallen to third place this year.
- India has not only climbed the rankings but also improved its overall score, rising from 53.63 out of 100 in 2024 to 54.43 in 2025.
- India secured 1st rank in "Annual investment in telecommunication services", "AI scientific publications", "ICT services exports" and "E-commerce legislation",



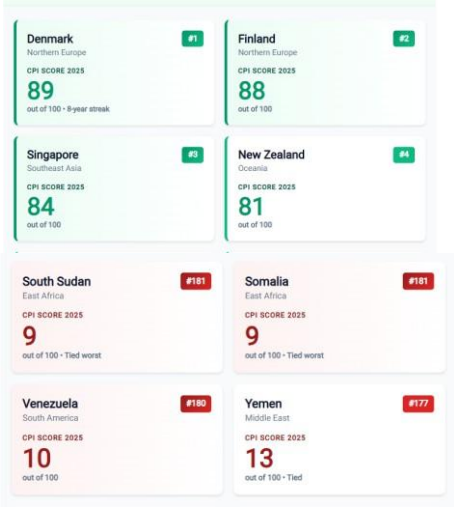
- 2nd rank in "FTTH/Building Internet subscriptions", "Mobile broadband internet traffic within the country" and "International Internet bandwidth", and 3rd rank in "Domestic market scale" and "Income Inequality".
- The Network Readiness Index maps how economies leverage information and communication technologies to support growth, innovation and social development.

Corruption Perceptions Index 2025



- Corruption globally is worsening, even in advanced democracies, as the number of countries scoring above 80 has decreased from 12 a decade ago to just five this year, according to Transparency International's 2025 Corruption Perception Index (CPI)
- The index evaluated 182 countries based on perceived public sector corruption, using a scale from zero (highly corrupt) to 100 (very clean).
- Denmark, maintaining its eight-year streak, tops the

- CPI 2025 with the highest score of 89, followed by Finland (88) and Singapore (84).
- South Sudan and Somalia, both scoring 9, tied at rank 181.
- Venezuela ranks at 180
- placing these three nations at the bottom of the index.



India's rank on the Corruption Perception Index 2025:

- In 2025, India ranked 91st globally on the Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI), scoring 39 out of 100, which is a slight improvement from the previous year

NSO to Conduct Nationwide Migration Survey in 2026–27

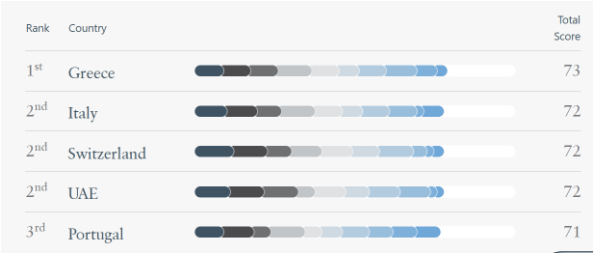
- The National Statistics Office (NSO), under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), will conduct a Survey on Migration across the country during July 2026 to June 2027, aimed at generating comprehensive and updated data on migration patterns in India.
- the proposed survey will capture detailed information on the extent and nature of migration, including rural–urban and inter-state movement, reasons for migration, return and seasonal migration, and the employment profiles of migrants.
- will help policymakers, planners, researchers and development practitioners design more targeted interventions in key areas such as urban planning, housing, transport infrastructure, employment generation, social security and skill development.
- The most recent migration-related data were collected through the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) 2020-21 and the Multiple Indicator Survey 2020–21.

Indian Youth Rank 60th in Global Mental Health Study



- Young adults in India have ranked 60th among 84 countries in **key mental well-being indicators, according to the 'Global Mind Health in 2025' report released by US-based Sapien Labs.**
- Young Indian adults recorded an average MHQ score of 33
- **Globally, young adults in economically developed countries reported poorer mental health** than peers in less developed regions.
- Countries such as Japan, Taiwan, Hong Kong, the UK and China ranked near the bottom for youth mental health,
- While several sub-Saharan African nations, including Ghana and Nigeria, performed relatively better.

+UAE Enters Top Three in Global Residence Index 2026



- The Henley Residence Program Index reflects the relative worth of the most reputable residence programs around the world.
- **Greece retained 1st position in the 2026 Global Residence Program Index.**
- United Arab Emirates (UAE) rose sharply to joint 2nd place (from 5th in 2025), entering the top three for the first time.

World Bank's Women, Business and the Law 2026 report



- The Women, Business and the Law (WBL) 2026 report is the 11th in a series of annual studies measuring the laws and policies affecting women's economic opportunities in 190 economies.

This edition uses the WBL 2.0 framework, which benchmarks three pillars:

- Legal Frameworks (the laws),
- Supportive Frameworks (policies and services), and
- Enforcement Perceptions (how laws are applied in reality).

Key Highlights of the Report:

- **The Global Score**: The global average score for legal frameworks is 67.9 out of 100, but it drops sharply to 47.3 for supportive frameworks and 53.4 for enforcement perceptions.
- **Safety Gap**: Safety is the lowest-scoring area; while many countries have some laws, enforcement fails roughly 80% of the time, and only one-third of the necessary safety laws are in place globally.
- **The 4% Benchmark**: Only 4% of women live in economies that have achieved nearly full legal equality (scoring 90 or above) across all three pillars.
- **Economic Stakes:** Closing the gender gap in labor force participation could increase global GDP by more than 20% over the next decade.
- **Childcare Deficit**: Less than half of the 190 economies have laws providing financial support for families, and in low-income economies, only 1% of the required childcare support mechanisms exist.
- **Entrepreneurship Barriers**: Although women can legally start businesses in most places, only half of economies promote equal access to credit.
- **Reform Momentum**: Over the last two years, 68 economies enacted 113 positive legal reforms, with Sub-Saharan Africa leading with 33 reforms.

PM Modi becomes most followed world leader on Instagram with 100 million followers



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi has crossed the massive milestone of 100 million followers on Instagram, making him the first world leader and politician to achieve this feat on the platform
- Prime Minister Modi joined Instagram in 2014.
- **U.S. President Donald Trump holds the second spot with 43.2 million followers.**
- He is followed by Indonesian President Prabowo Subianto with 15 million followers,